GOOGLE WORKSPACE TRAINING



Google Workspace Masterclass

One-day course review draft

Build and check practical workplace outputs with fictional project data. These notes and prompts are a written review draft awaiting full live lab validation.

Delivered by Asraf · Microsoft Certified Trainer

Collaborative Tools Masterclass

One-day course review draft · Review draft, version 0.3

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Resources: Use the practice files supplied with this review package.

Google, Google Workspace, Gmail, Google Drive, Google Docs, Google Sheets, Google Slides, Google Sites, Gemini and NotebookLM are names associated with Google. This independent training guide is not published or endorsed by Google.

Screenshots show the product at the time of writing. Google updates its apps often, so labels, availability and layouts in your account may differ. This review draft still requires full lab validation.

About the author

Asraf is a Microsoft Certified Trainer and HRD Corp-certified IT trainer based in Malaysia. He has been teaching working professionals since 2008, helping teams at banks, pharmaceutical companies, construction firms, and retailers get real work done with Microsoft 365, Power Platform, Excel, Google Workspace, and, more recently, AI tools like Copilot.

He holds a Bachelor of Information Technology (Multimedia) from the University of Malaya, along with Microsoft certifications in Power BI (PL-300) and AI for business (AB-730). Outside the classroom he writes his own automation tools in Python and Node.js, mostly to save himself from doing the same task twice.

He runs his training practice solo, which means he has personally felt every inefficiency this book tries to fix.

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INTRODUCTION

Before you begin

This review book accompanies Collaborative Tools Masterclass. Work through its chapters in order and keep the original practice inputs unchanged. The same notes and prompts also appear in the local course website.

Current Status

All chapters in this book are written drafts. Most have not yet been executed end to end in the application. The masterclass's reference brief chapter has a tested core path with a recorded recovery prompt; that does not validate the other exercises. Treat VERIFY notes and draft notices as production work still to complete.

What You Need

Use a desktop browser and the Google account approved for the class. Confirm app and AI access beforehand. Edition, administrator controls and language can affect availability.

Download the supplied fictional practice pack. No real client or personnel record is needed. Dataset week fields are relative practice weeks, not an agreed pilot start date.

How to Use the Exercises

Follow the numbered steps, attempt the output and then open the expected-result box. AI wording can vary; source facts and approval conditions must remain correct.

Values and prompts follow the notes. Replace source placeholders before submitting. Inspect proposed edits before applying them. Drafting does not authorise sending, inviting people or publishing.

Course Timing

This course is planned for 1 day, with 390 teaching minutes per day, excluding breaks and lunch. Estimates include practice, checks and discussion and need a classroom pilot.

Each course supplies independent starting inputs. Use a stated recovery file if an earlier output is missing.

Expanded Six-Lab Design

Revision 0.3 replaces eight short chapters with six connected assignments. Complete the guided work, independent change and evidence checks. Allocations are design targets awaiting a representative learner pilot. Earlier brief-core evidence does not validate these expanded labs.

01

CHAPTER 1

Build a Governed Project Workspace

Your assignment: Prepare a usable project filing system and an access plan that distinguishes ownership, editing, review and publication.

Target allocation: 60 minutes: 18 demonstration and discussion, 25 guided build, 12 independent challenge, 5 verification and repair. These are design allocations, not measured completion times. Finish the challenge and checks before moving on; finishing the guided clicks is not completion of the lab.

Status: core workspace stages captured in the real apps. Upload used the connected Drive tool because the browser extension blocked local-file selection. Shared Drive membership, reviewer allowed/denied tests and the independent challenge remain untested. Timings remain unvalidated for learners.

What You Will Learn

- Design a folder structure and recognise the source of truth for each output.
- Convert and inspect a starter workbook rather than relying on its filename.
- Find a file by name and type, distinguish shortcuts from copies, and assess access requirements.
- Explain how Shared Drive membership differs from a personal folder.

Before You Begin

Read project-facts.txt. You need Drive, Docs and Sheets. If Shared Drives are unavailable, complete the My Drive route and record the governance difference rather than claiming a Shared Drive test.

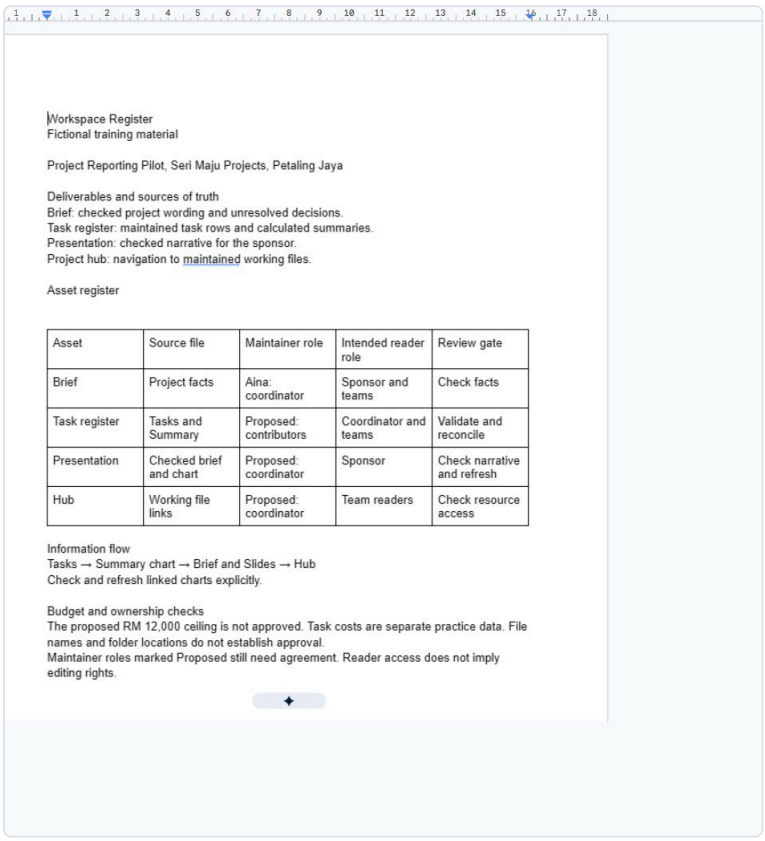
Use the copy-paste page and shared practice files. Keep fictional role names as text. Use only trainer-assigned test identities for any access test.

1.1 Plan the Information Flow

1. Create a Doc named `GW - Project Reporting Pilot - Workspace Register`. Label it **Fictional training material**.
2. Read the fact sheet and list the four deliverables. Beside each, identify what it is authoritative for: agreed brief wording, task rows, presentation narrative or navigation.
3. Add a table with columns Asset, Source file, Maintainer role, Intended reader role and Review gate. Use Aina as coordinator and Farid as sponsor only where the source supports those roles; mark unassigned responsibilities as **Proposed**.
4. Draw a simple text flow: Tasks → Summary chart → Brief and Slides → Hub. Add a note explaining that a linked chart requires a refresh check.
5. Separate the budget proposal from the task cost dataset. Record that neither a file name nor a folder location proves approval.

What should you see?

The register identifies four outputs, their source relationships and unresolved ownership decisions. No reader is treated as an editor just because they need to see a report.



Workspace Register
Fictional training material

Project Reporting Pilot, Seri Maju Projects, Petaling Jaya

Deliverables and sources of truth
Brief: checked project wording and unresolved decisions.
Task register: maintained task rows and calculated summaries.
Presentation: checked narrative for the sponsor.
Project hub: navigation to maintained working files.

Asset register

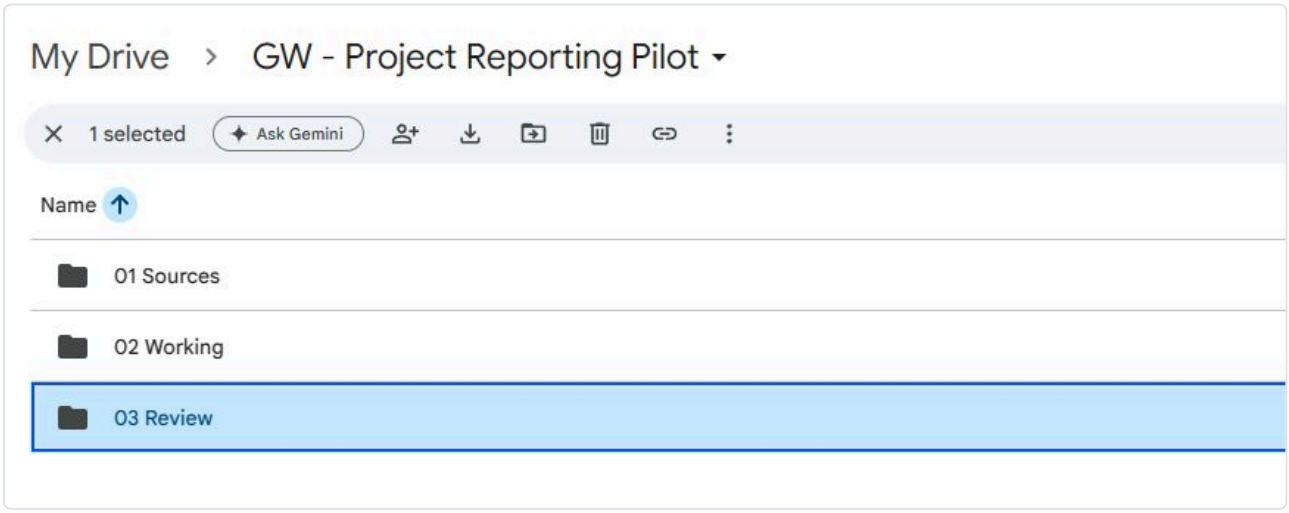
Asset	Source file	Maintainer role	Intended reader role	Review gate
Brief	Project facts	Aina: coordinator	Sponsor and teams	Check facts
Task register	Tasks and Summary	Proposed: contributors	Coordinator and teams	Validate and reconcile
Presentation	Checked brief and chart	Proposed: coordinator	Sponsor	Check narrative and refresh
Hub	Working file links	Proposed: coordinator	Team readers	Check resource access

Information flow
Tasks → Summary chart → Brief and Slides → Hub
Check and refresh linked charts explicitly.

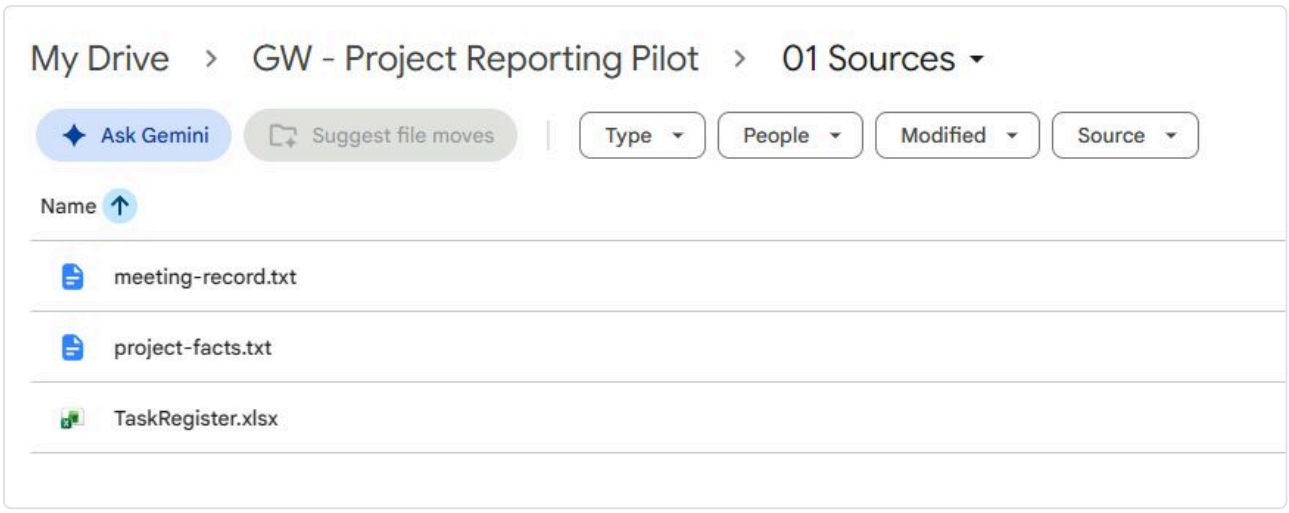
Budget and ownership checks
The proposed RM 12,000 ceiling is not approved. Task costs are separate practice data. File names and folder locations do not establish approval.
Maintainer roles marked Proposed still need agreement. Reader access does not imply editing rights.

1.2 Create and Inspect the Workspace

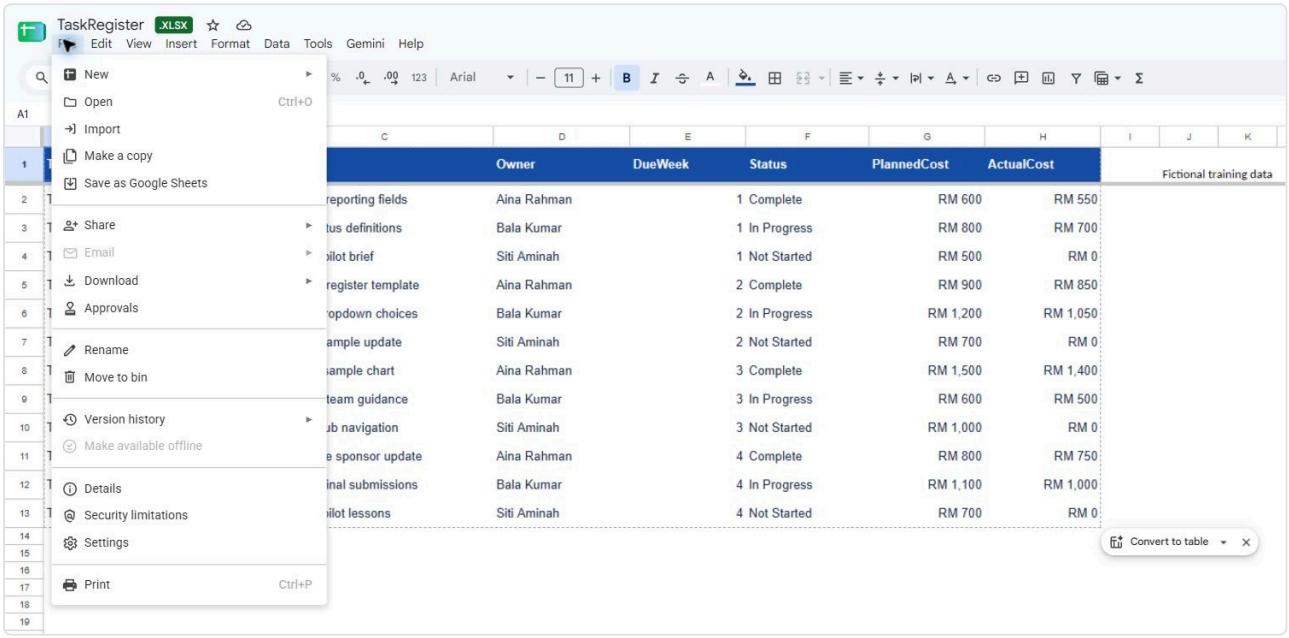
1. In Drive choose **New**, then **New folder**. Name it `GW - Project Reporting Pilot`. Inside create `01 Sources`, `02 Working` and `03 Review`.



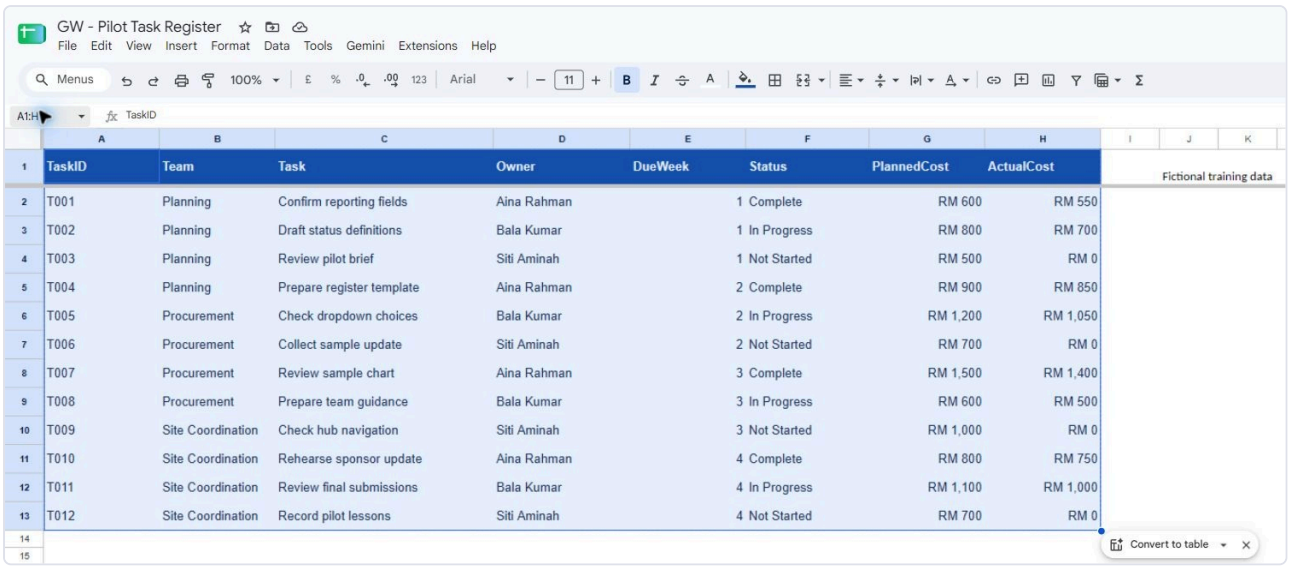
2. Upload project-facts.txt, meeting-record.txt and TaskRegister.xlsx into **01 Sources**. Keep these starter inputs unchanged.



3. Open TaskRegister.xlsx in Google Sheets. Use **File**, then **Save as Google Sheets** if it is still an Office file. Move the native version into **02 Working** and name it `GW - Pilot Task Register`.



4. Inspect **Tasks** A1:H13 and **Summary** A1:B4. Confirm 12 TaskIDs, three team names, relative week values, numeric costs and three existing status labels. Do not fill the blank Summary formulas yet.

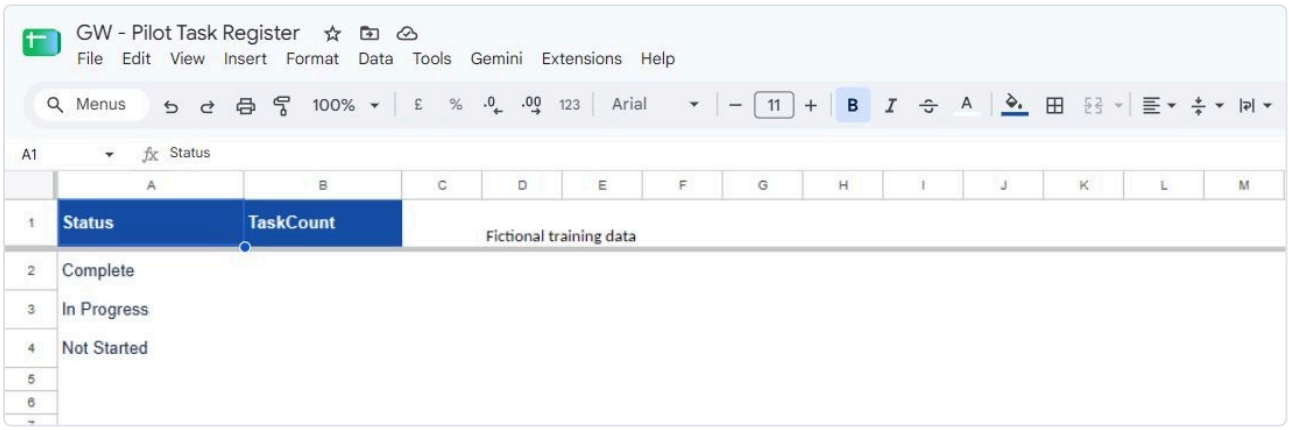

GW - Pilot Task Register

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Gemini Extensions Help

TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost
T001	Planning	Confirm reporting fields	Aina Rahman	1	Complete	RM 600	RM 550
T002	Planning	Draft status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	In Progress	RM 800	RM 700
T003	Planning	Review pilot brief	Siti Aminah	1	Not Started	RM 500	RM 0
T004	Planning	Prepare register template	Aina Rahman	2	Complete	RM 900	RM 850
T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM 1,200	RM 1,050
T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM 700	RM 0
T007	Procurement	Review sample chart	Aina Rahman	3	Complete	RM 1,500	RM 1,400
T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM 600	RM 500
T009	Site Coordination	Check hub navigation	Siti Aminah	3	Not Started	RM 1,000	RM 0
T010	Site Coordination	Rehearse sponsor update	Aina Rahman	4	Complete	RM 800	RM 750
T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM 1,100	RM 1,000
T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM 700	RM 0

Fictional training data

Convert to table

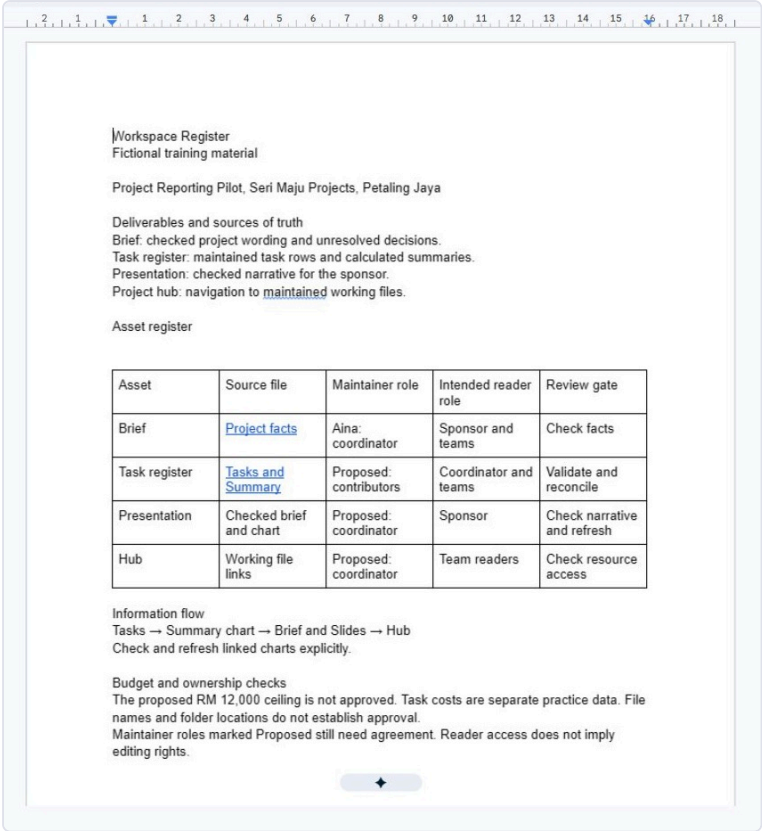

GW - Pilot Task Register

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Gemini Extensions Help

Status	TaskCount
Complete	
In Progress	
Not Started	

Fictional training data

5. Move the Workspace Register into **02 Working**. Paste links to the source fact sheet and native tracker in its asset table.



Workspace Register
Fictional training material

Project Reporting Pilot, Seri Maju Projects, Petaling Jaya

Deliverables and sources of truth
Brief: checked project wording and unresolved decisions.
Task register: maintained task rows and calculated summaries.
Presentation: checked narrative for the sponsor.
Project hub: navigation to maintained working files.

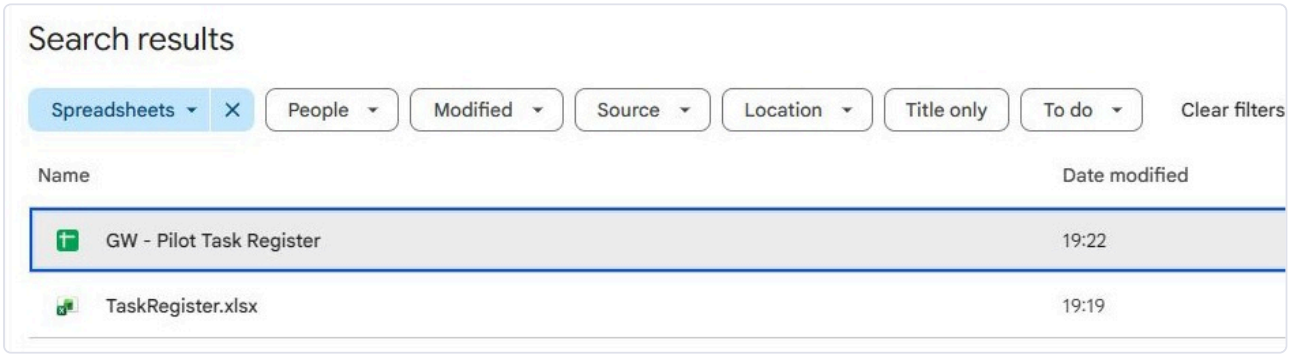
Asset register

Asset	Source file	Maintainer role	Intended reader role	Review gate
Brief	Project facts	Aina: coordinator	Sponsor and teams	Check facts
Task register	Tasks and Summary	Proposed: contributors	Coordinator and teams	Validate and reconcile
Presentation	Checked brief and chart	Proposed: coordinator	Sponsor	Check narrative and refresh
Hub	Working file links	Proposed: coordinator	Team readers	Check resource access

Information flow
Tasks → Summary chart → Brief and Slides → Hub
Check and refresh linked charts explicitly.

Budget and ownership checks
The proposed RM 12,000 ceiling is not approved. Task costs are separate practice data. File names and folder locations do not establish approval.
Maintainer roles marked Proposed still need agreement. Reader access does not imply editing rights.

6. Use Drive search to find the native tracker by its distinctive name and the **Spreadsheets** type. Open the result and confirm it has the expected two tabs rather than opening the original XLSX.

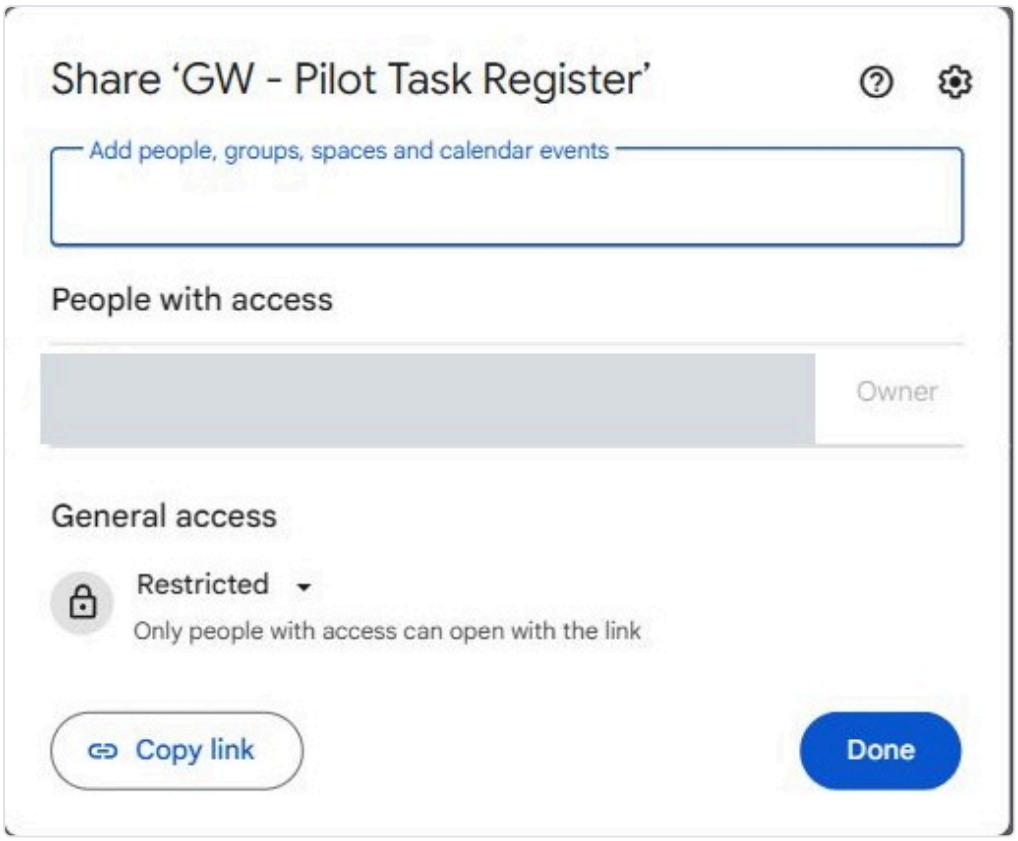


What should you see?

The original workbook and a separate native spreadsheet are easy to distinguish. The register links to the native working source. Twelve task rows remain intact.

1.3 Inspect Access and File Identity

1. Open **Share** for the working folder and native tracker. Record their current **General access** setting and who owns them. Keep them restricted during individual practice.



2. In the register create an access matrix for coordinator, sponsor, team contributor and hub visitor. Write the minimum proposed role for each asset and explain one difference between viewing and editing.

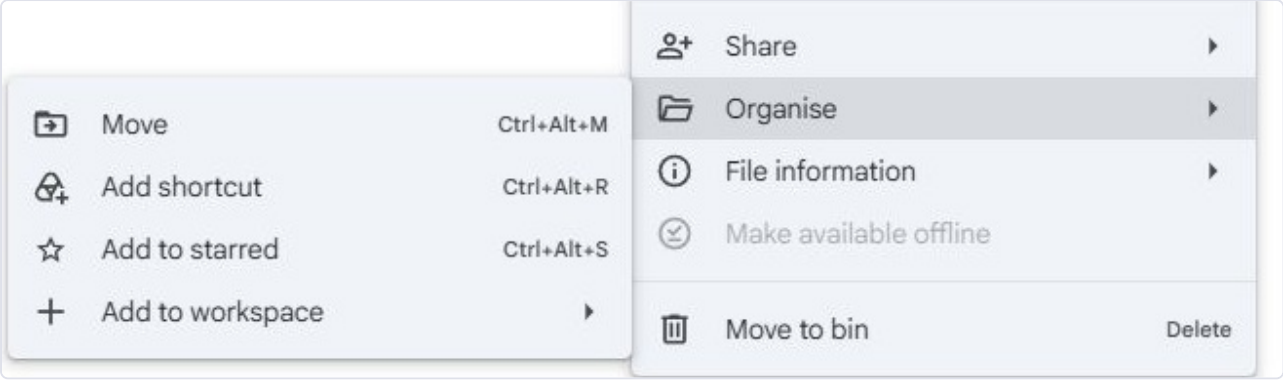
Proposed Access Plan
Fictional roles only. This is a plan, not a permissions grant.

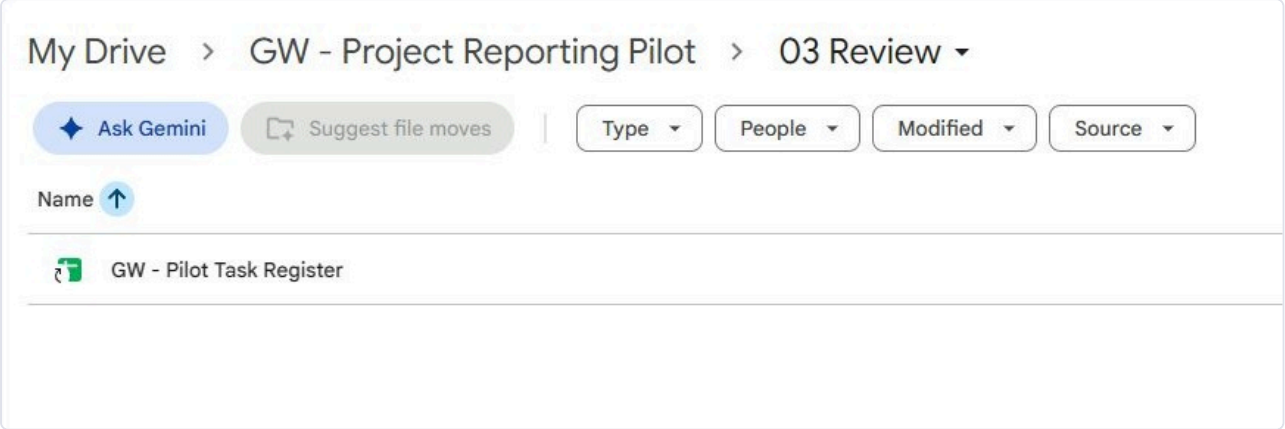
Role	Asset	Proposed access	Reason	Actually tested?	Result
Coordinator	Brief and tracker	Editor	Maintain source	No	Not granted
Sponsor	Brief and update	Viewer	Review decisions	No	Not granted
Contributor	Task register	Editor, proposed scope	Enter own updates	No	Not granted
Hub visitor	Hub and resources	Viewer	Read updates	No	Not published

Observed current state: the training account owns the working folder and native tracker; both are Restricted. No reviewer has been granted access. Proposed roles above are not actual permission changes.

If the matrix splits awkwardly across pages, insert a page break before its heading so the table stays readable. This changes layout only.

3. Choose **Organise**, then **Add shortcut** on the tracker if available. Place a shortcut in **03 Review**. Open it and compare the URL with the original. If the command is unavailable, record the dependency and use a normal link.

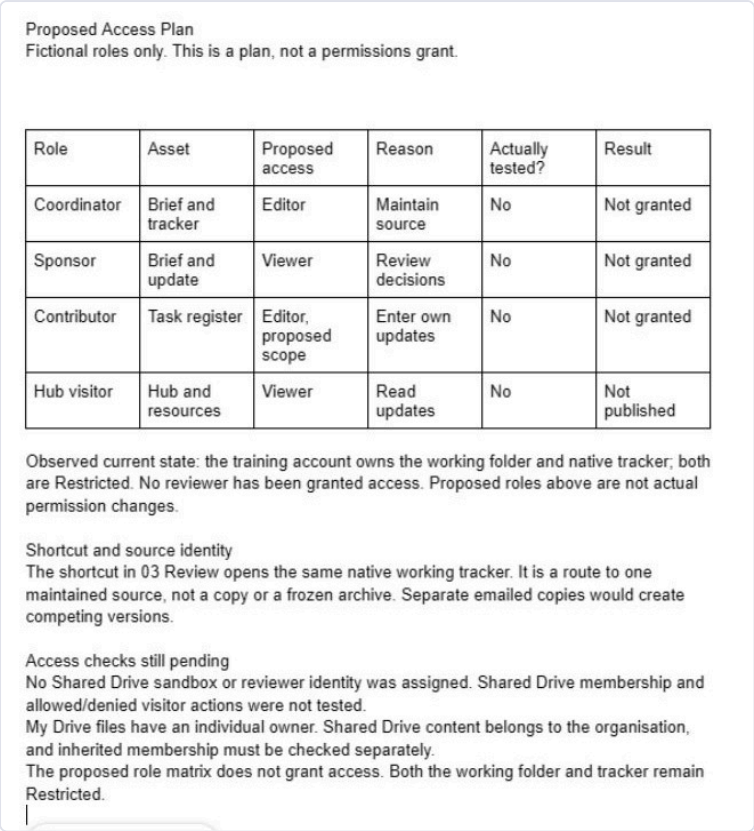




4. Explain why copying the tracker for each reviewer would create competing sources. Label the shortcut as a route to the working file, not an archive snapshot.
5. Observe the trainer inspecting Shared Drive roles and inherited membership in an assigned sandbox, if available. In your register compare who holds the content with My Drive ownership. Record **Not tested** if no sandbox exists.
6. If the trainer has assigned a test reviewer, grant only the agreed role, test through that identity, then remove the temporary grant and retest. Otherwise complete a proposed access plan and clearly label the access test as pending.

What should you see?

Links and shortcuts resolve to the intended source. Your record distinguishes inspected settings, tested access and proposed roles. Shared Drive membership is not inferred from a My Drive exercise.



Proposed Access Plan
Fictional roles only. This is a plan, not a permissions grant.

Role	Asset	Proposed access	Reason	Actually tested?	Result
Coordinator	Brief and tracker	Editor	Maintain source	No	Not granted
Sponsor	Brief and update	Viewer	Review decisions	No	Not granted
Contributor	Task register	Editor, proposed scope	Enter own updates	No	Not granted
Hub visitor	Hub and resources	Viewer	Read updates	No	Not published

Observed current state: the training account owns the working folder and native tracker; both are Restricted. No reviewer has been granted access. Proposed roles above are not actual permission changes.

Shortcut and source identity
The shortcut in 03 Review opens the same native working tracker. It is a route to one maintained source, not a copy or a frozen archive. Separate emailed copies would create competing versions.

Access checks still pending
No Shared Drive sandbox or reviewer identity was assigned. Shared Drive membership and allowed/denied visitor actions were not tested.
My Drive files have an individual owner. Shared Drive content belongs to the organisation, and inherited membership must be checked separately.
The proposed role matrix does not grant access. Both the working folder and tracker remain Restricted.

Independent Challenge

A reviewer asks you to email separate copies of every working file and says that anyone who sees the hub should edit the tracker. Without following a new click sequence, propose a better handover in the Workspace Register: a single source link, an appropriate review route and the minimum roles. Then find the tracker again without using **Recent**, and prove you opened the native working source. With an assigned test identity, demonstrate one allowed and one denied action; otherwise explain precisely what remains untested.

Evidence to Hand Over

- Workspace Register with asset inventory, source flow and proposed access matrix.
- Original inputs plus a clearly named native working tracker.
- One identity check and an access-test result or explicit pending test.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Repair to investigate
Two similarly named trackers	Compare type, location and URL; rename the working native file clearly.
A viewer can still access a file	Inspect inherited folder or Shared Drive membership as well as direct grants.
A shortcut is mistaken for an archive	Open both routes and compare the file identity; a shortcut is not a frozen copy.

Check Yourself

Explain one error you found, how you proved the correction, and which downstream result it could affect. A finished-looking file alone is not evidence that it is correct.

02

CHAPTER 2

Create, Review and Revise a Checked Brief

Your assignment: Produce a structured brief with traceable facts, a decision table, a review history and a checked PDF.

Target allocation: 65 minutes: 20 demonstration and discussion, 25 guided build, 15 independent challenge, 5 verification and repair. These are design allocations, not measured completion times. Finish the challenge and checks before moving on; finishing the guided clicks is not completion of the lab.

Status: core sections 2.1–2.3 executed and captured in a fresh private document: ten fact checks, eight section headings, decision table, verified links, two named versions, an accepted editorial suggestion, a rejected factual distortion, an open review thread and a three-page PDF inspected page by page. The independent challenge and classroom timings remain unvalidated.

What You Will Learn

- Ground an AI draft in supplied facts and independently audit it.
- Use paragraph styles, document navigation, tables and source links.
- Distinguish a comment, an editorial suggestion and an actual project approval.
- Preserve a baseline and inspect an exported copy.

Before You Begin

Use the workspace from Lab 1. Have project-facts.txt, checked-brief.txt and review-examples.txt available. If Gemini is unavailable, use checked-brief.txt for the draft and perform the same factual audit and revision tasks manually.

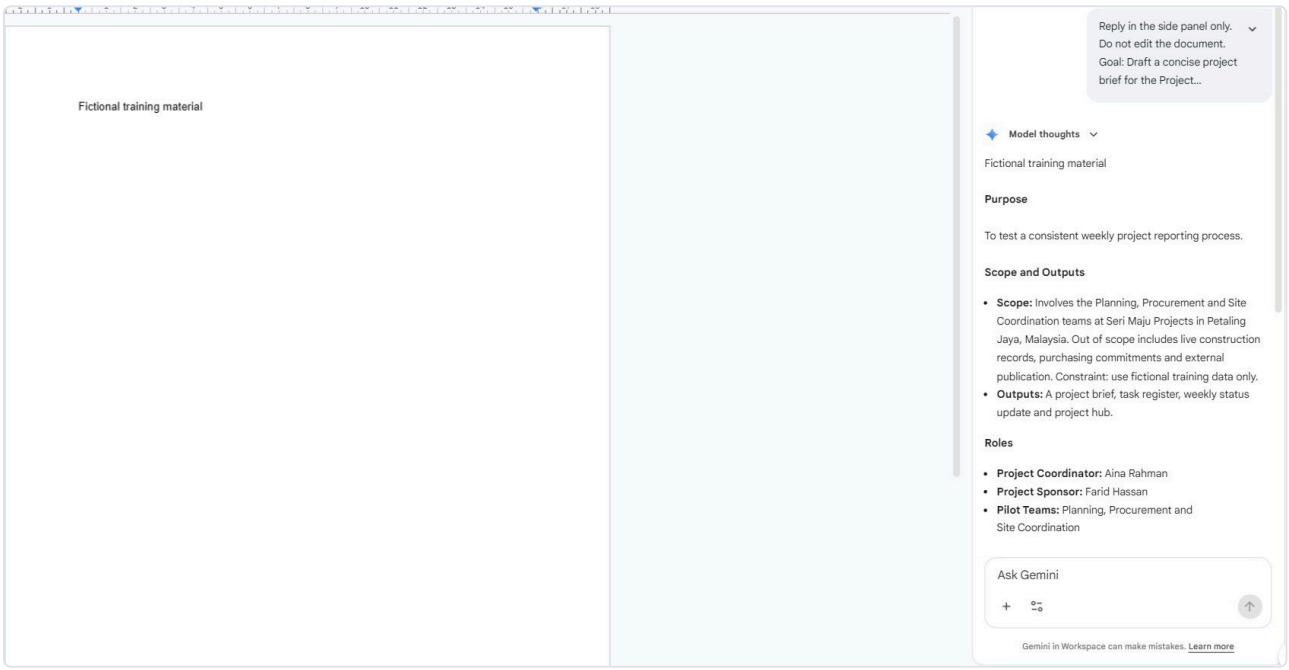
Use the copy-paste page and shared practice files. Keep fictional role names as text. Use only trainer-assigned test identities for any access test.

2.1 Draft and Audit the Facts

1. Create a Doc in **02 Working** named `GW - Project Reporting Pilot - Brief`. Add the fictional-material label.



2. If available, open **Ask Gemini** and use the panel-only prompt on the copy-paste page with the full fact sheet. If it proposes an in-place edit, inspect it before accepting. Reject any replacement of known facts with placeholders; use the recovery prompt.



3. Create a check table at the end of the document: Claim, Source wording and Verdict. Check duration, teams, coordinator, sponsor, budget condition, reporting cadence, risk and success measure.
4. Check the unresolved start date and budget approval separately. Use the AI audit prompt only as a second opinion; compare its answer with your own table.

Fictional training material

Fact Audit

Claim	Source wording	Verdict
Duration: four weeks	Pilot duration: four weeks from an agreed start date	Matches
Teams: Planning, Procurement and Site Coordination	Pilot teams: Planning, Procurement and Site Coordination	Matches
Coordinator: Aina Rahman	Project coordinator: Aina Rahman	Matches
Sponsor: Farid Hassan	Project sponsor: Farid Hassan	Matches
Budget ceiling: RM 12,000, proposed	Budget ceiling: RM 12000; Budget status: proposed, not approved	Matches; proposal retained
Reporting: every Friday	One status update every Friday during the pilot	Matches
Risk: inconsistent status definitions	Teams may use different definitions of task status	Matches
Success: all three teams on time in final two weeks	All three teams submit their weekly update on time for the final two weeks	Matches
Start date: To be confirmed	Start date: not yet agreed	Unresolved; no date invented
Budget approval: not approved	Budget status: proposed, not approved; sponsor approval unresolved	Unresolved; no approval asserted

5. Insert the checked brief. Remove unsupported benefits, suppliers or approvals. If no AI is available, copy the recovery brief and still complete all ten factual checks.

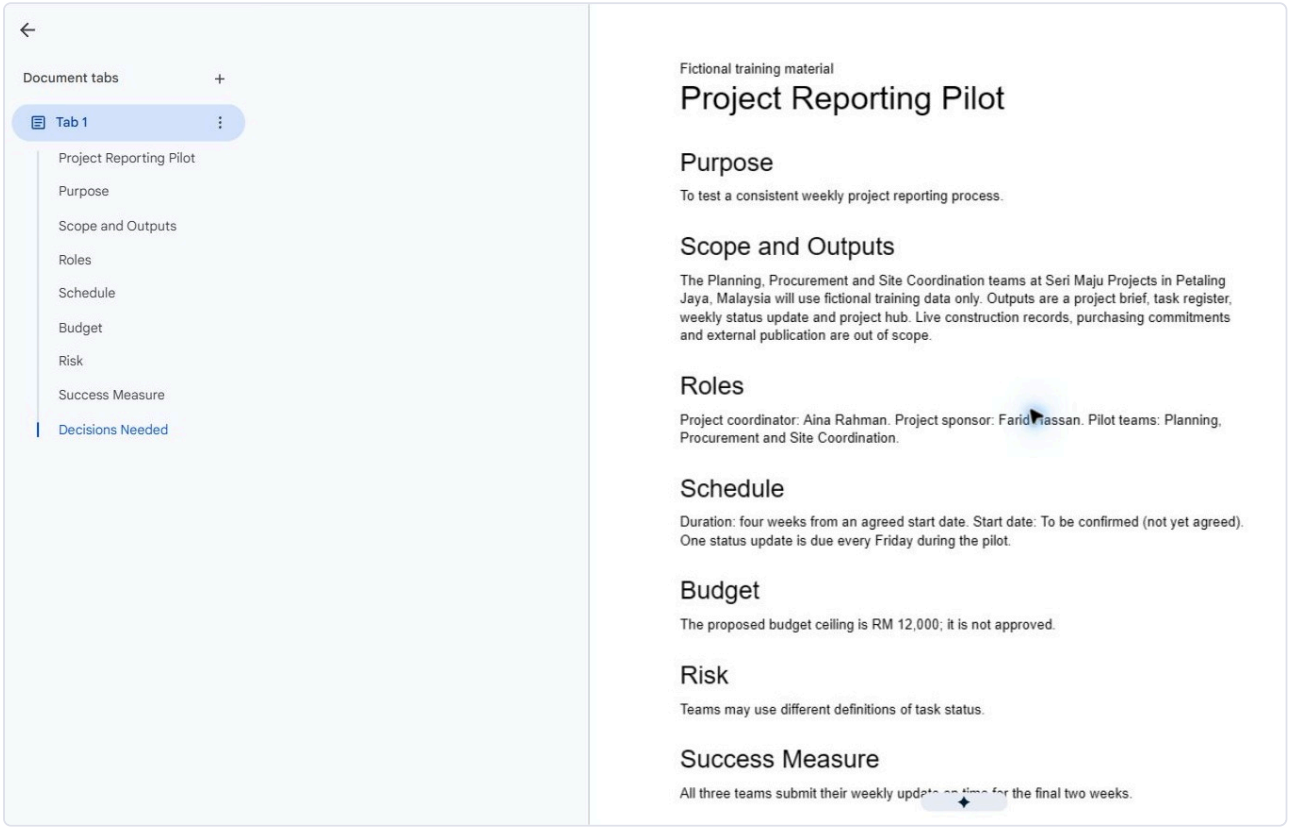
Fictional training material
Project Reporting Pilot
Purpose
To test a consistent weekly project reporting process.
Scope and Outputs
The Planning, Procurement and Site Coordination teams at Seri Maju Projects in Petaling Jaya, Malaysia will use fictional training data only. Outputs are a project brief, task register, weekly status update and project hub. Live construction records, purchasing commitments and external publication are out of scope.
Roles
Project coordinator: Aina Rahman. Project sponsor: Farid Hassan. Pilot teams: Planning, Procurement and Site Coordination.
Schedule
Duration: four weeks from an agreed start date. Start date: To be confirmed (not yet agreed). One status update is due every Friday during the pilot.
Budget
The proposed budget ceiling is RM 12,000; it is not approved.
Risk
Teams may use different definitions of task status.
Success Measure
All three teams submit their weekly update on time for the final two weeks.
Decisions Needed
Sponsor approval of the budget and the pilot start date remain unresolved.

What should you see?

The brief preserves the four-week duration and proposed RM 12,000 ceiling. It does not invent a start date, approval or benefit percentage. The audit records source evidence, not just “AI says correct”.

2.2 Build Navigation and Decision Structure

1. Apply **Title** to the project title and **Heading 1** to Purpose, Scope and Outputs, Roles, Schedule, Budget, Risk, Success Measure and Decisions Needed.
2. Open the document outline and navigate to Budget and Decisions Needed. Confirm these are real headings, not bold body text.



3. Under **Decisions Needed**, insert a four-column table: Decision, Decision-maker, Current state and Evidence required. Add the budget ceiling and start date as two unresolved decisions. The sponsor decides budget approval; mark the start-date decision-maker **To be confirmed** unless the source names one.

If the decision heading and table split across pages, insert a page break before **Decisions Needed**. Keep the completed audit on its own page.

If the decision heading and table split across pages, insert a page break before **Decisions Needed**. Keep the completed audit on its own page.

4. Add a source link to the fact sheet. Add a link or file chip for the native task register. Open each and verify its identity.

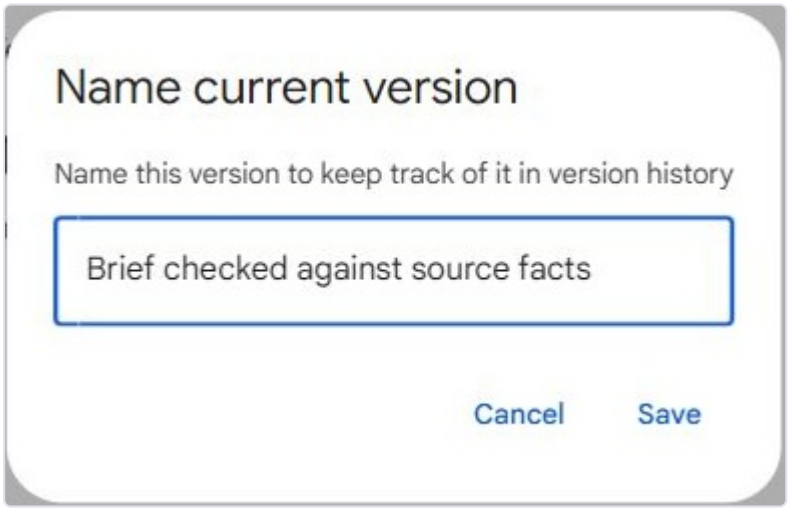


Decisions Needed

Sponsor approval of the budget and the pilot start date remain unresolved.
Sources: Project facts
Working register: Tasks and Summary

Decision	Decision-maker	Current state	Evidence required
Approve proposed RM 12,000 budget ceiling	Farid Hassan, sponsor	Proposed; not approved	Recorded sponsor approval
Agree pilot start date	To be confirmed	Not yet agreed	Recorded agreement on the start date

5. Use **File**, **Version history**, **Name current version** and name it `Brief checked against source facts`. This baseline precedes the independent editorial revision.

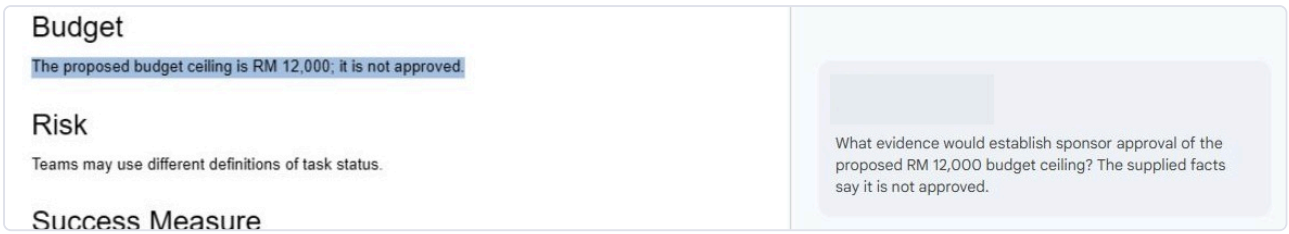


What should you see?

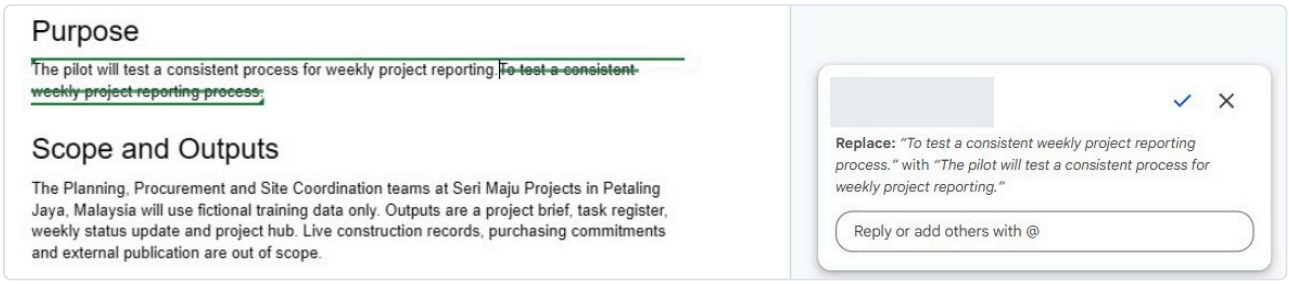
Eight main headings navigate correctly. The decision table keeps open items open. A file chip provides navigation, not an access grant.

2.3 Practise Review and Export

1. Select a sentence about the budget and add a comment asking what evidence would establish approval. Do not @mention or assign a fictional person.



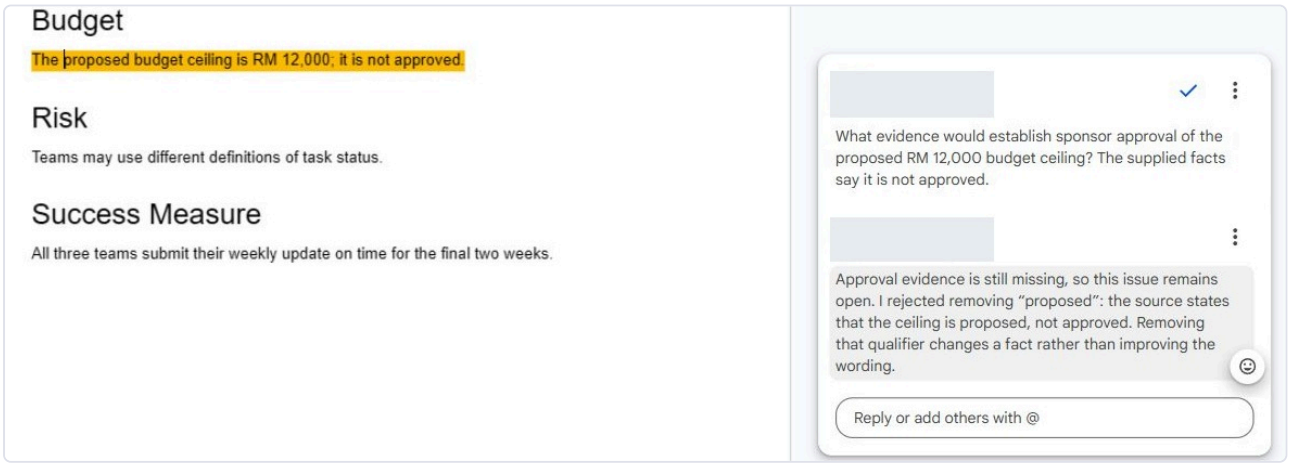
2. Switch from **Editing** to **Suggesting**. Propose a clearer purpose sentence without changing facts. Inspect the suggestion, then accept it only if the meaning is preserved.

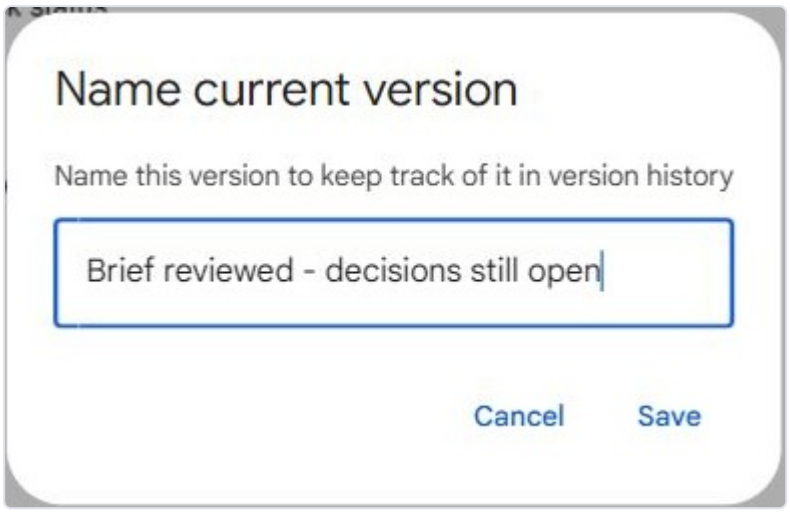


3. Add a second suggestion that incorrectly removes the word **proposed** from the budget. Reject it and explain why this is a factual change rather than an editorial improvement.

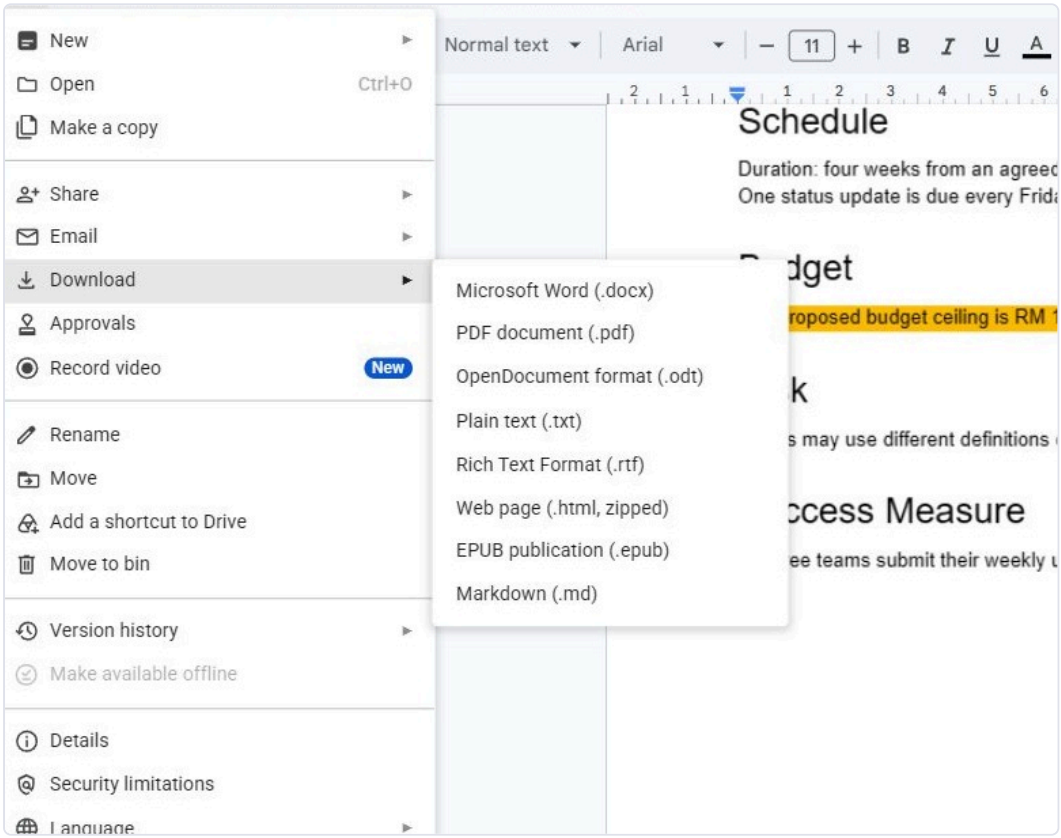


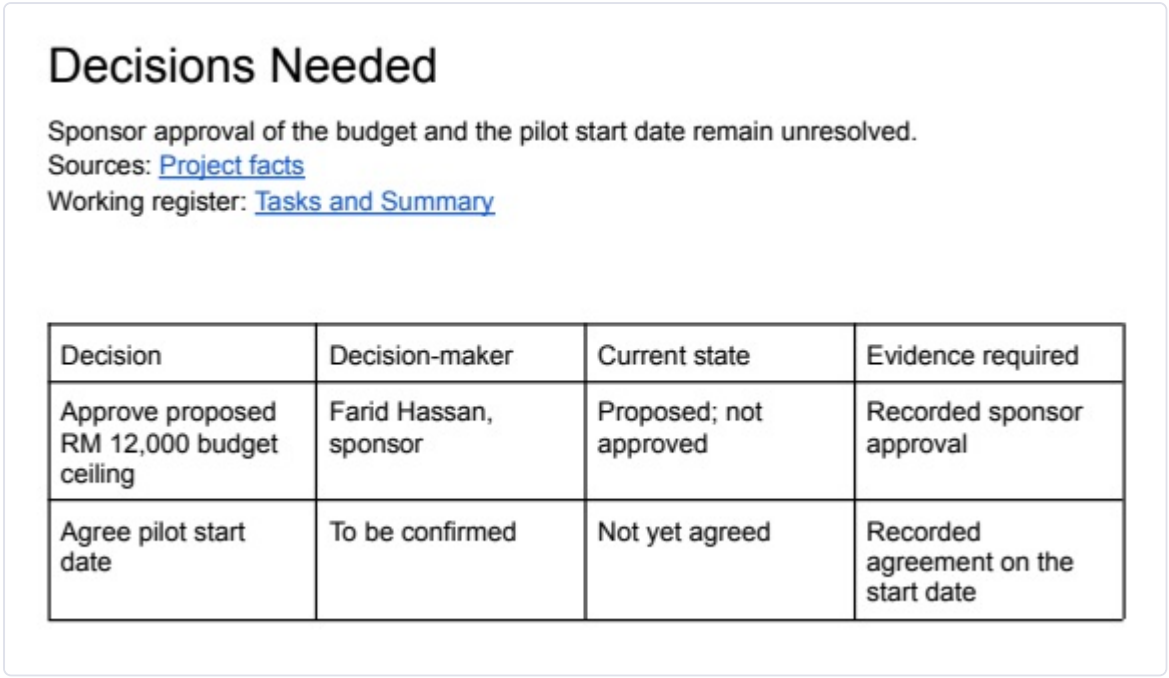
4. Reply to the budget comment that approval evidence is still missing. Leave that issue open. Name a new version `Brief reviewed - decisions still open`.





5. Choose **File**, **Download**, **PDF Document**. Open the exported PDF and inspect every page, table break and heading. Compare its budget wording with the native document.





Decisions Needed

Sponsor approval of the budget and the pilot start date remain unresolved.
Sources: Project facts
Working register: Tasks and Summary

Decision	Decision-maker	Current state	Evidence required
Approve proposed RM 12,000 budget ceiling	Farid Hassan, sponsor	Proposed; not approved	Recorded sponsor approval
Agree pilot start date	To be confirmed	Not yet agreed	Recorded agreement on the start date

6. Record which file is maintained and which is a snapshot. After a later revision, the PDF must be regenerated; it does not track the native document.

What should you see?

There is a demonstrable accepted suggestion, a rejected factual distortion and an unresolved comment. The PDF is readable and retains the source caveats.

Independent Challenge

Read review-examples.txt. Create a **Review Response** section identifying each unsupported claim, its correction and the missing evidence. Independently write an 80 to 100 word sponsor update that preserves the proposed budget and unresolved start date. Give a partner the source and your update to audit, or perform a second-pass audit if working alone. Correct one issue or document why no correction was needed, then name the revised version. Do not treat completion of this exercise as sponsor approval.

Evidence to Hand Over

- Native brief with eight main headings, source links and a decision table.
- Ten factual checks, review response and independently written sponsor update.
- Version names, visible review evidence and inspected PDF.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Repair to investigate
Gemini removes known facts	Reject the proposal and use the explicit panel-only recovery request.
Headings do not appear in the outline	Apply named paragraph styles to entire heading paragraphs.
The PDF differs from the working file	Re-export after changes and inspect the new copy.

Check Yourself

Explain one error you found, how you proved the correction, and which downstream result it could affect. A finished-looking file alone is not evidence that it is correct.

Prompts and values

Use these values in the reference chapter. Copy the project facts from the supplied text file. The prompts work on fictional material only.

Part 1: Name the Document

```
GW - Project Reporting Pilot - Brief
```

Part 2: Draft from Supplied Facts

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** pasted project fact sheet, no web research

```
Reply in the side panel only. Do not edit the document.
Goal: Draft a concise project brief for the Project Reporting Pilot.
Context: I am the project coordinator at the fictional Seri Maju Projects in Petaling Jaya.
This is fictional training material.
Source: Use only the FACTS pasted below. Do not search my other files or email, and do not use
the web.
Expectations: Use British English and these headings: Purpose, Scope and Outputs, Roles,
Schedule, Budget, Risk, Success Measure, Decisions Needed. Keep the brief below 350 words.
Preserve all numbers and approval conditions. If a fact is missing, write "To be confirmed".
Do not invent a start date, approval, benefit percentage or supplier. Label the document
"Fictional training material".

FACTS:
[paste the full project fact sheet here]
```

Replace `[paste the full project fact sheet here]` with the full contents of the supplied file before submitting.

Part 3: Check the Draft

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** original fact sheet and draft

```
Compare your draft with the original FACTS. List any claim that is unsupported, changes a
number, or turns a proposed item into an approved item. For each claim give the source fact
and a correction. If none are found, say that none were found. Do not rewrite or edit the
document yet.
```

Check the result yourself against the fact sheet. An AI self-check can miss an error.

Part 4: Rewrite for the Sponsor

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** checked brief and original facts

```
Write an 80 to 100 word update for the project sponsor using only the checked brief and
original FACTS. Explain the purpose, proposed budget ceiling, success measure and decisions
still needed. Keep approval and the start date unresolved. Do not send the update or create a
calendar event.
```

Part 5: Name the Checked Version

```
Brief checked against source facts
```

Recovery Prompt

Session: same chat | **Grounding:** facts embedded below

This exact request produced the successful panel response during the live test. Check the result again; AI wording can vary.

```
Reply in the side panel only. Do not edit the document. Draft the brief using the following
facts in this message, not other files. Organisation: fictional Seri Maju Projects, Petaling
Jaya. Project: Project Reporting Pilot. Purpose: test a consistent weekly project reporting
process. Coordinator: Aina Rahman. Sponsor: Farid Hassan. Teams: Planning, Procurement and
Site Coordination. Duration: four weeks. Start date: not agreed. Proposed budget ceiling: RM
12,000; NOT approved. Outputs: project brief, task register, weekly status update, project
hub. Cadence: every Friday during the pilot. Risk: inconsistent definitions of task status.
Success: all three teams submit on time for the final two weeks. Decisions needed: sponsor
approval of the budget and start date. Only fictional training data; no live construction
records, purchasing commitments or external publication. Use British English, fewer than 350
words, label Fictional training material, and headings Purpose, Scope and Outputs, Roles,
Schedule, Budget, Risk, Success Measure, Decisions Needed. Include the known facts; only mark
the missing start date To be confirmed. Do not replace supplied facts with placeholders.
```

Review Table

```
Claim | Source wording | Verdict
Decision | Decision-maker | Current state | Evidence required
```

03

CHAPTER 3

Turn a Meeting Record into Accountable Actions

Your assignment: Prepare an unsent kick-off message, a private practice event and a checked action register with a follow-up process.

Target allocation: 55 minutes: 17 demonstration and discussion, 18 guided build, 15 independent challenge, 5 verification and repair. These are design allocations, not measured completion times. Finish the challenge and checks before moving on; finishing the guided clicks is not completion of the lab.

Status: the unsent Gmail draft was saved and reopened with recipients empty. The meeting record contains three manually checked actions, an unsent follow-up and a named baseline. Calendar uses the documented event-specification fallback because no practice slot was assigned; no actual event, time-zone UI test or invitation is claimed. Independent challenge and learner timing remain unvalidated.

What You Will Learn

- Translate a brief into an agenda and decision-focused message.
- Handle Calendar time zones and scheduling without implying an agreed pilot date.
- Extract owners and relative deadlines while distinguishing actions from decisions.
- Maintain action status and an escalation note without inventing commitments.

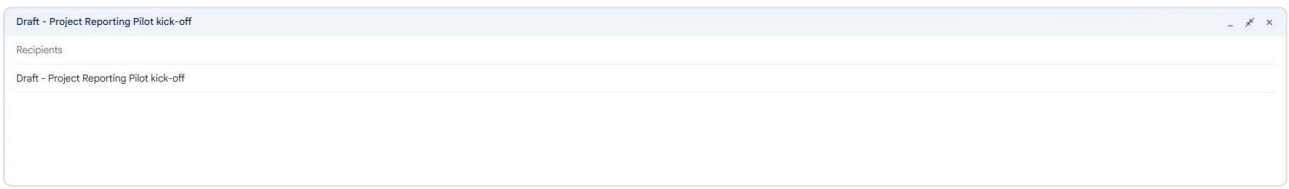
Before You Begin

Use the checked brief and meeting-record.txt. You need Gmail, Calendar and Docs. Use a trainer-assigned future practice slot for the Calendar test; this is not the pilot start date. If Calendar is unavailable, build and label an event specification in the meeting Doc instead.

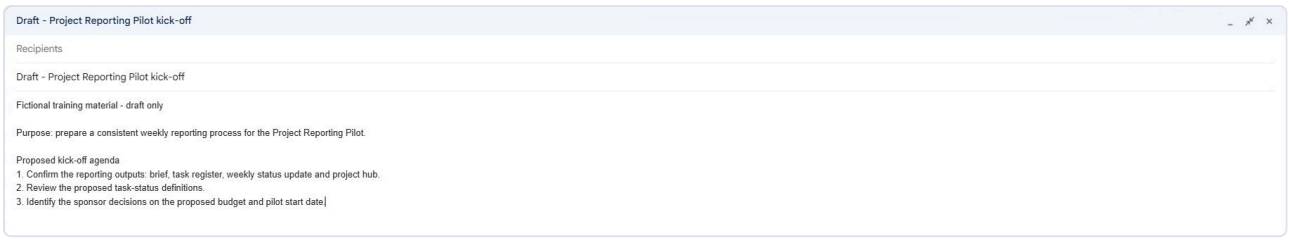
Use the copy-paste page and shared practice files. Keep fictional role names as text. Use only trainer-assigned test identities for any access test.

3.1 Prepare the Communication

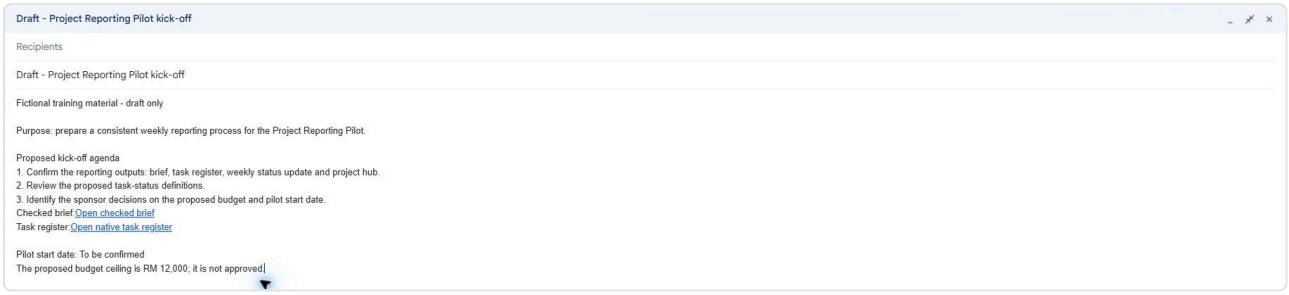
1. In Gmail choose **Compose**, leave recipients blank and use subject `Draft - Project Reporting Pilot kick-off`.



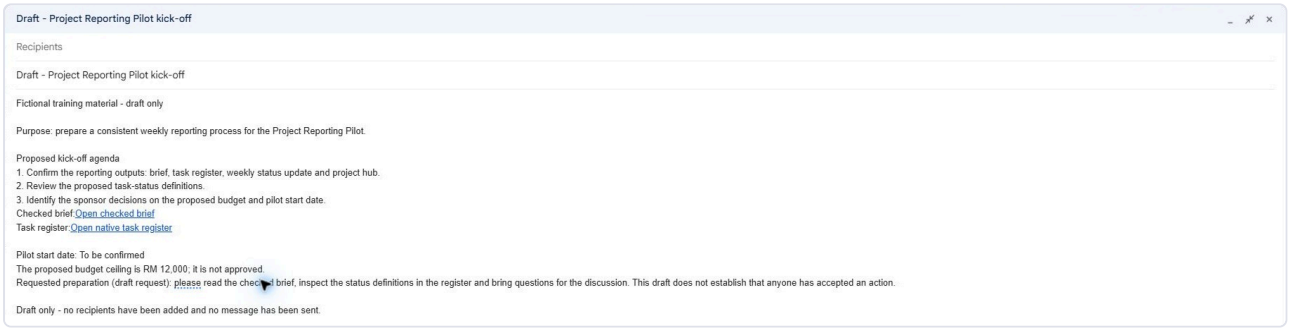
2. Write the purpose and a three-part agenda: confirm reporting outputs, review proposed status definitions and identify sponsor decisions.



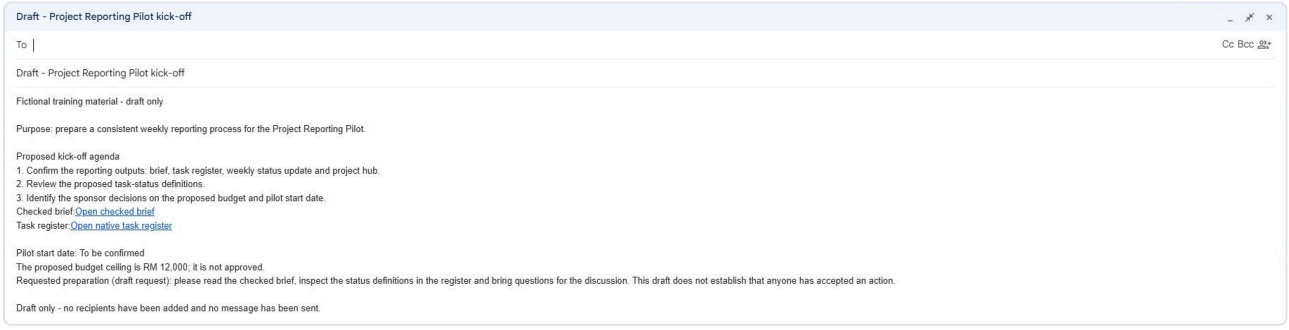
3. Include links to the checked brief and tracker. Write **Pilot start date: To be confirmed** and preserve the proposed budget wording.



4. Add a requested preparation paragraph: read the brief, inspect the status definitions and bring questions. Treat this as a draft request, not proof that someone accepted an action.



5. Close the compose window, reopen the saved draft and check subject, links and unresolved decisions. Keep recipients empty and leave it unsent.

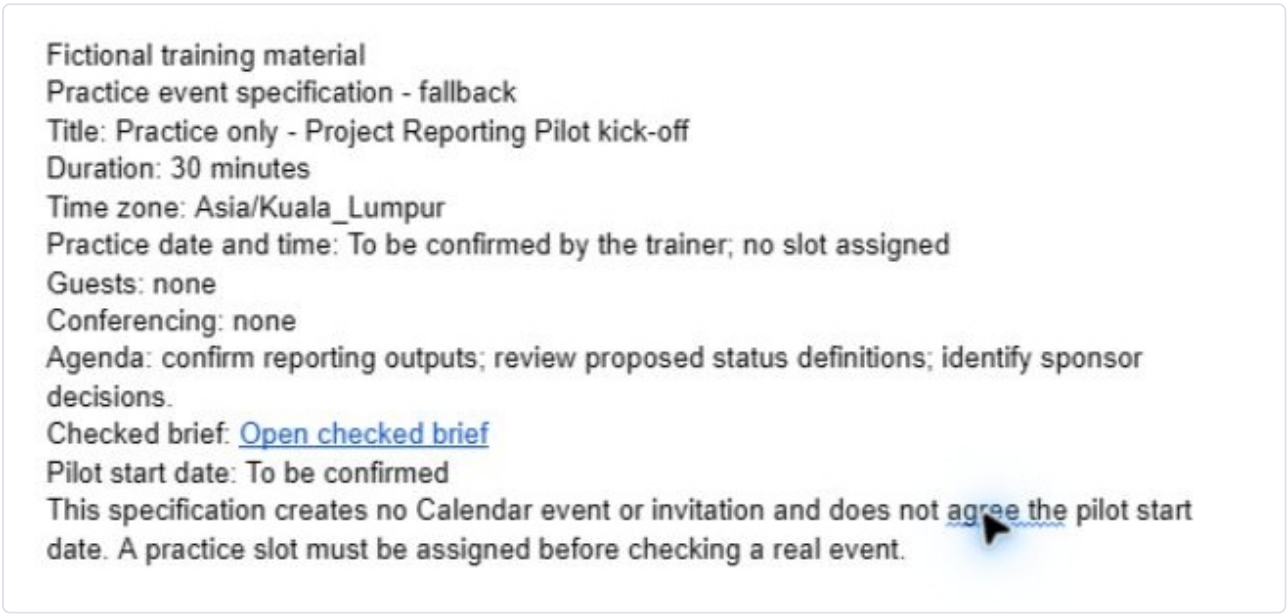


What should you see?

The saved draft contains a purpose, agenda, preparation request and useful links. It does not turn a proposed date or budget into a commitment.

3.2 Prepare a Private Calendar Test

1. In Calendar choose **Create**, then **Event**. Title it `Practice only - Project Reporting Pilot kick-off`.
2. Use the assigned 30-minute practice slot. Check the event time zone against **Asia/Kuala_Lumpur**, and inspect whether the displayed start and end match the intended local time.
3. Leave guests empty. Remove automatically added conferencing if it is not needed for this private test. Add the agenda and brief link in the description, labelled as fictional practice.
4. Save the private event, reopen it and compare its title, duration, local time, guest list and description with your draft. If the class has no assigned slot, keep an event specification in the Doc instead of choosing a real project date.
5. Record why scheduling this private practice item does not agree the pilot start date. After the lab, delete only your own practice event if it is no longer needed.


Fictional training material
Practice event specification - fallback
Title: Practice only - Project Reporting Pilot kick-off
Duration: 30 minutes
Time zone: Asia/Kuala_Lumpur
Practice date and time: To be confirmed by the trainer; no slot assigned
Guests: none
Conferencing: none
Agenda: confirm reporting outputs; review proposed status definitions; identify sponsor decisions.
Checked brief: Open checked brief
Pilot start date: To be confirmed
This specification creates no Calendar event or invitation and does not agree the pilot start date. A practice slot must be assigned before checking a real event.

What should you see?

A private practice event, or clearly labelled fallback specification, has the correct duration and time zone. No guest has been invited.

3.3 Create and Verify the Action Register

1. Create `GW - Pilot Meeting Record` in **02 Working**. Add headings Agenda, Discussion, Decisions Needed and Actions. Insert the supplied scripted record under Discussion and link to the brief.

Keep **Actions** and its table together; insert a page break before the heading if needed.

2. Under Actions insert a table: ActionID, Action, Owner, Due practice week, Status and Evidence. Manually extract the three preparation commitments, or use the supplied extraction prompt then audit each row.
3. Compare every owner and due week against the source. Distinguish these three preparation commitments from the separate 12-row task dataset. Do not merge them by matching names.

4. Set action status to **Not started - practice assumption** and evidence to **No completion evidence supplied**. Keep budget approval and start-date agreement in Decisions Needed, not in the completed-action list.

Actions

ActionID	Action	Owner	Due practice week	Status	Evidence
A01	Prepare a draft reporting template	Aina Rahman	1	Not started - practice assumption	No completion evidence supplied
A02	Review the status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	Not started - practice assumption	No completion evidence supplied
A03	Collect a fictional sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not started - practice assumption	No completion evidence supplied

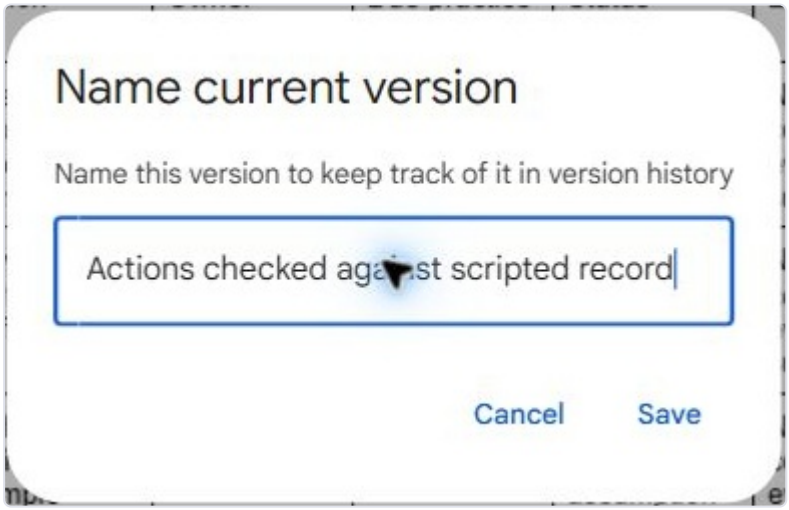
5. Add a draft follow-up paragraph for any action with no completion evidence. A reminder is proposed communication, not a new due date or a sent message.

Actions

ActionID	Action	Owner	Due practice week	Status	Evidence
A01	Prepare a draft reporting template	Aina Rahman	1	Not started - practice assumption	No completion evidence supplied
A02	Review the status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	Not started - practice assumption	No completion evidence supplied
A03	Collect a fictional sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not started - practice assumption	No completion evidence supplied

Source check: exactly three preparation commitments, with due practice weeks 1, 1 and 2. These are separate from the twelve-row task dataset. Names alone are not a basis for merging the records.
Draft follow-up - not sent
Please provide the completion evidence for the draft reporting template, status-definition review and fictional sample update. Their source due practice weeks remain 1, 1 and 2. This proposed reminder creates no new deadline, assignment or completed status.
A meeting-notes template and AI extraction produce document content; they do not create or synchronise assigned Google Tasks automatically. No Tasks assignment was created.

6. Name a version `Actions checked against scripted record`. Explain why a meeting-notes template and an AI extraction do not create or synchronise assigned Tasks automatically.



What should you see?

Exactly three source commitments have traceable owners and due weeks. Unknown completion status is labelled as a practice assumption, and both project decisions remain unresolved.

Independent Challenge

Use the Lab 3 change card in masterclass-challenges.txt. A later message says that Bala's review is delayed, but provides no replacement week. Update the action record without inventing a deadline. Prepare an unsent escalation paragraph for the coordinator and add a proposed decision-focused agenda for the next review. Demonstrate which source changed, which status is your assumption and which items still need confirmation. Recheck the private event for an accidental guest or changed time zone.

Evidence to Hand Over

- Reopened unsent Gmail draft and a checked private event or fallback specification.
- Meeting record with three traceable actions and two unresolved project decisions.
- Delay-handling revision, escalation paragraph and clear separation of source facts and assumptions.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Repair to investigate
Calendar fills an unexpected time	Check the event time zone and the assigned practice slot before saving.
AI supplies a new deadline	Remove it unless the change card supplies one; retain **To be confirmed**.
Action extraction seems to assign Tasks	Inspect the actual destination; extracted text is not an assigned task.

Check Yourself

Explain one error you found, how you proved the correction, and which downstream result it could affect. A finished-looking file alone is not evidence that it is correct.

Prompts and values

Extraction Prompt

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** pasted scripted record only

```
Reply in the side panel only. Do not edit files, send messages or create tasks. Extract only
explicit commitments from the RECORD below into Action, Owner and Due practice week.
Separately list unresolved decisions. Do not infer completion, invent dates or treat the
budget proposal as approval. Use British English.
RECORD:
[paste meeting-record.txt in full]
```

Table Headings

```
ActionID | Action | Owner | Due practice week | Status | Evidence
```

Practice Event

```
Practice only - Project Reporting Pilot kick-off
Duration: 30 minutes
Time zone: Asia/Kuala_Lumpur
Guests: none
Pilot start date: To be confirmed
```

Use the assigned practice slot, not a guessed project start date.

04

CHAPTER 4

Clean, Calculate and Stress-Test a Reporting Dashboard

Your assignment: Build a validated tracker, cost calculations, two summaries and a linked chart that survives a new-record test.

Target allocation: 80 minutes: 24 demonstration and discussion, 30 guided build, 20 independent challenge, 6 verification and repair. These are design allocations, not measured completion times. Finish the challenge and checks before moving on; finishing the guided clicks is not completion of the lab.

Status: core sections 4.1–4.3 executed and captured with the twelve-task baseline: preserved intake strings, rejecting validation, relative row formulas, reconciled counts and costs, two charts, a saved filter view and a changed/restored linked-chart test. The new-record card and conditional-formatting test were also executed as a scripted reference run, preserving each before/after stage. T013 is retained for the next lab. This does not establish independent learner performance or classroom timings; the optional pivot-table extension remains untested.

What You Will Learn

- Audit text categories and apply validation.
- Use relative references, COUNTIF and SUMIF for a live summary.
- Distinguish task costs, variance and an unapproved budget ceiling.
- Investigate range failures and verify a linked chart after changing records.

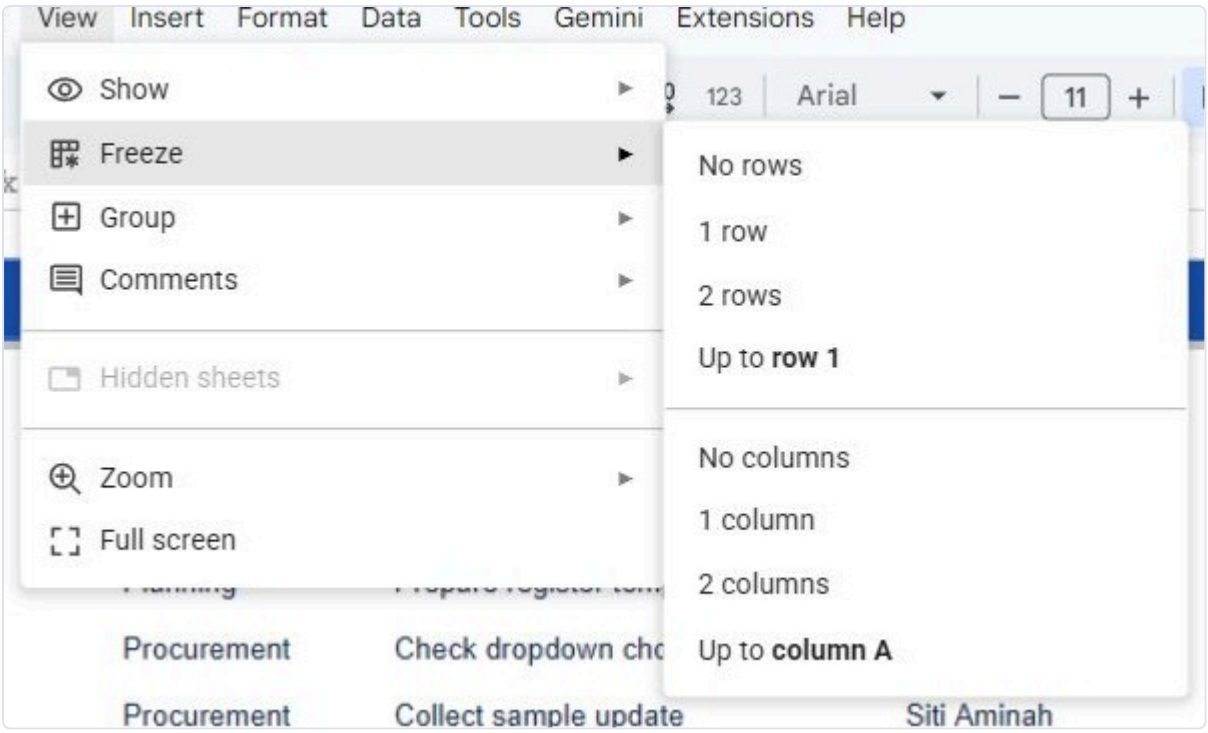
Before You Begin

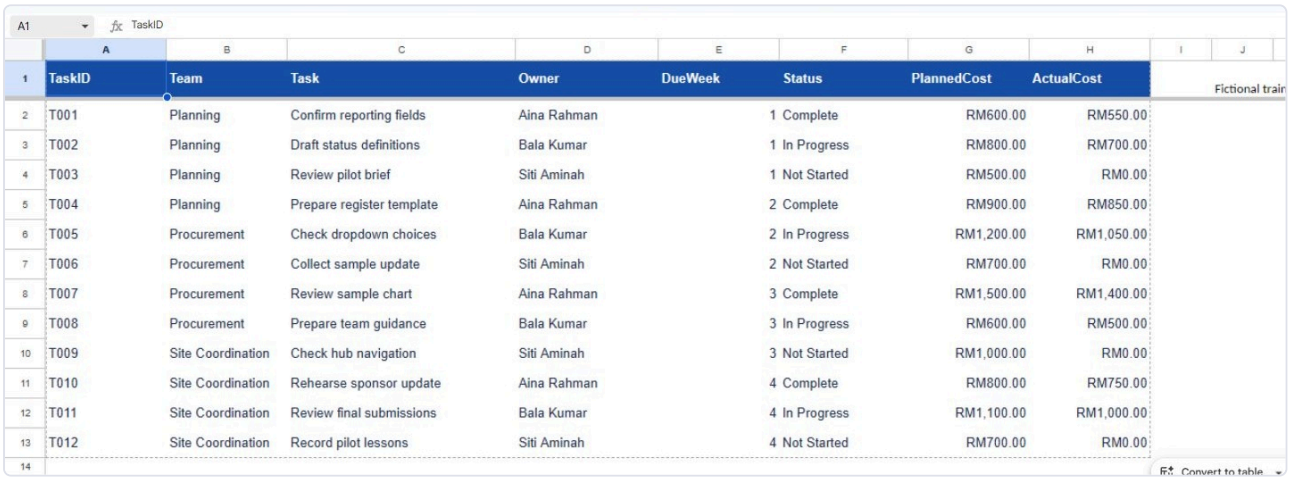
Use your native tracker from Lab 1, or convert a fresh TaskRegister.xlsx. Use commas in formulas; use semicolons for argument separators if required by your locale. You need the checked brief as a linked-chart destination.

Use the copy-paste page and shared practice files. Keep fictional role names as text. Use only trainer-assigned test identities for any access test.

4.1 Audit and Validate the Input

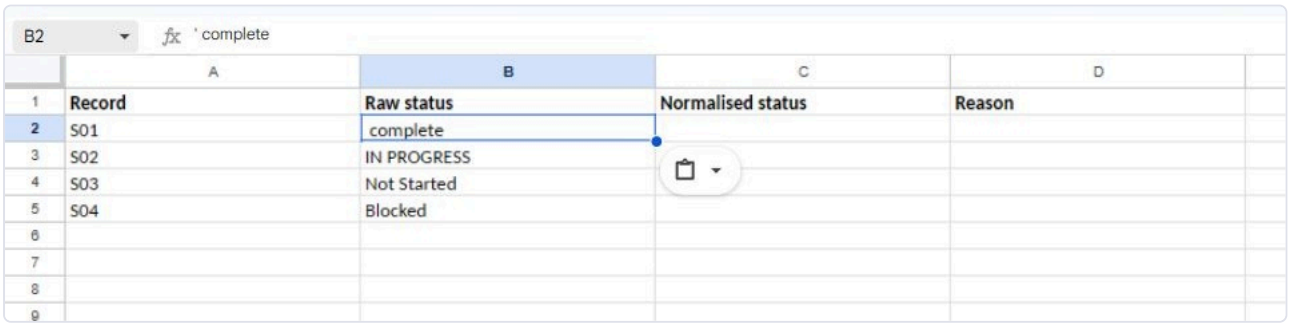
1. In **Tasks** inspect A1:H13. Freeze row 1 using **View**, **Freeze**, **1 row**. Format G:H as currency with a clearly identified RM unit.





TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost
T001	Planning	Confirm reporting fields	Aina Rahman	1	Complete	RM600.00	RM550.00
T002	Planning	Draft status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	In Progress	RM800.00	RM700.00
T003	Planning	Review pilot brief	Siti Aminah	1	Not Started	RM500.00	RM0.00
T004	Planning	Prepare register template	Aina Rahman	2	Complete	RM900.00	RM850.00
T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM1,200.00	RM1,050.00
T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00
T007	Procurement	Review sample chart	Aina Rahman	3	Complete	RM1,500.00	RM1,400.00
T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM600.00	RM500.00
T009	Site Coordination	Check hub navigation	Siti Aminah	3	Not Started	RM1,000.00	RM0.00
T010	Site Coordination	Rehearse sponsor update	Aina Rahman	4	Complete	RM800.00	RM750.00
T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00
T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00

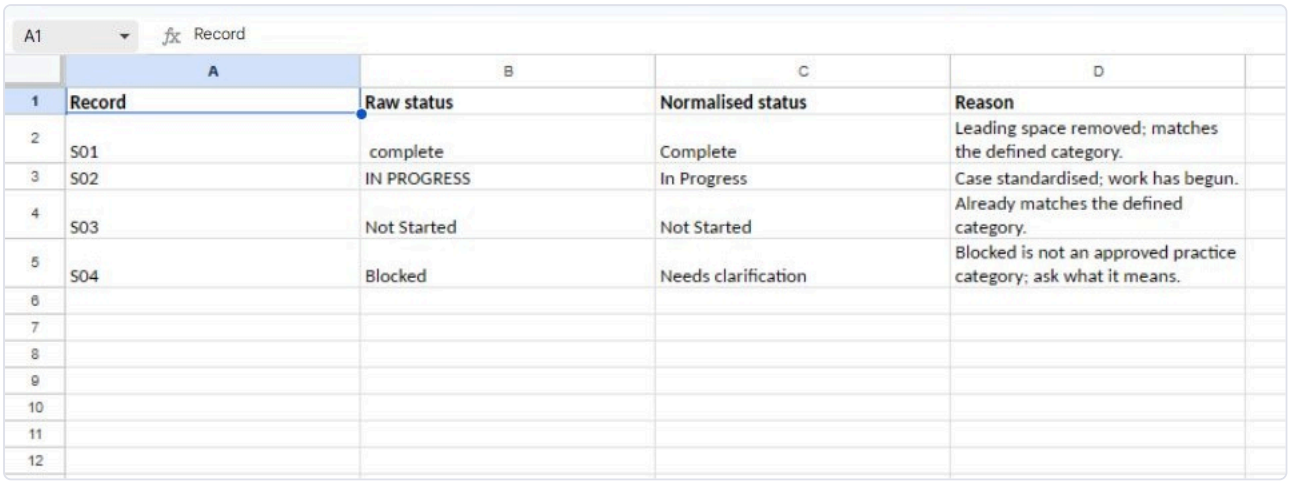
2. Create a tab named **Status Intake**. Paste the four dirty records from masterclass-challenges.txt. Preserve the raw status in column B; add Normalised status in C and Reason in D.



Record	Raw status	Normalised status	Reason
S01	complete		
S02	IN PROGRESS		
S03	Not Started		
S04	Blocked		

If pasting trims S01's leading space, enter it as literal text with a leading apostrophe: `' complete`. Verify that the stored value still begins with a space. Keep this raw value unchanged when recording its correction in column C.

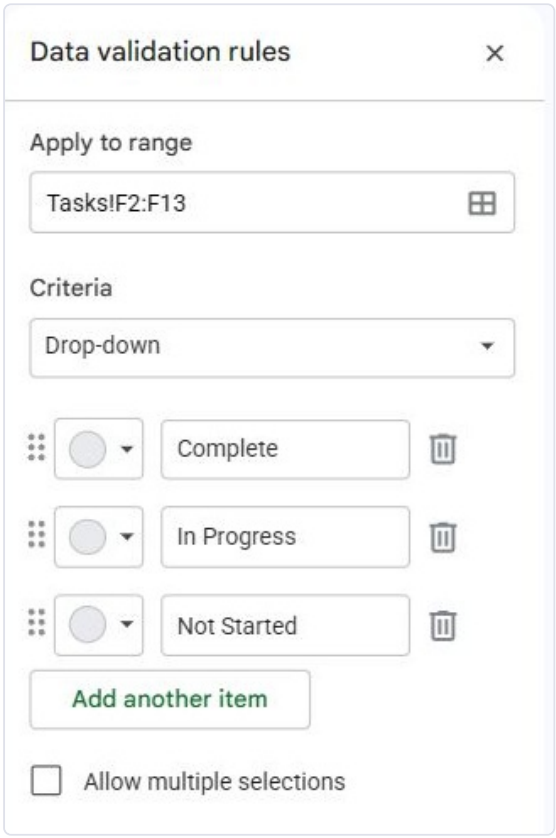
3. Compare each raw entry with the definitions in reporting-guidance.txt. Remove unnecessary spaces and standardise case only when the intended category is clear. Leave **Blocked** as **Needs clarification** rather than silently treating it as complete.

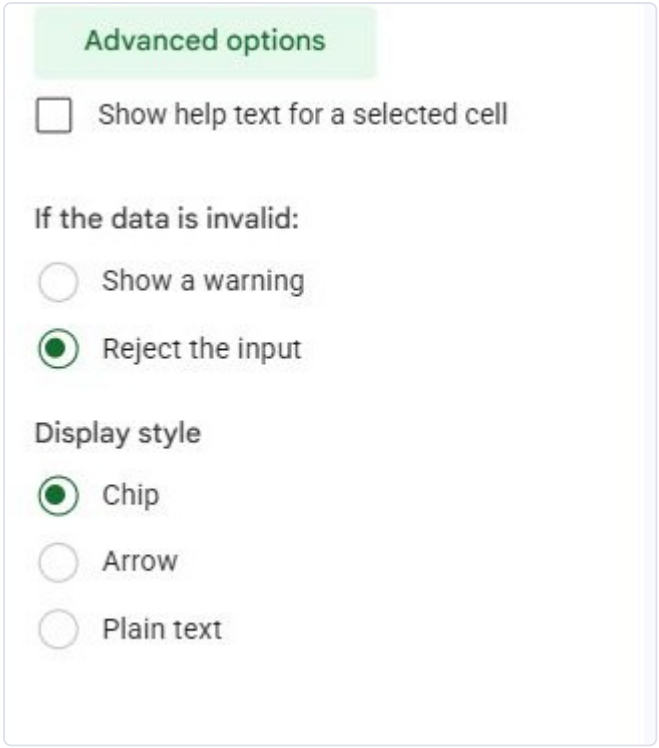


A1 | Record

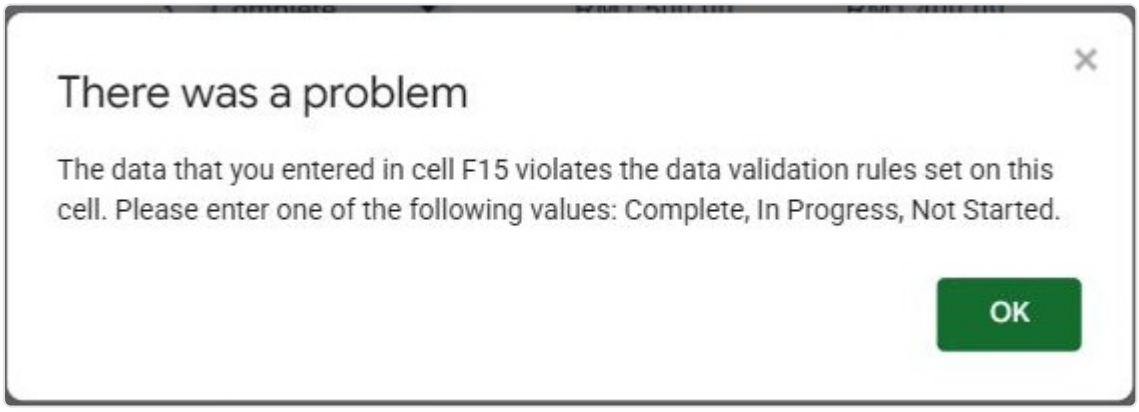
	A	B	C	D
1	**Record**	**Raw status**	**Normalised status**	**Reason**
2	S01	complete	Complete	Leading space removed; matches the defined category.
3	S02	IN PROGRESS	In Progress	Case standardised; work has begun.
4	S03	Not Started	Not Started	Already matches the defined category.
5	S04	Blocked	Needs clarification	Blocked is not an approved practice category; ask what it means.
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				

4. On **Tasks** select F2:F13. Choose **Data**, **Data validation** and add a dropdown for Complete, In Progress and Not Started. Select the setting that rejects invalid input.





5. Test an invalid entry on a spare cell with the copied validation rule. Undo or clear the test. Recheck that all 12 original task statuses are unchanged.



6. Add **Variance** in I1. In I2 enter `=H2-G2` and fill to I13. Inspect I3 to prove that both row references moved. Add a note that negative values mean actual costs are below planned costs, not proof of a realised saving.



TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost	Variance
T001	Planning	Confirm reporting fields	Aina Rahman	1	Complete	RM600.00	RM550.00	-RM50.00
T002	Planning	Draft status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	In Progress	RM800.00	RM700.00	-RM100.00
T003	Planning	Review pilot brief	Siti Aminah	1	Not Started	RM500.00	RM0.00	-RM500.00
T004	Planning	Prepare register template	Aina Rahman	2	Complete	RM900.00	RM850.00	-RM50.00
T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM1,200.00	RM1,050.00	-RM150.00
T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00
T007	Procurement	Review sample chart	Aina Rahman	3	Complete	RM1,500.00	RM1,400.00	-RM100.00
T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM600.00	RM500.00	-RM100.00
T009	Site Coordination	Check hub navigation	Siti Aminah	3	Not Started	RM1,000.00	RM0.00	-RM1,000.00
T010	Site Coordination	Rehearse sponsor update	Aina Rahman	4	Complete	RM800.00	RM750.00	-RM50.00
T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00	-RM100.00
T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00

Fictional training data

Convert to table

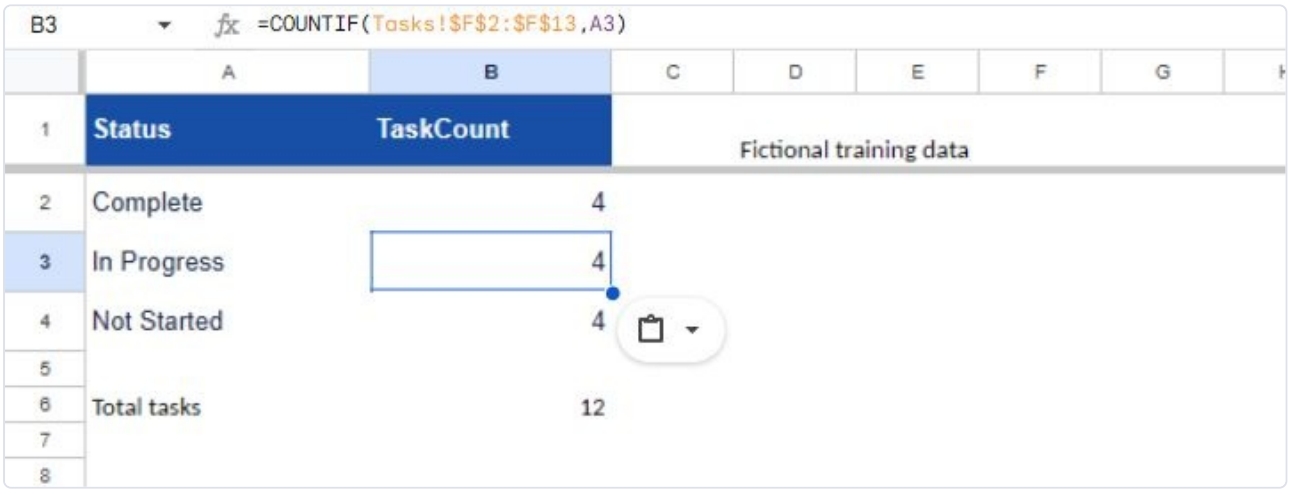
Negative variance means actual cost is below plan; it is not proof of a realised saving.

What should you see?

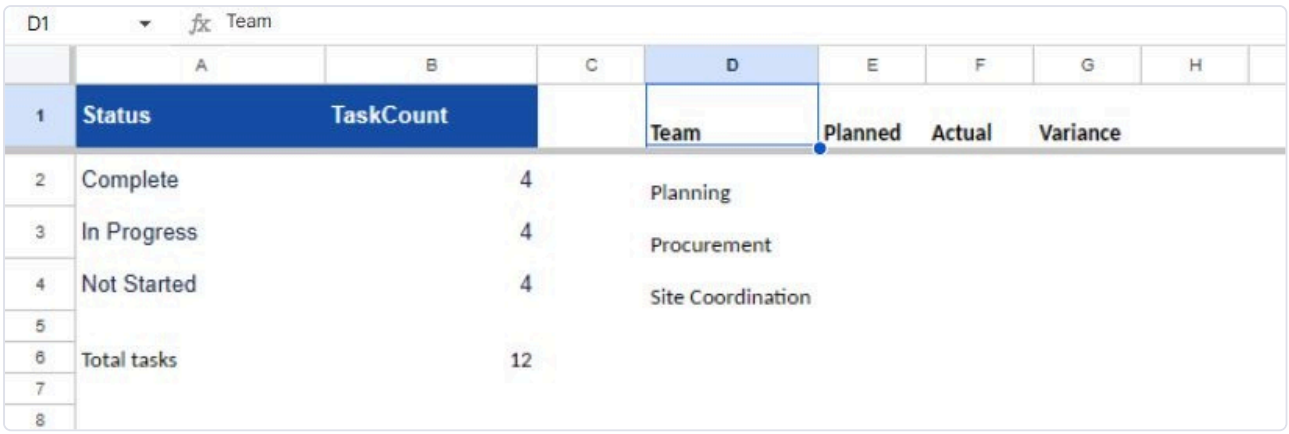
Twelve source tasks remain intact, each variance calculates from its own row, and the intake audit explains why an ambiguous category needs clarification.

4.2 Build Two Summaries

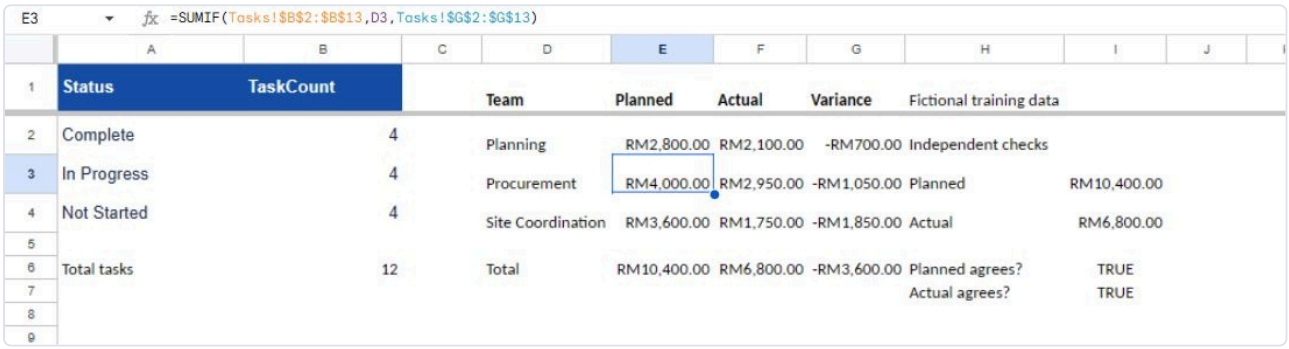
1. On **Summary** use the existing status labels in A2:A4. In B2 enter `=COUNTIF(Tasks!$F$2:$F$13,A2)` and fill to B4. Add **Total tasks** in A6 and `=SUM(B2:B4)` in B6.



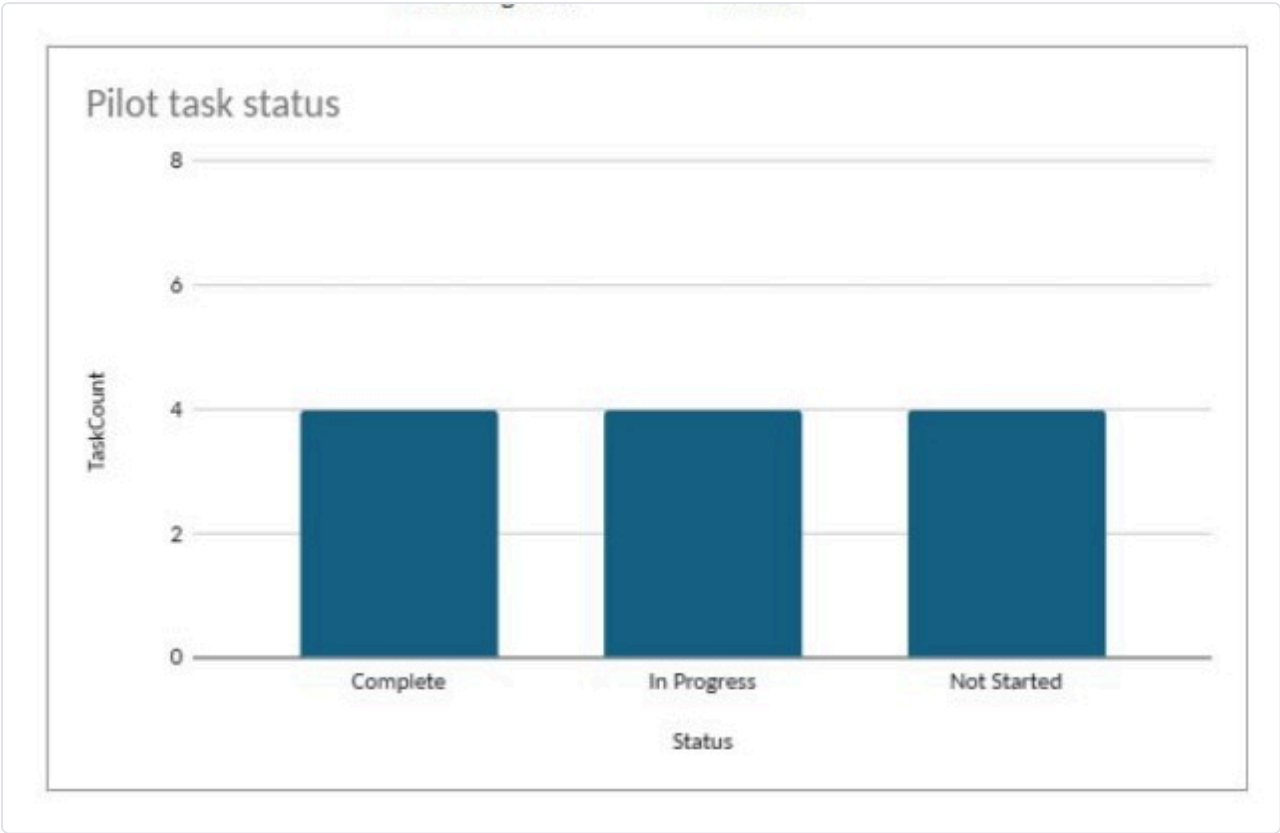
2. In D1:G1 enter Team, Planned, Actual and Variance. In D2:D4 enter Planning, Procurement and Site Coordination.



3. In E2 enter `=SUMIF(Tasks!$B$2:$B$13,D2,Tasks!$G$2:$G$13)`. In F2 enter `=SUMIF(Tasks!$B$2:$B$13,D2,Tasks!$H$2:$H$13)`. In G2 enter `=F2-E2`. Fill E2:G2 down to row 4.
4. Add totals in E6:G6 using SUM. Independently total Tasks G2:G13 and H2:H13 in spare check cells and compare them with the team totals.



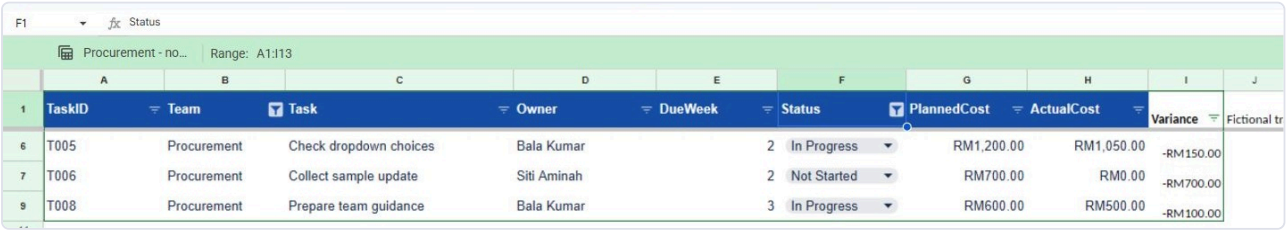
5. Select A1:B4 and choose **Insert**, **Chart**. Use a column chart titled `Pilot task status`. Build a second chart from D1:F4 to compare planned and actual costs by team.





Current UI: choose **Data**, **Create filter view**, then **Save view** to name it. With a header selected, **Ctrl+Alt+R** opens its filter menu.

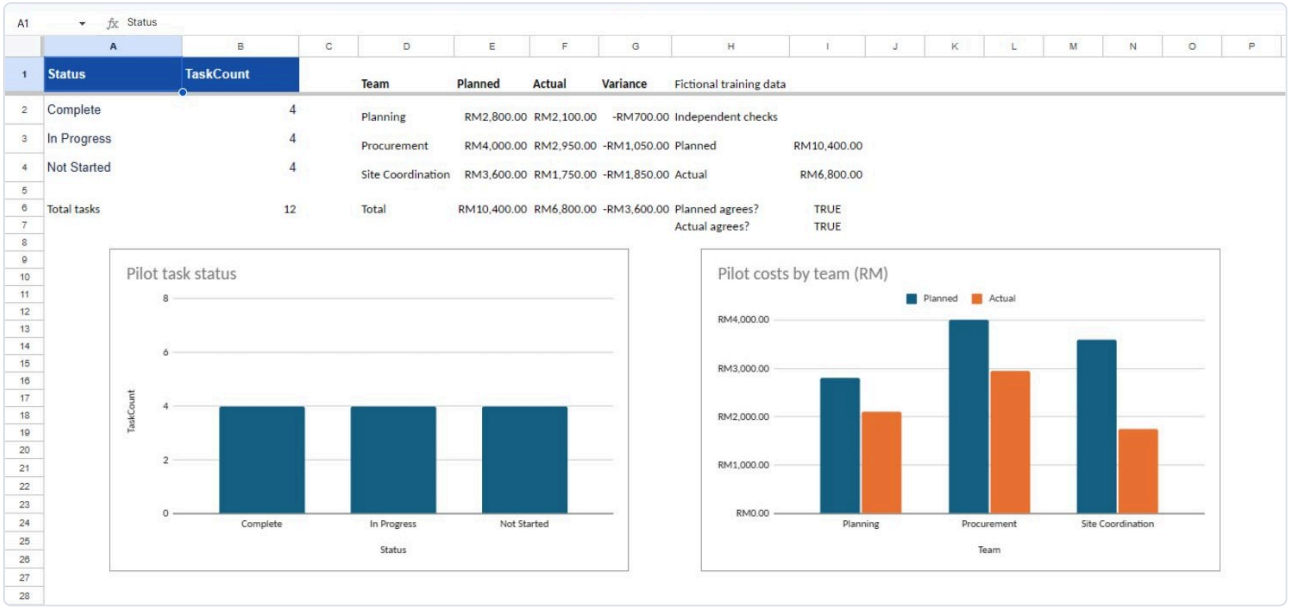
6. Create a named **Filter view** through **Data** for the Procurement rows with status other than Complete. Close the view and confirm all 12 source records are still present. Filtering must not delete records.



	TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost	Variance	Fictional tr
6	T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM1,200.00	RM1,050.00	-RM150.00	
7	T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
9	T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM600.00	RM500.00	-RM100.00	

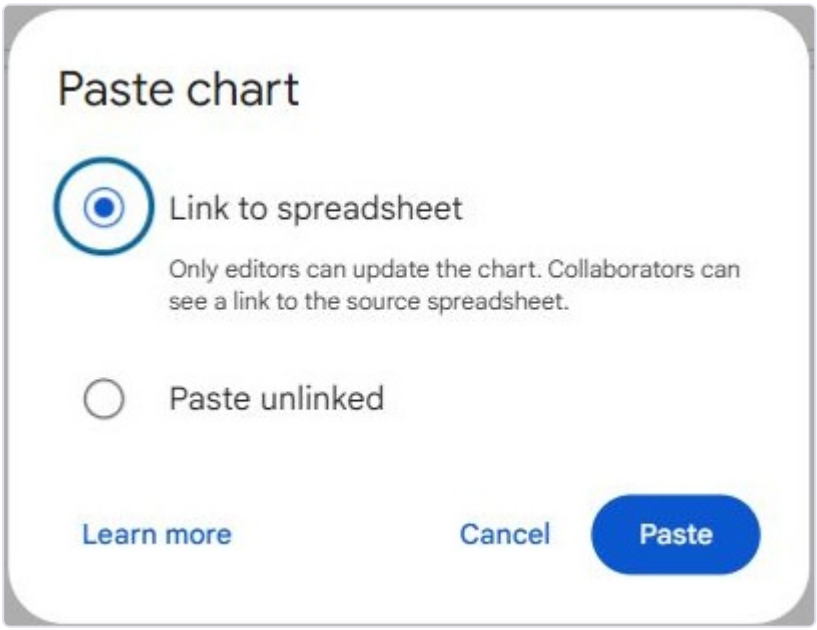
What should you see?

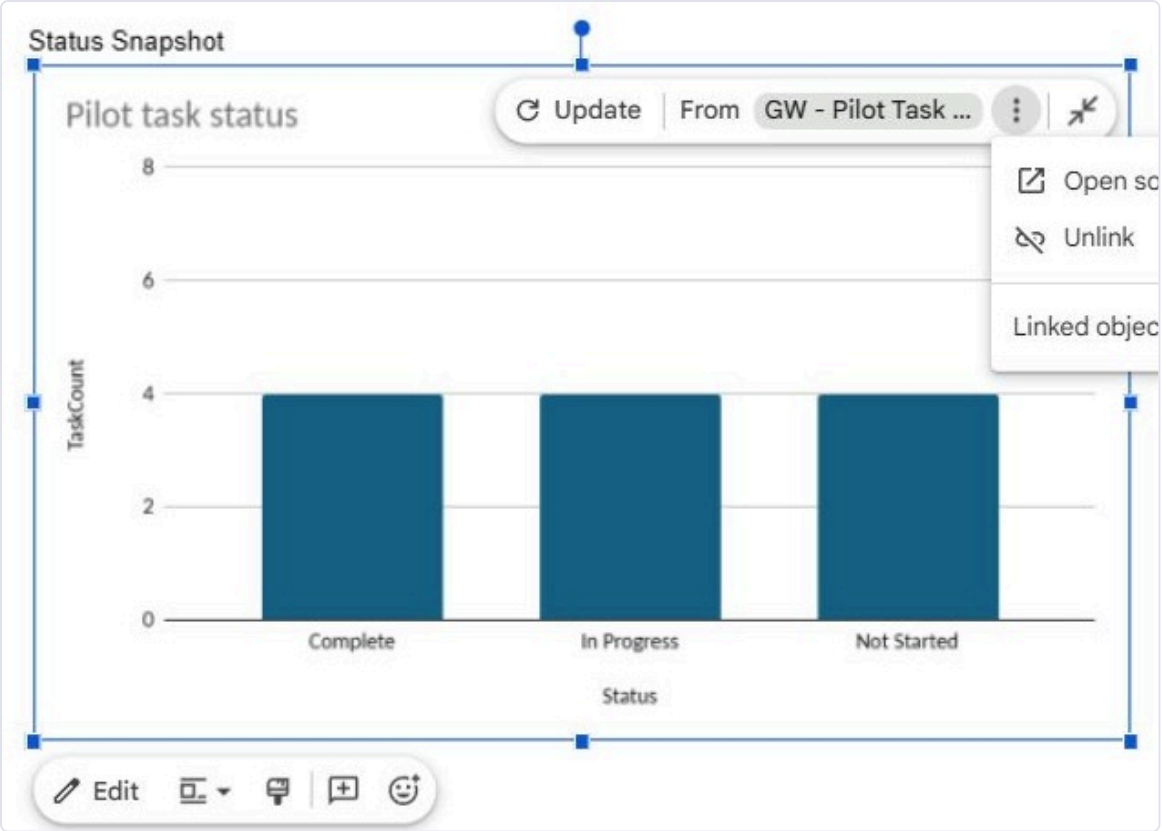
At baseline the three status counts are 4 each, planned costs total RM 10,400 and actual costs total RM 6,800. Team totals reconcile to the source. A filter view changes visibility rather than the underlying record set.



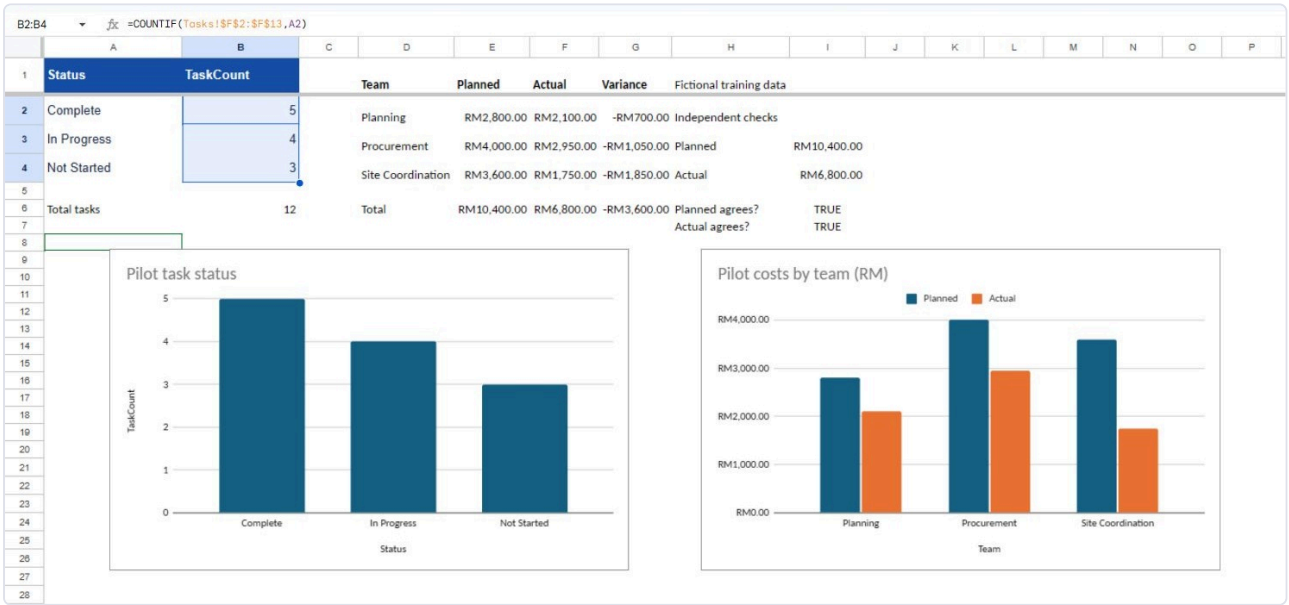
4.3 Verify the Downstream Snapshot

1. Copy the status chart into the brief under **Status Snapshot**. Choose **Link to spreadsheet** when offered. Verify it points to your working tracker.

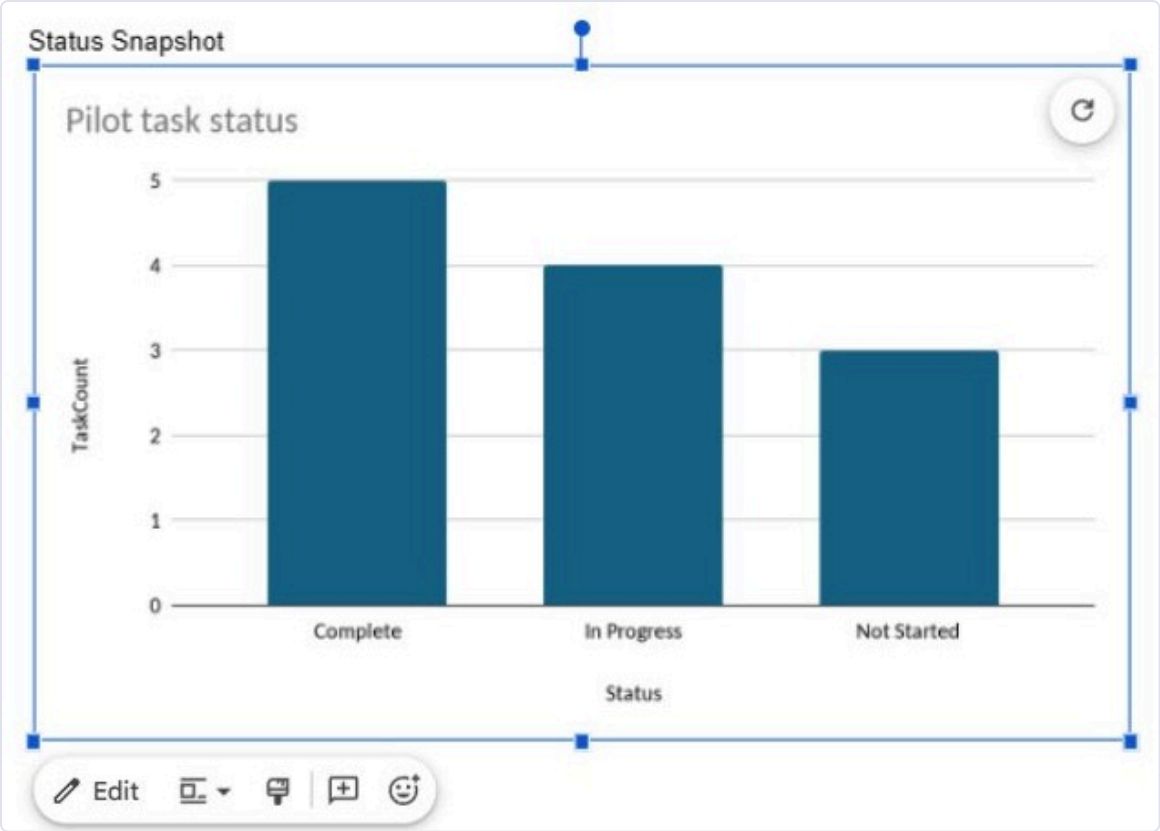


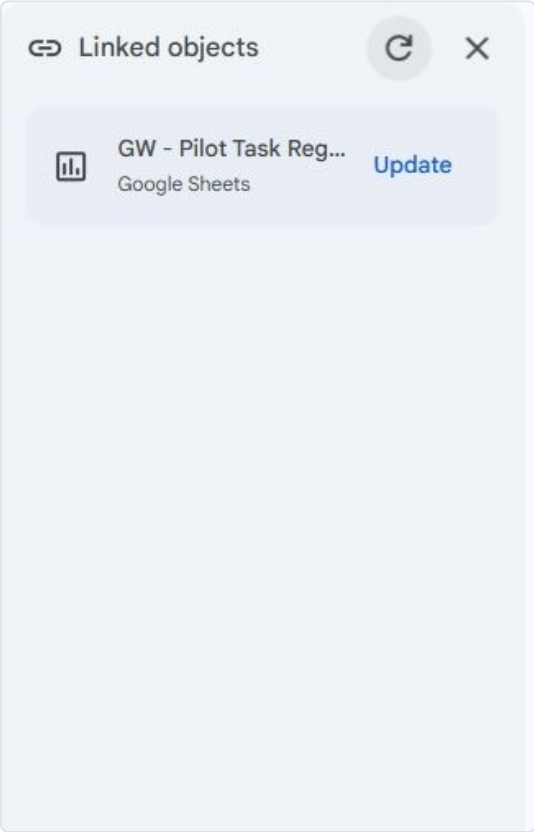


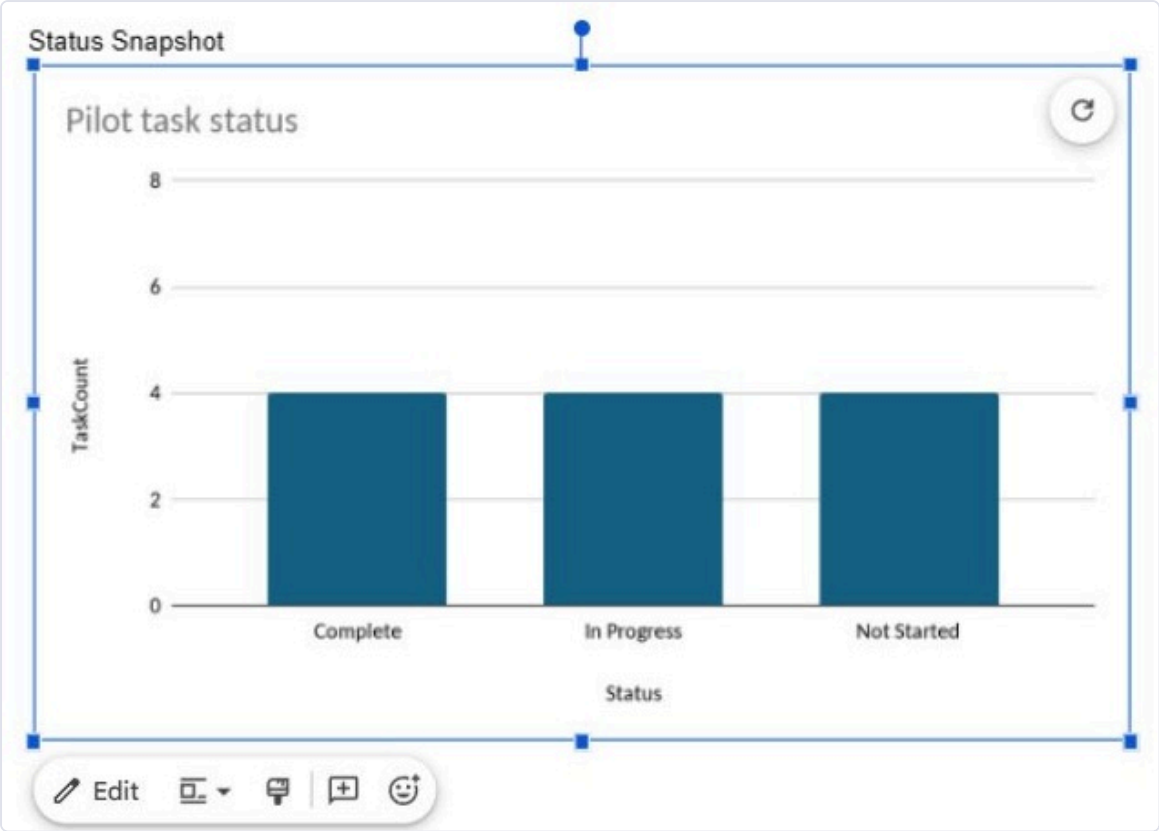
2. Temporarily change T003 from Not Started to Complete in **Tasks**. Inspect the source summary before touching the document.



3. In the brief select the linked chart and choose **Update** if offered. Compare its values with the source, then restore T003 and refresh again.


Status Snapshot
Pilot task status
5
4
3
2
1
0
TaskCount
Complete
In Progress
Not Started
Status
Edit


Linked objects
GW - Pilot Task Reg...
Google Sheets
Update



If **Update** is not yet offered after restoration, open **Linked chart options**, **Linked objects**, then **Refresh** and **Update chart**. Verify the destination values after updating.

4. Add a small refresh log to the brief: Source change, Source checked, Destination refreshed and Result. Record both the changed and restored states.
5. Explain that a reader can see a linked chart in a document without necessarily having access to the source spreadsheet. Use aggregated fictional data and inspect the intended document audience.

Refresh Log

Source change	Source checked	Destination refreshed	Result
T003: Not Started to Complete (temporary test)	Summary: 5 Complete, 4 In Progress, 3 Not Started; total 12	Brief linked chart: Update	Matched 5, 4, 3
T003: restored to Not Started	Summary: 4 Complete, 4 In Progress, 4 Not Started; total 12	Linked objects: Refresh, then Update chart	Matched 4, 4, 4

Audience check: the brief remains private to its owner. A linked chart may be visible to a document reader without granting access to the source spreadsheet. Only aggregated fictional data is shown. No sharing permission was changed.
Maintain the native brief and tracker. The earlier downloaded PDF is a snapshot and must be regenerated after this chart and log revision.

What should you see?

The source and destination both change to 5, 4, 3, then return to 4, 4, 4. The refresh log records a check rather than assuming that pasted content is always current.

Independent Challenge

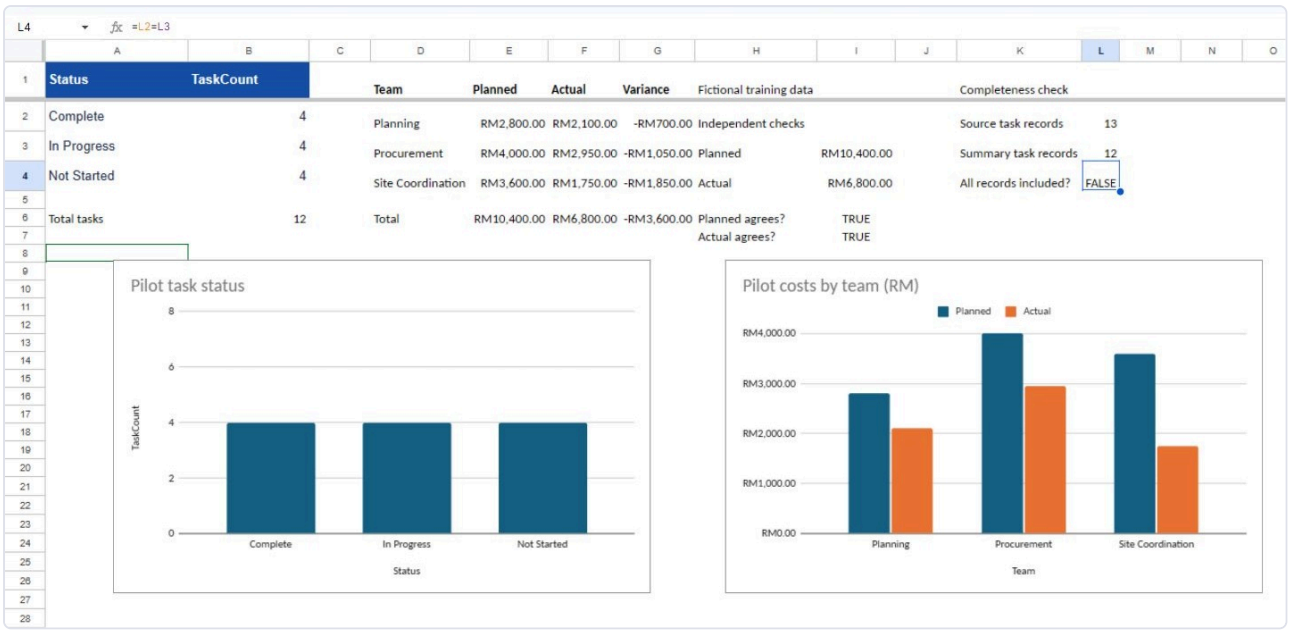
Use the Lab 4 card in masterclass-challenges.txt without copying a completed formula solution.

1. Add T013 as a new row in **Tasks**, with the supplied fields. Extend the status validation and variance formula to that row.

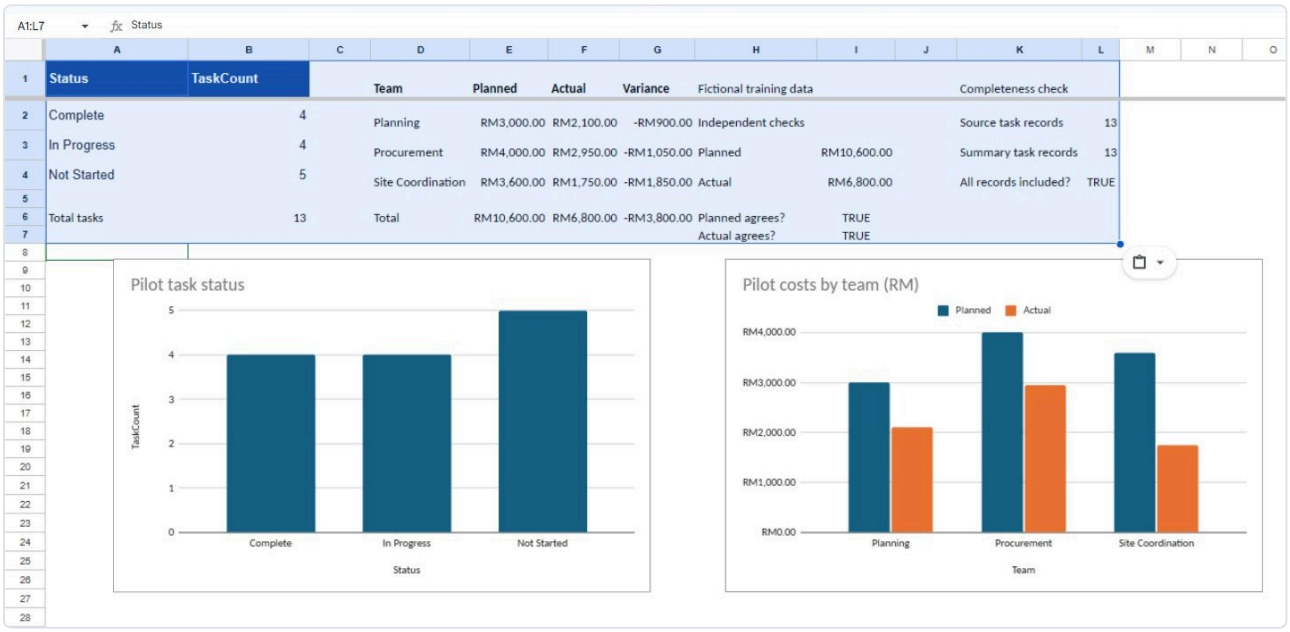
I14 fx =H14-G14

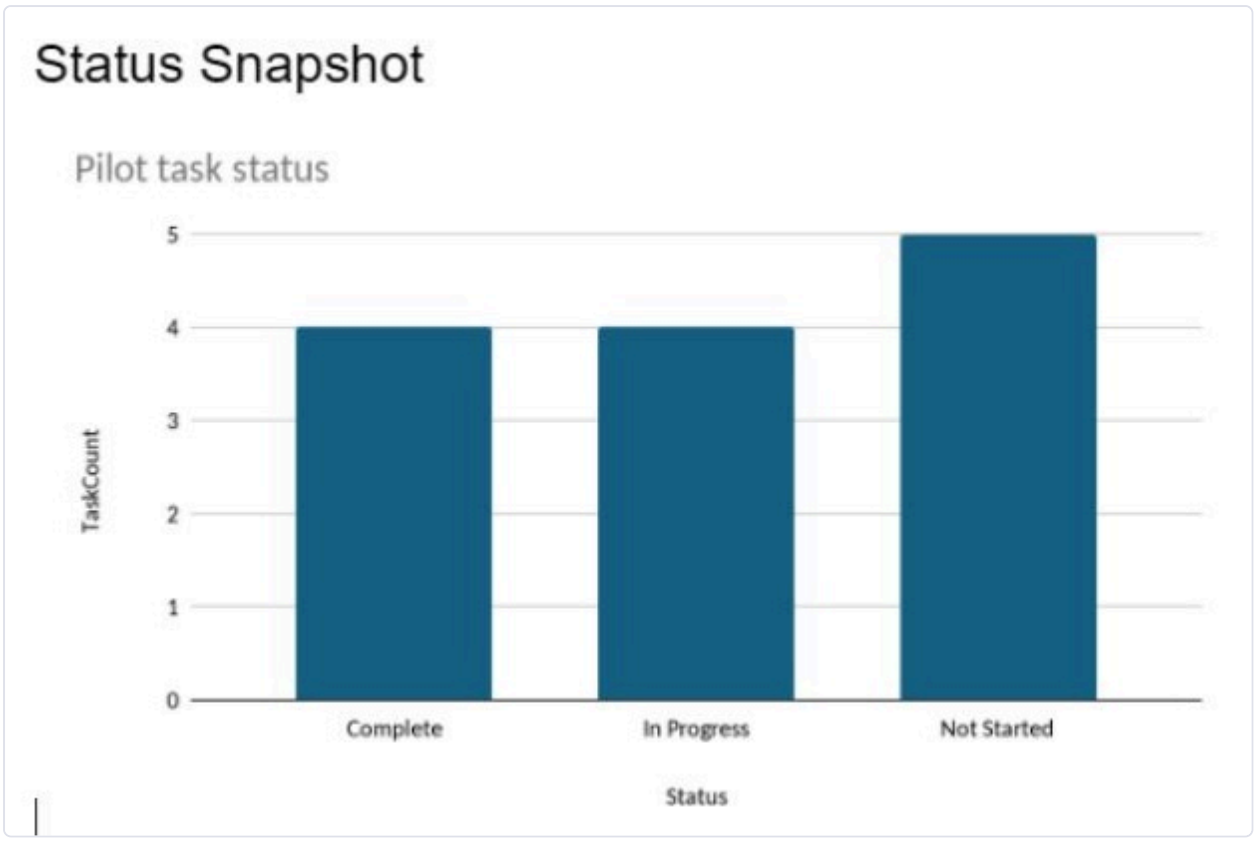
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost	Variance	Fictional tr
2	T001	Planning	Confirm reporting fields	Aina Rahman	1	Complete	RM600.00	RM550.00	-RM50.00	
3	T002	Planning	Draft status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	In Progress	RM800.00	RM700.00	-RM100.00	
4	T003	Planning	Review pilot brief	Siti Aminah	1	Not Started	RM500.00	RM0.00	-RM500.00	
5	T004	Planning	Prepare register template	Aina Rahman	2	Complete	RM900.00	RM850.00	-RM50.00	
6	T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM1,200.00	RM1,050.00	-RM150.00	
7	T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
8	T007	Procurement	Review sample chart	Aina Rahman	3	Complete	RM1,500.00	RM1,400.00	-RM100.00	
9	T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM600.00	RM500.00	-RM100.00	
10	T009	Site Coordination	Check hub navigation	Siti Aminah	3	Not Started	RM1,000.00	RM0.00	-RM1,000.00	
11	T010	Site Coordination	Rehearse sponsor update	Aina Rahman	4	Complete	RM800.00	RM750.00	-RM50.00	
12	T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00	-RM100.00	
13	T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
14	T013	Planning	Check reporting handover	Aina Rahman	4	Not Started	200	0	-200	
15										

2. Predict which status count and cost total should change. Inspect whether the existing fixed-range formulas actually include the row.

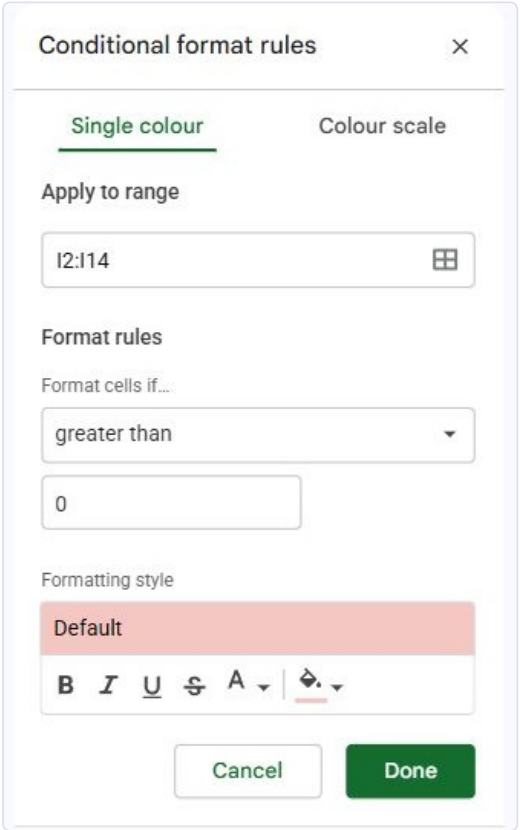


3. Repair the COUNTIF, SUMIF and independent control ranges to include all 13 records. Explain why adding the row did not automatically repair every reference. Recheck both charts and refresh the brief.





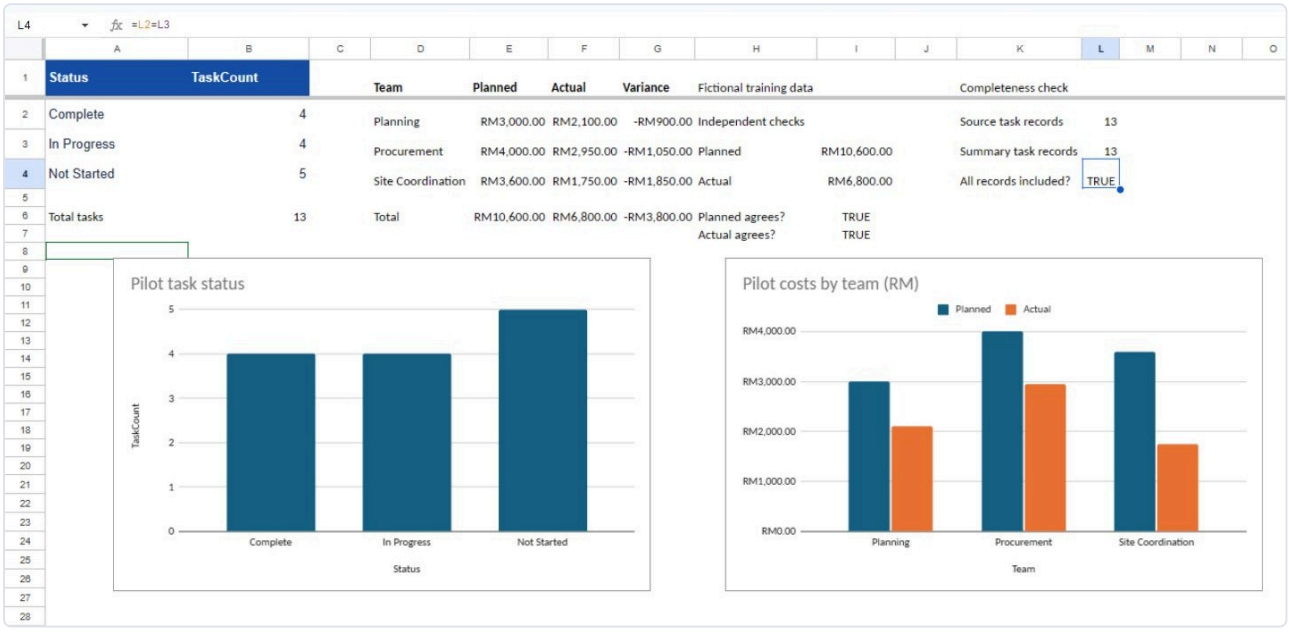
4. Apply conditional formatting to I2:I14 so positive actual-minus-planned variance is easy to identify. Use a temporary over-plan value on the new record to test it, then restore the card's value and prove restoration.



12	T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00	-RM100.00
13	T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00
14	T013	Planning	Check reporting handover	Aina Rahman	4	Not Started	200	250	50
15									

12	T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00	-RM100.00
13	T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00
14	T013	Planning	Check reporting handover	Aina Rahman	4	Not Started	200	0	-200
15									

5. Leave T013 in place for Labs 5 and 6. Record the final totals, row count and the changed ranges in your refresh log.



New-record verification - scripted reference run
T013 retained: Planning; Not Started; planned RM 200; actual RM 0. The source has 13 task records.
Repaired COUNTIF status range: Tasks!F2:F14. Repaired SUMIF team and cost ranges: Tasks!B2:B14, G2:G14 and H2:H14. Independent checks now total G2:G14 and H2:H14.
Status validation covers F2:F14 and variance formulas I2:I14.
Final source and brief counts: 4 Complete, 4 In Progress, 5 Not Started; total 13. Planned RM 10,600; actual RM 6,800; actual-minus-planned variance -RM 3,800. Both source-sum checks and completeness check are TRUE.
The saved Procurement filter range also includes row 14; its three matching tasks are unchanged.
Positive-variance rule: I2:I14 greater than 0, red background. Temporary T013 actual RM 250 produced variance RM 50 and triggered the highlight. Restored actual RM 0 and variance -RM 200; the positive highlight cleared.
Refreshed the linked brief chart after repair and checked 4, 4, 5. Adding a source row had not extended the fixed summary formula ranges automatically. The earlier PDF remains an older snapshot.

If you finish early, build a pivot table that summarises planned and actual cost by team and reconcile it with SUMIF. This is an extension, not a replacement for the range-repair challenge.

Evidence to Hand Over

- Status Intake audit with justified normalisation and an unresolved category.
- 13-row tracker, validation, row formulas, status summary, team costs and two charts.
- Independent reconciliation and a refresh log showing the baseline test and final new-record state.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Repair to investigate
The new task is absent from a chart	Inspect the summary formula ranges first, then the chart source range.
SUMIF gives zero for a team	Compare the team text and criteria cell; inspect spaces and numeric cost types.
Every variance uses row 2	Remove accidental absolute row references and inspect a copied formula.
A pasted chart has no Update control	Verify whether it was inserted as a linked object rather than an image.

Check Yourself

Explain one error you found, how you proved the correction, and which downstream result it could affect. A finished-looking file alone is not evidence that it is correct.

05

CHAPTER 5

Build an Evidence-Based Sponsor Update

Your assignment: Create and rehearse a five-slide decision-focused update with live data, source links and checked speaker notes.

Target allocation: 60 minutes: 18 demonstration and discussion, 22 guided build, 15 independent challenge, 5 verification and repair. These are design allocations, not measured completion times. Finish the challenge and checks before moving on; finishing the guided clicks is not completion of the lab.

Status: five-slide native reference deck captured in sequence, with source notes, two linked charts, editable process shapes, presentation inspection, a named baseline and two inspected five-page PDF snapshots. The cost-correction card was executed as a scripted prerequisite for Lab 6. Partner rehearsal, independent reviewer comparison, independent learner performance and classroom timings remain unvalidated.

What You Will Learn

- Select a message and layout for a specific audience.
- Use linked evidence and distinguish totals from unsupported benefits.
- Create a repeatable visual style and readable chart.
- Handle a change request, refresh evidence and check an exported deck.

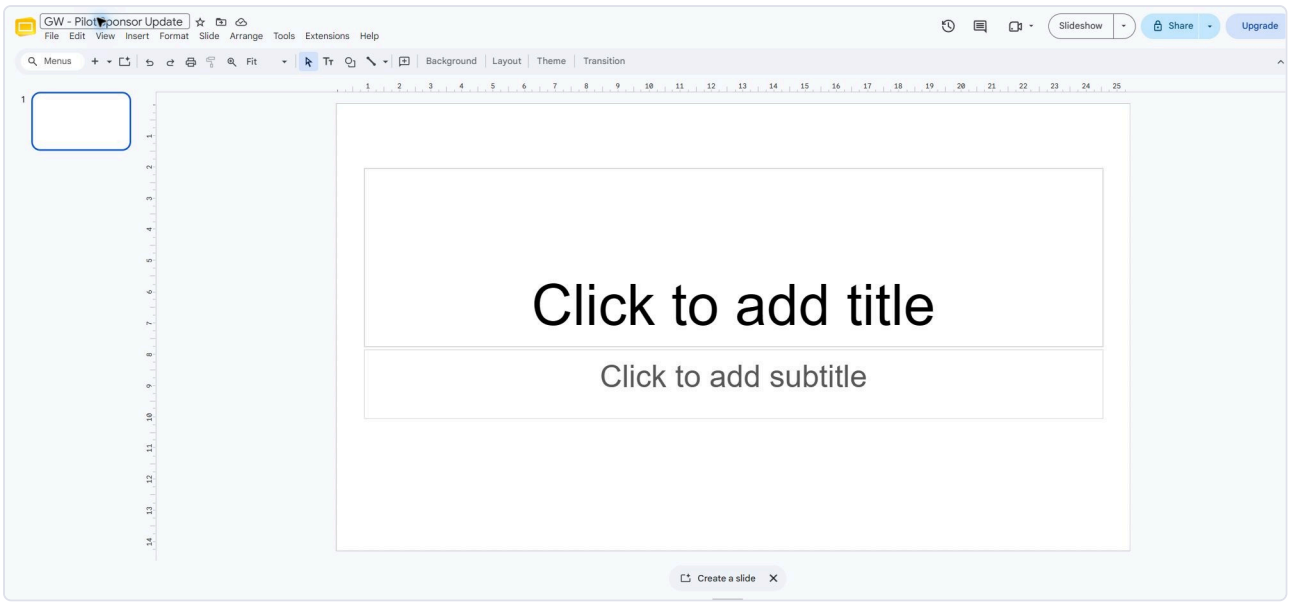
Before You Begin

Use the checked brief and the 13-task tracker from Lab 4. Recovery: convert the starter workbook and complete the Lab 4 new-record card before preparing the deck. If Slides AI features are unavailable, author the same deck manually.

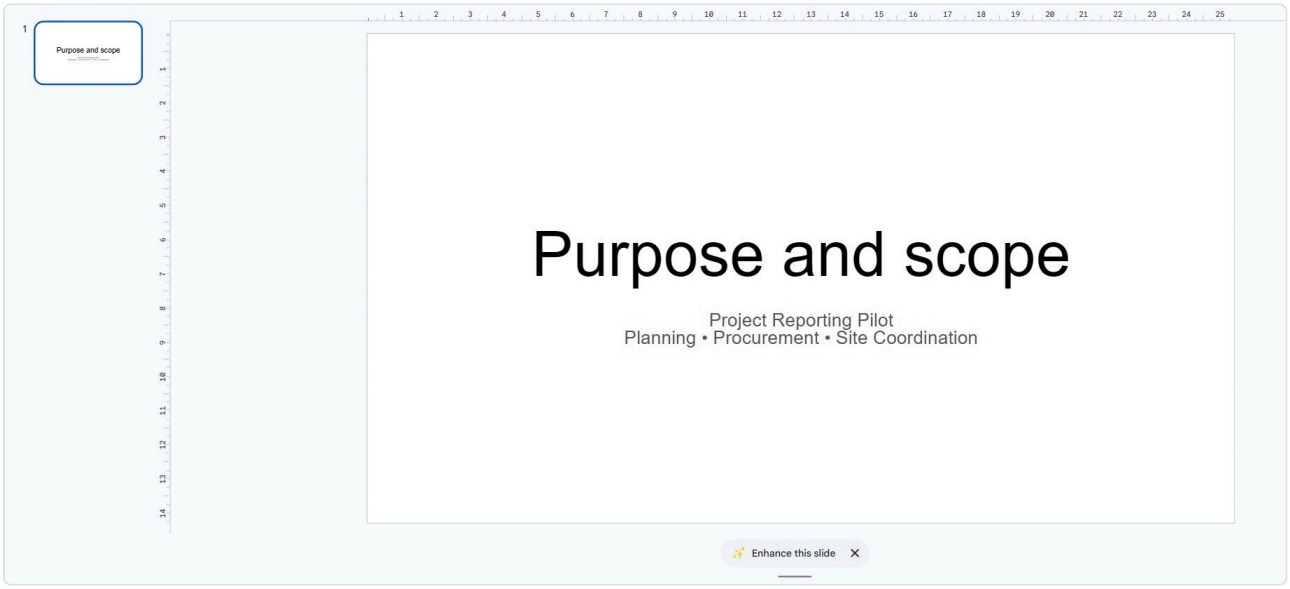
Use the copy-paste page and shared practice files. Keep fictional role names as text. Use only trainer-assigned test identities for any access test.

5.1 Plan the Story Before Formatting

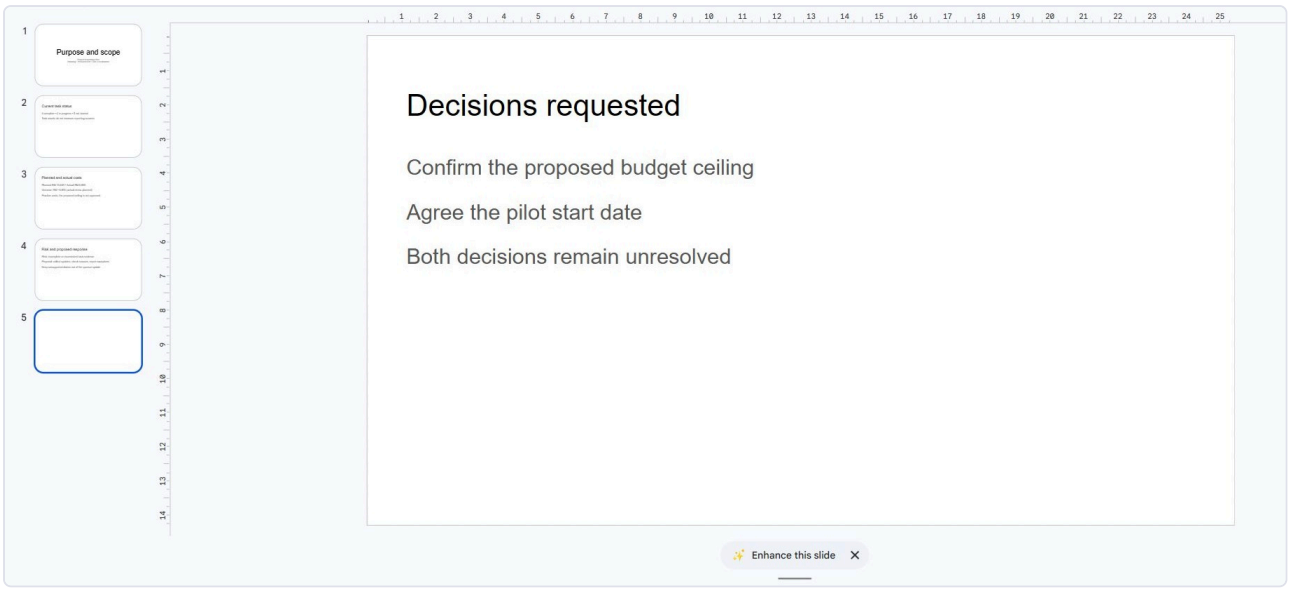
1. Create `GW - Pilot Sponsor Update` in **02 Working**. Plan five slides: Purpose and scope; Current task status; Planned and actual costs; Risk and response; Decisions requested.



2. For each slide write one audience takeaway and its source in the speaker notes. Label proposed mitigations as proposals.



3. Use the optional AI outline prompt only after pasting checked facts and final summary values. Compare the outline with your five planned messages; reject invented progress percentages or approvals.
4. Write the two decision requests explicitly. Keep budget approval and pilot start-date agreement unresolved. Do not present a Calendar practice slot as the project schedule.

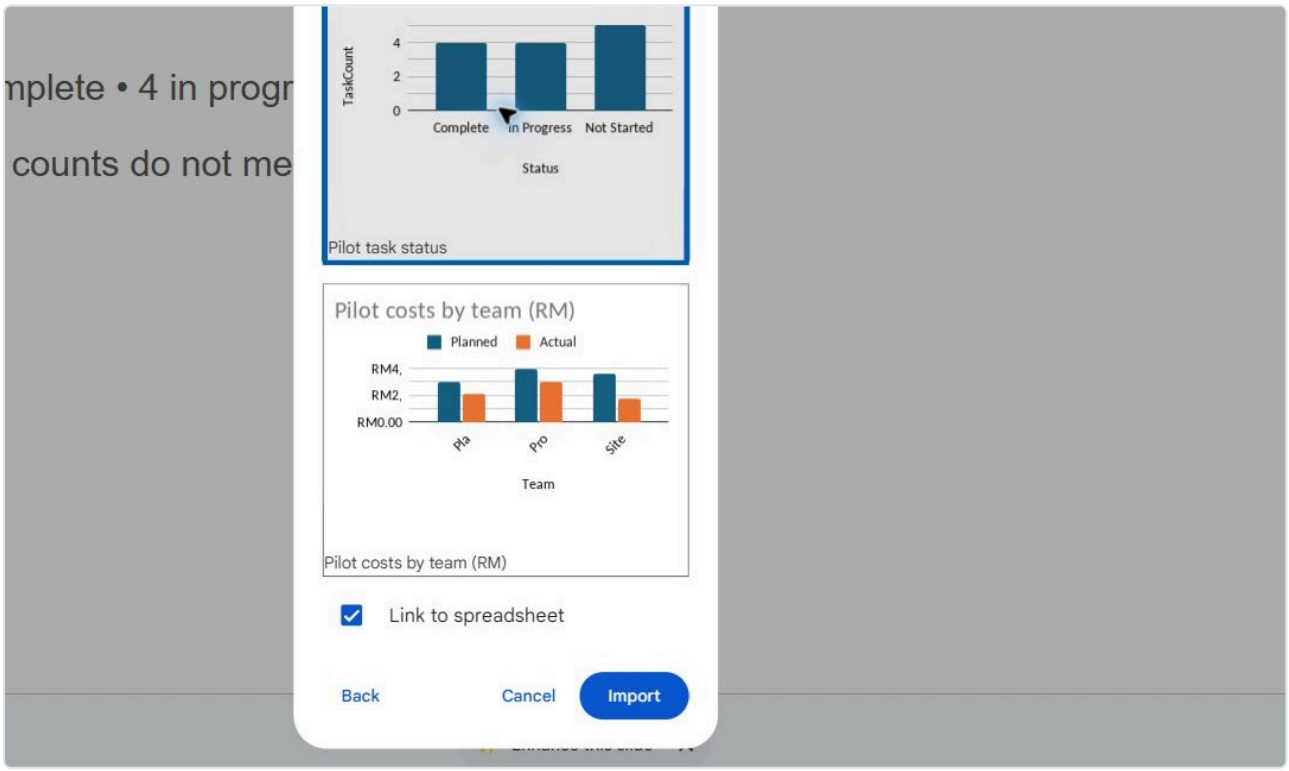


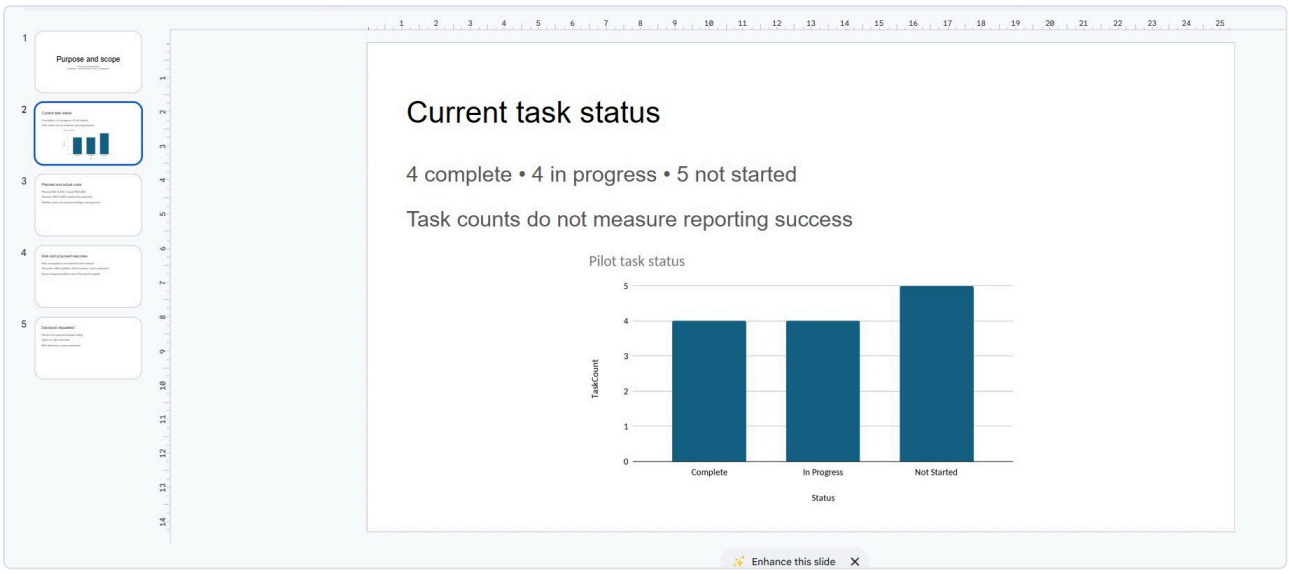
What should you see?

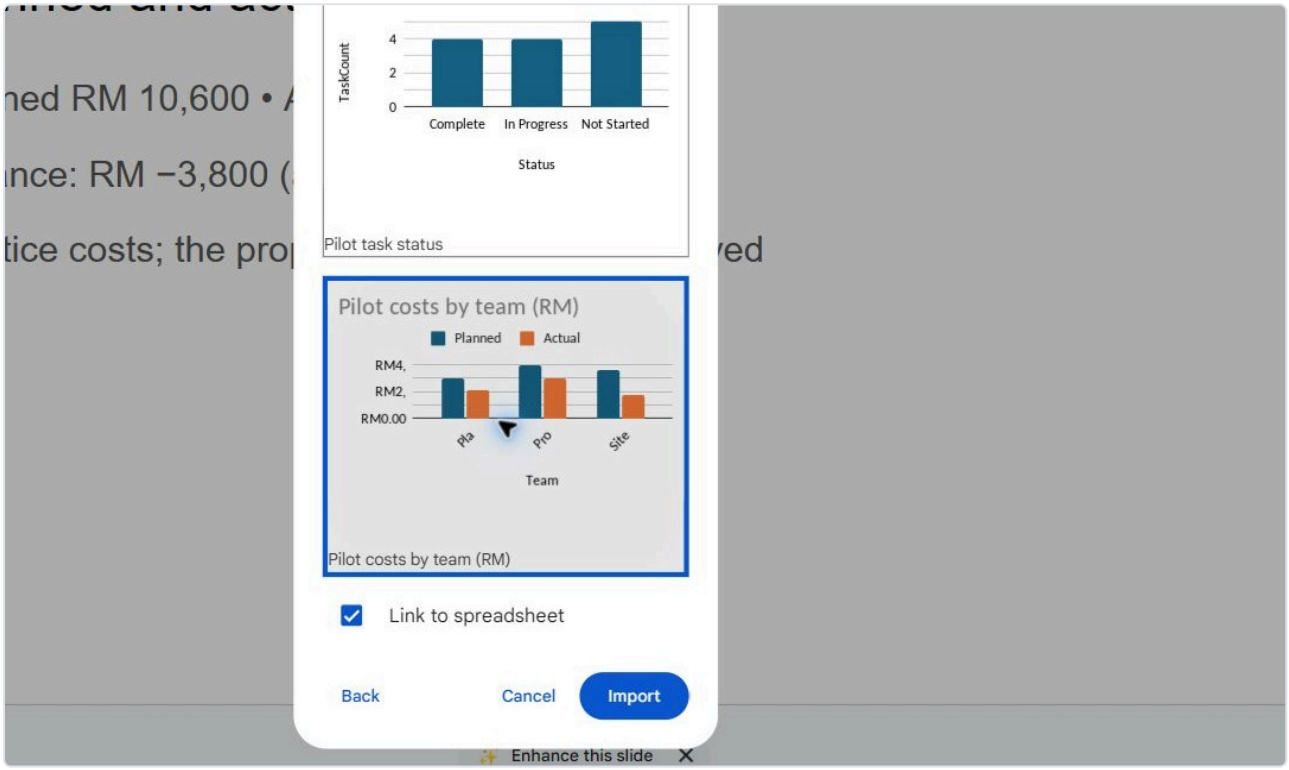
The deck tells a decision-focused story with a source for every numeric or factual claim. Task counts do not establish a time-based success measure.

5.2 Build Readable and Traceable Slides

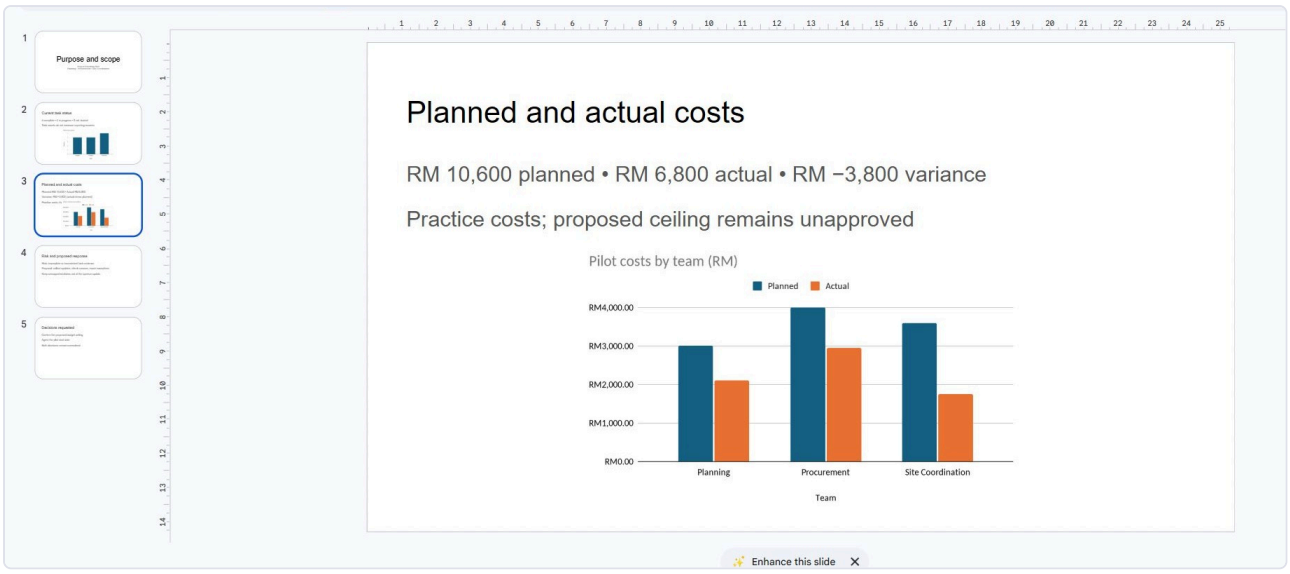
1. Choose a simple theme. Use consistent title and body layouts, readable text sizes and a restrained colour palette. Replace dense prose with short points, retaining factual qualifications.
2. On slide 2 choose **Insert**, **Chart**, **From Sheets** and select your working tracker's status chart with **Link to spreadsheet** enabled. On slide 3 insert the team-cost chart the same way.



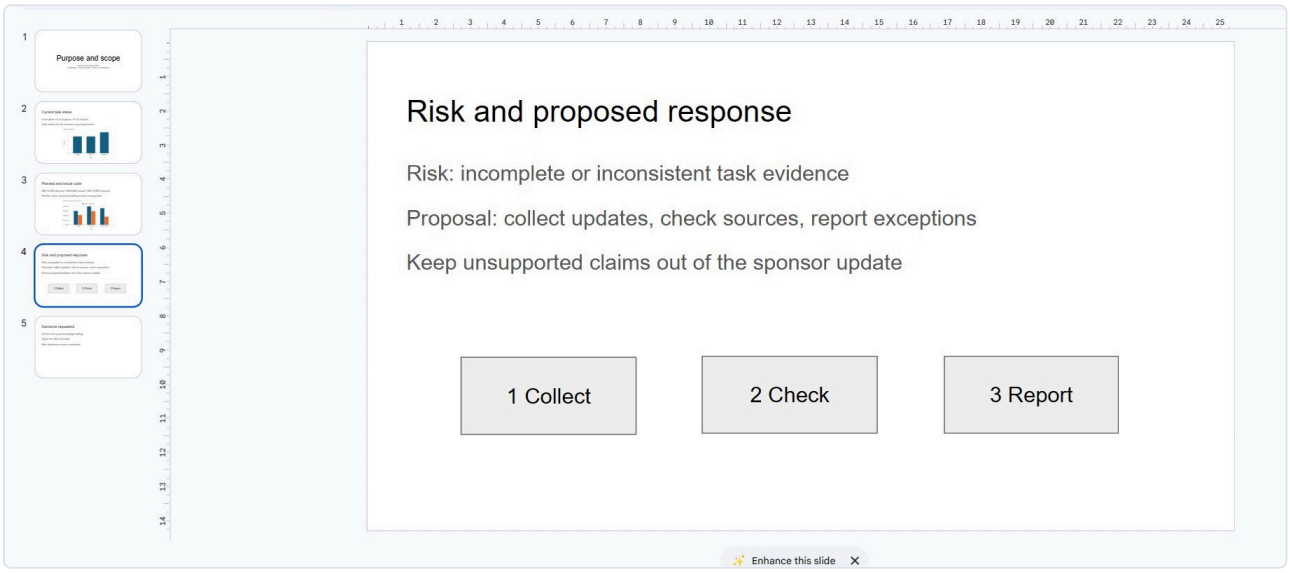




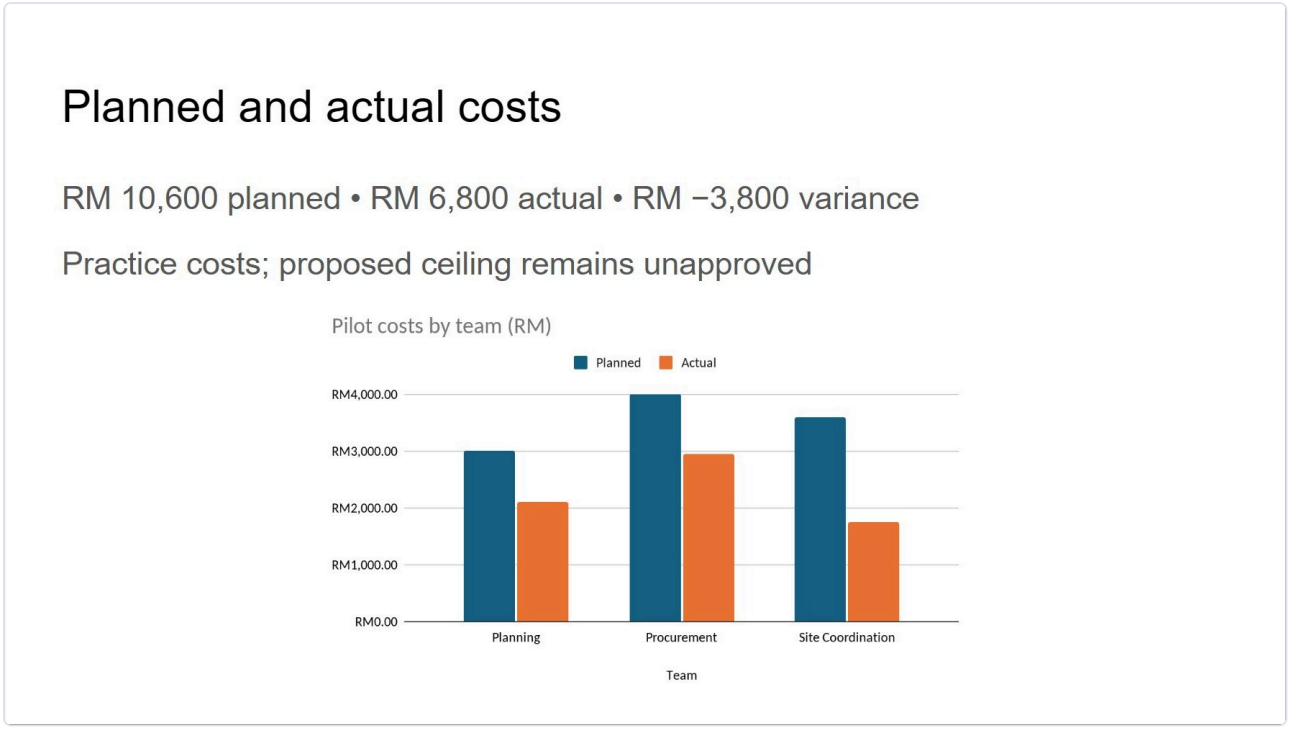
3. Check category labels, title and contrast at presentation size. Avoid a colour-only status distinction by retaining explicit labels.



4. In speaker notes record the source link, 13-task dataset scope and the actual-minus-planned variance definition. State that the task costs are practice data and the proposed ceiling is not approved.
5. Create a simple three-step process diagram with shapes for Collect, Check and Report. Give it a short text explanation. If using a decorative AI image, label it illustrative and record its origin; it must not substitute for data.



6. Use **Present** to check every slide. Inspect any clipped labels and notes that accidentally became slide text. Remove effects that make the chart harder to read.

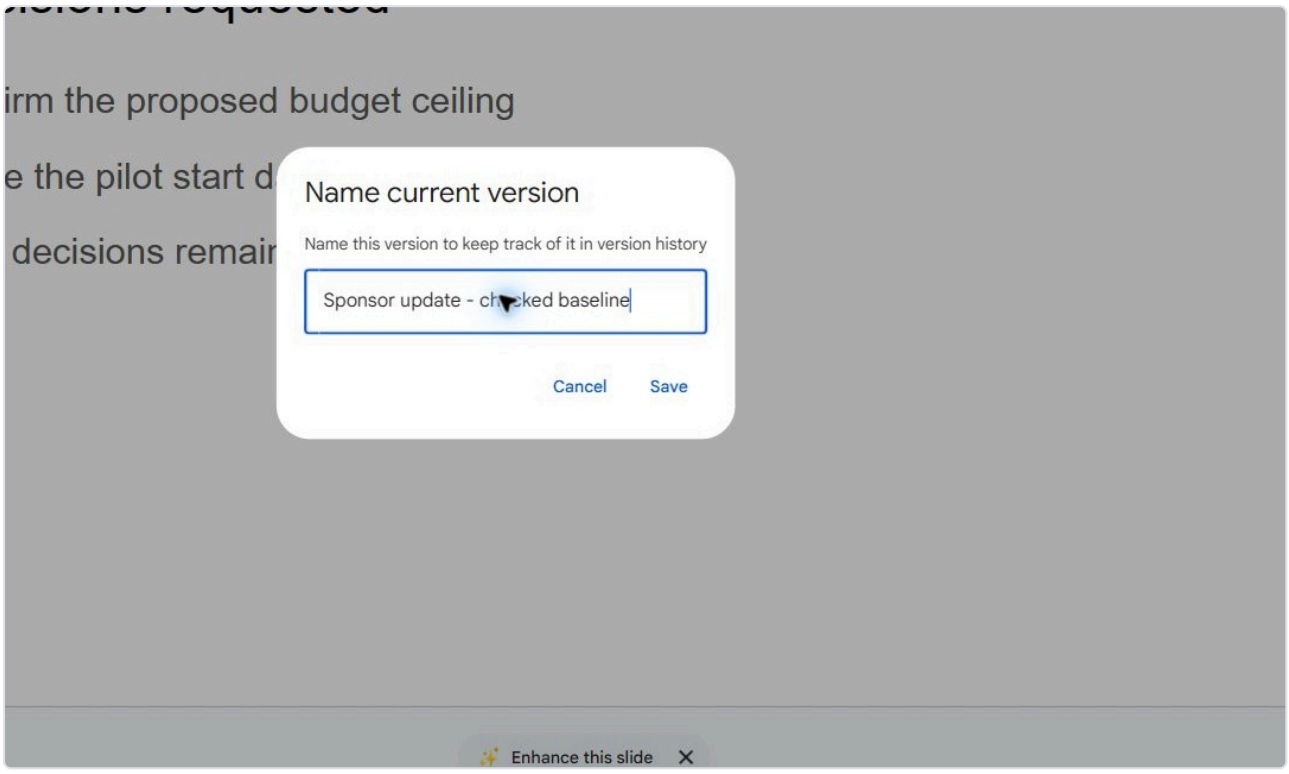


What should you see?

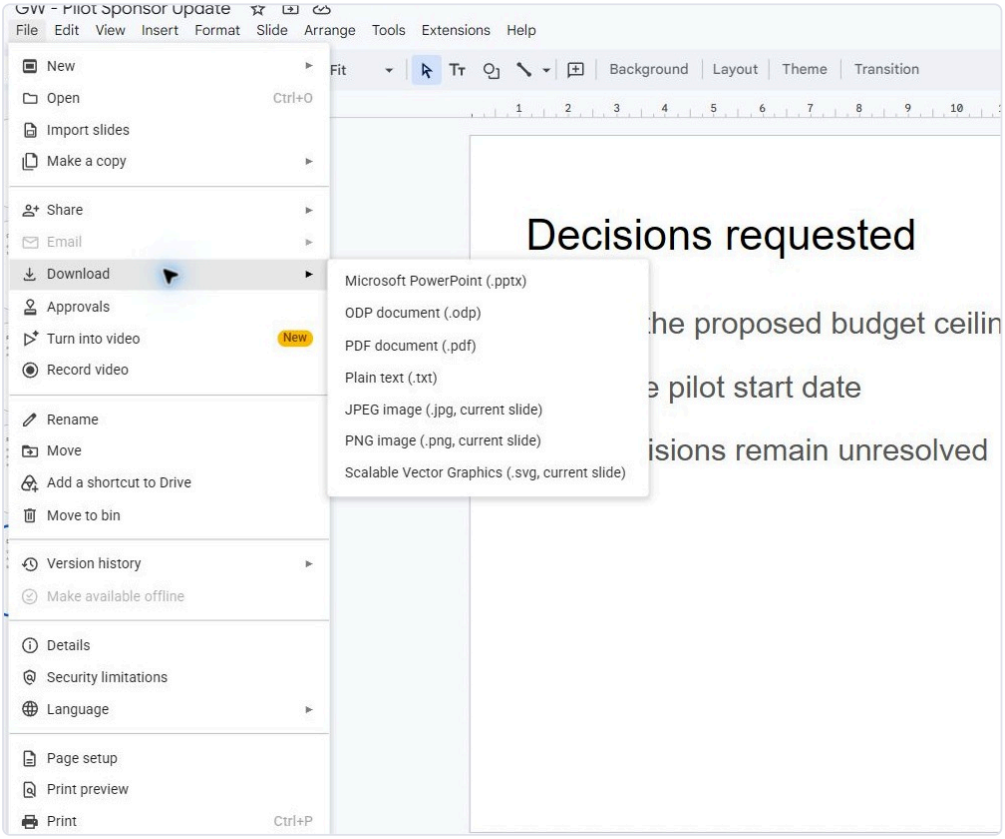
Five slides have coherent layouts, two linked charts and useful notes. Both source scope and unresolved decisions are clear at presentation size.

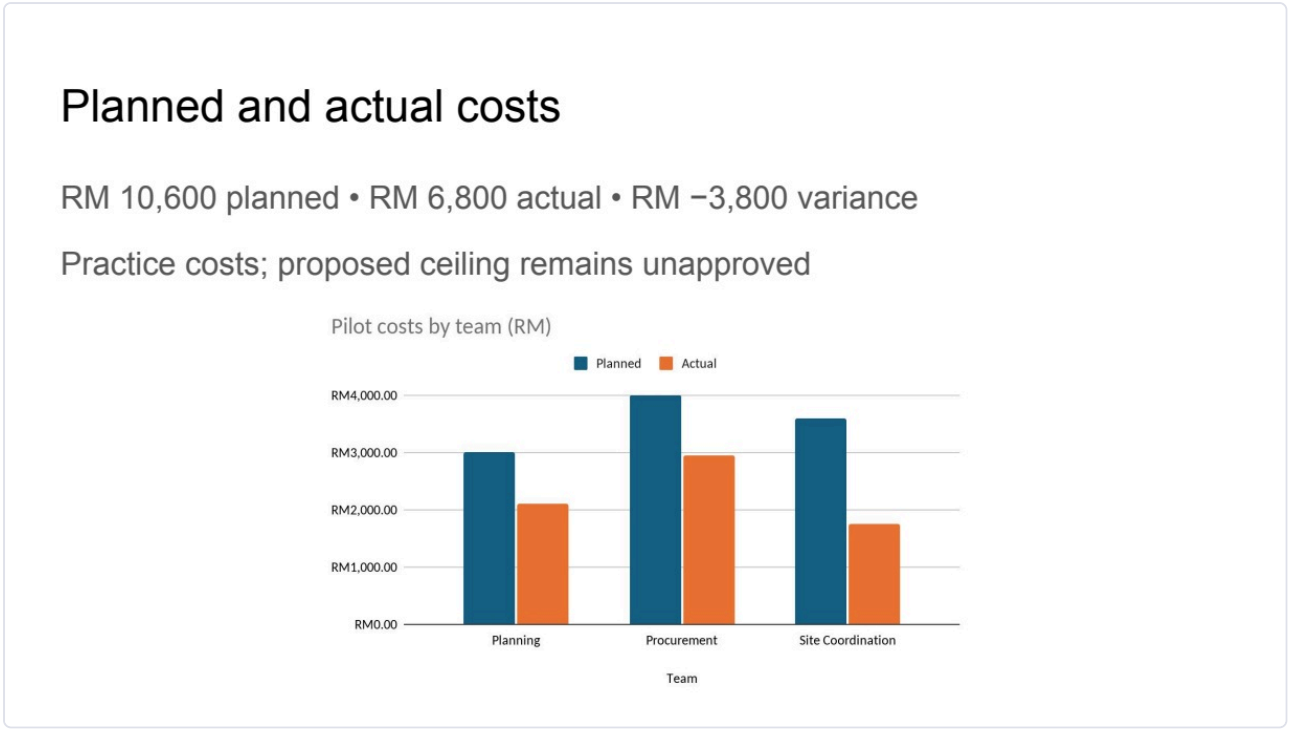
5.3 Rehearse, Review and Export

1. Deliver a two-minute sponsor update to a partner or rehearse aloud. Explain the evidence and ask for the two unresolved decisions.
2. Ask the reviewer to identify one unsupported statement and one unclear label. If none is found, have them point to the evidence for the most consequential claim.
3. Correct the deck and name the version `Sponsor update - checked baseline` through **File**, **Version history**.



4. Download a PDF through **File**, **Download**. Open every page and inspect charts and layout. Record that the PDF is a dated snapshot and will need a new export after source updates.





What should you see?

The learner can explain the figures and limitations without reading raw slide text. The exported copy matches the checked native baseline.

Independent Challenge

Use the Lab 5 cost-correction card. The following captures are a scripted reference run; learners should make their own predictions before inspecting the result.

1. Locate T013 in the source and record its current actual cost before editing.

H14 fx 0

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost	Variance	Fictional tr
2	T001	Planning	Confirm reporting fields	Aina Rahman	1	Complete	RM600.00	RM550.00	-RM50.00	
3	T002	Planning	Draft status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	In Progress	RM800.00	RM700.00	-RM100.00	
4	T003	Planning	Review pilot brief	Siti Aminah	1	Not Started	RM500.00	RM0.00	-RM500.00	
5	T004	Planning	Prepare register template	Aina Rahman	2	Complete	RM900.00	RM850.00	-RM50.00	
6	T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM1,200.00	RM1,050.00	-RM150.00	
7	T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
8	T007	Procurement	Review sample chart	Aina Rahman	3	Complete	RM1,500.00	RM1,400.00	-RM100.00	
9	T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM600.00	RM500.00	-RM100.00	
10	T009	Site Coordination	Check hub navigation	Siti Aminah	3	Not Started	RM1,000.00	RM0.00	-RM1,000.00	
11	T010	Site Coordination	Rehearse sponsor update	Aina Rahman	4	Complete	RM800.00	RM750.00	-RM50.00	
12	T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00	-RM100.00	
13	T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
14	T013	Planning	Check reporting handover	Aina Rahman	4	Not Started	RM200.00	RM0.00	-RM200.00	
15										

2. Correct only T013 ActualCost from 0 to 150. Predict the affected team and totals. Keep status and planned cost unchanged.

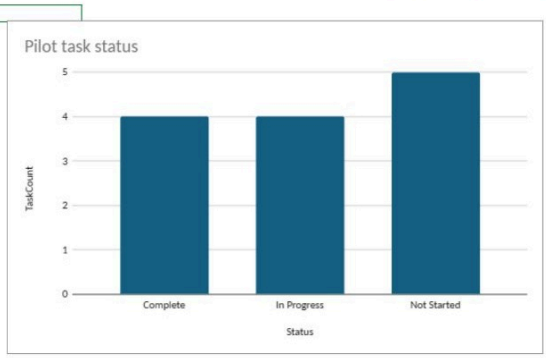
H14 150

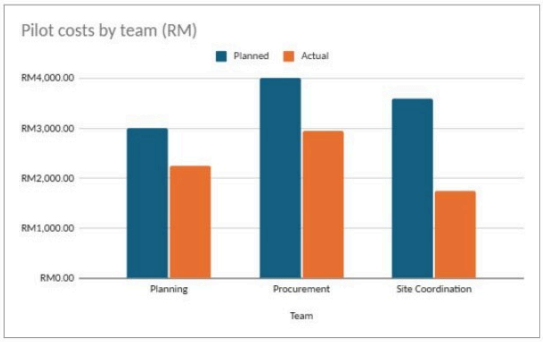
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	TaskID	Team	Task	Owner	DueWeek	Status	PlannedCost	ActualCost	Variance	Fictional tr
2	T001	Planning	Confirm reporting fields	Aina Rahman	1	Complete	RM600.00	RM550.00	-RM50.00	
3	T002	Planning	Draft status definitions	Bala Kumar	1	In Progress	RM800.00	RM700.00	-RM100.00	
4	T003	Planning	Review pilot brief	Siti Aminah	1	Not Started	RM500.00	RM0.00	-RM500.00	
5	T004	Planning	Prepare register template	Aina Rahman	2	Complete	RM900.00	RM850.00	-RM50.00	
6	T005	Procurement	Check dropdown choices	Bala Kumar	2	In Progress	RM1,200.00	RM1,050.00	-RM150.00	
7	T006	Procurement	Collect sample update	Siti Aminah	2	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
8	T007	Procurement	Review sample chart	Aina Rahman	3	Complete	RM1,500.00	RM1,400.00	-RM100.00	
9	T008	Procurement	Prepare team guidance	Bala Kumar	3	In Progress	RM600.00	RM500.00	-RM100.00	
10	T009	Site Coordination	Check hub navigation	Siti Aminah	3	Not Started	RM1,000.00	RM0.00	-RM1,000.00	
11	T010	Site Coordination	Rehearse sponsor update	Aina Rahman	4	Complete	RM800.00	RM750.00	-RM50.00	
12	T011	Site Coordination	Review final submissions	Bala Kumar	4	In Progress	RM1,100.00	RM1,000.00	-RM100.00	
13	T012	Site Coordination	Record pilot lessons	Siti Aminah	4	Not Started	RM700.00	RM0.00	-RM700.00	
14	T013	Planning	Check reporting handover	Aina Rahman	4	Not Started	RM200.00	RM150.00	-RM50.00	
15										

3. Reconcile the summary and independent checks before refreshing a report.

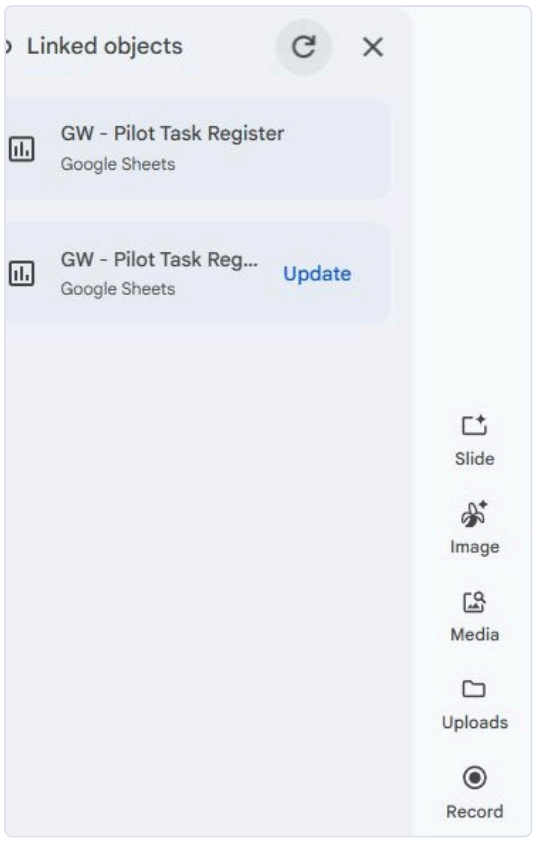
A1 Status

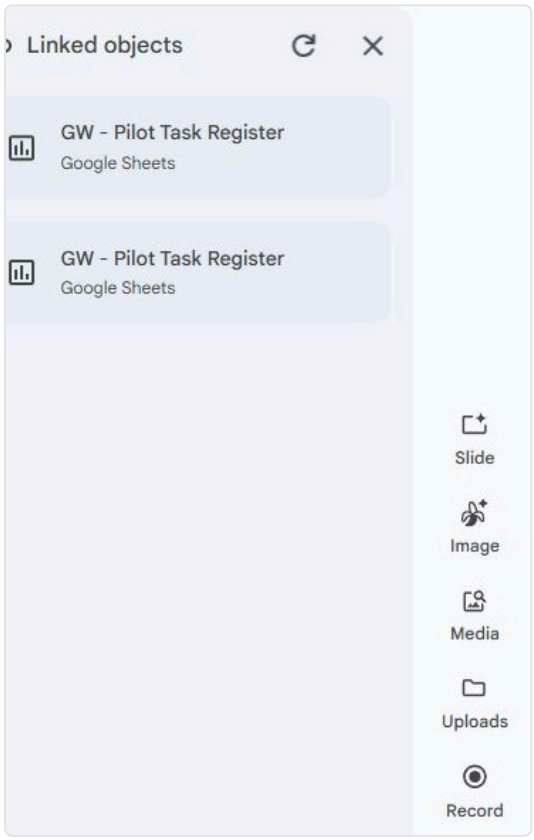
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
1	Status	TaskCount		Team	Planned	Actual	Variance	Fictional training data			Completeness check				
2	Complete	4		Planning	RM3,000.00	RM2,250.00	-RM750.00	Independent checks			Source task records	13			
3	In Progress	4		Procurement	RM4,000.00	RM2,950.00	-RM1,050.00	Planned	RM10,600.00		Summary task records	13			
4	Not Started	5		Site Coordination	RM3,600.00	RM1,750.00	-RM1,850.00	Actual	RM6,950.00		All records included?	TRUE			
5															
6	Total tasks	13		Total	RM10,600.00	RM6,950.00	-RM3,650.00	Planned agrees?	TRUE						
7								Actual agrees?	TRUE						



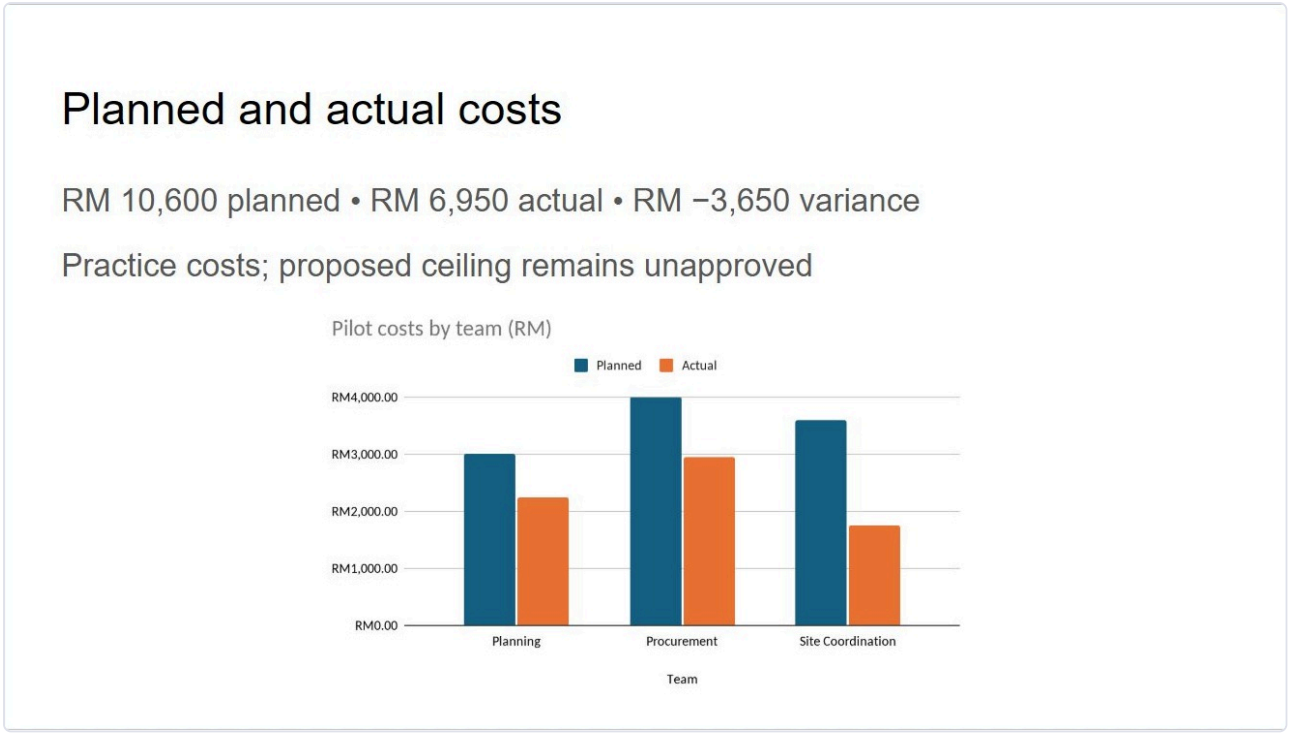


4. In Slides open **Tools**, **Linked objects**, choose **Refresh**, then **Update all** for available changes. Check both chart links. A cost-only correction leaves the status chart unchanged, so only one update may be offered.

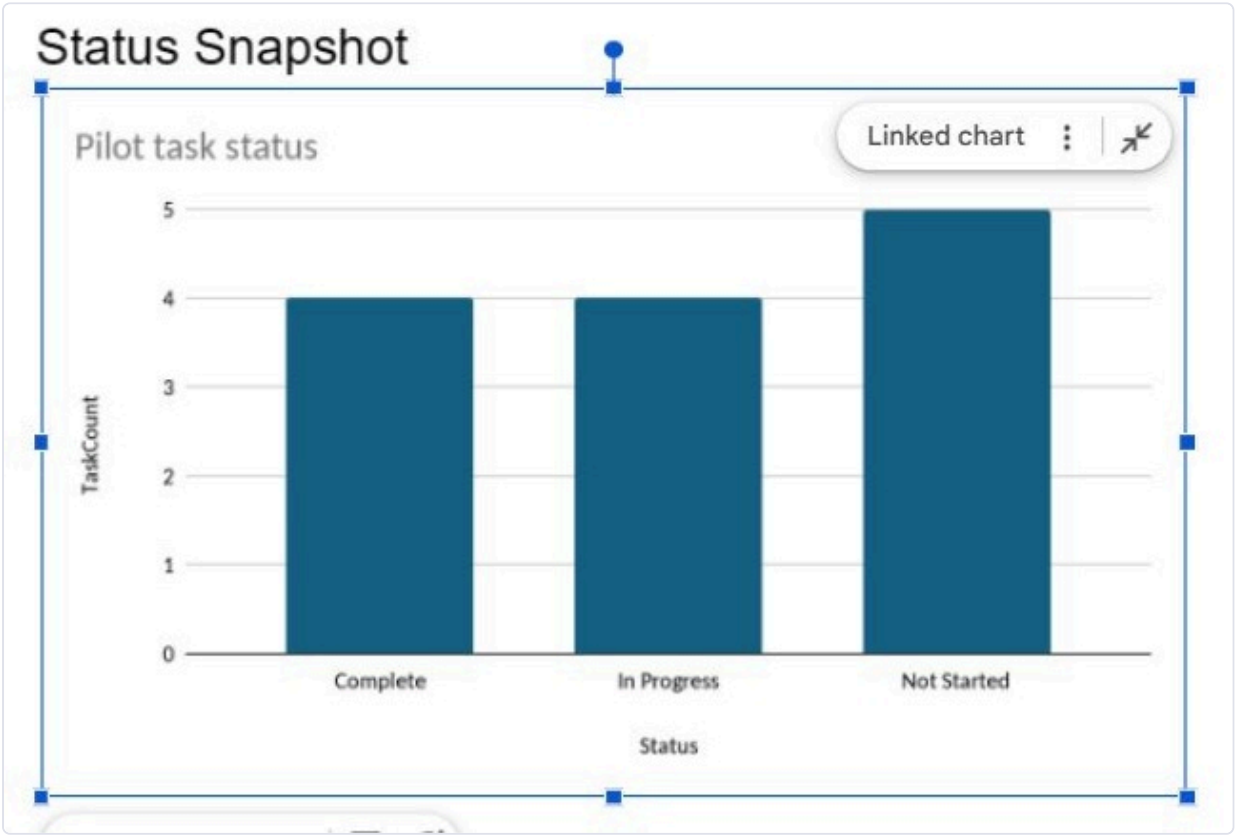




5. Rewrite the cost-slide takeaway and speaker notes to explain the changed figure consistently.



6. Refresh the brief's linked-object panel too. Its status chart should still show 4, 4, 5. Record why no status change was expected and update the refresh log.



Refreshed the linked brief chart after repair and checked 4, 4, 5. Adding a source row had not extended the fixed summary formula ranges automatically. The earlier PDF remains an older snapshot.

Lab 5 cost correction — 18 October 2026
T013 ActualCost corrected from RM 0 to RM 150; its status remains Not Started and planned cost remains RM 200. Summary now reconciles 13 records: planned RM 10,600, actual RM 6,950, variance (actual minus planned) -RM 3,650. Planning actual is RM 2,250 and variance -RM 750. Status counts remain 4 Complete, 4 In Progress and 5 Not Started. Slides linked-object refresh updated the cost chart; the unchanged status chart and this brief chart were checked against the source. Both remain 4, 4, 5. The cost takeaway and speaker notes were revised. The baseline sponsor PDF r1 remains an older snapshot; a separately named r2 is required. No budget approval or pilot start date has been supplied.

Match writing style

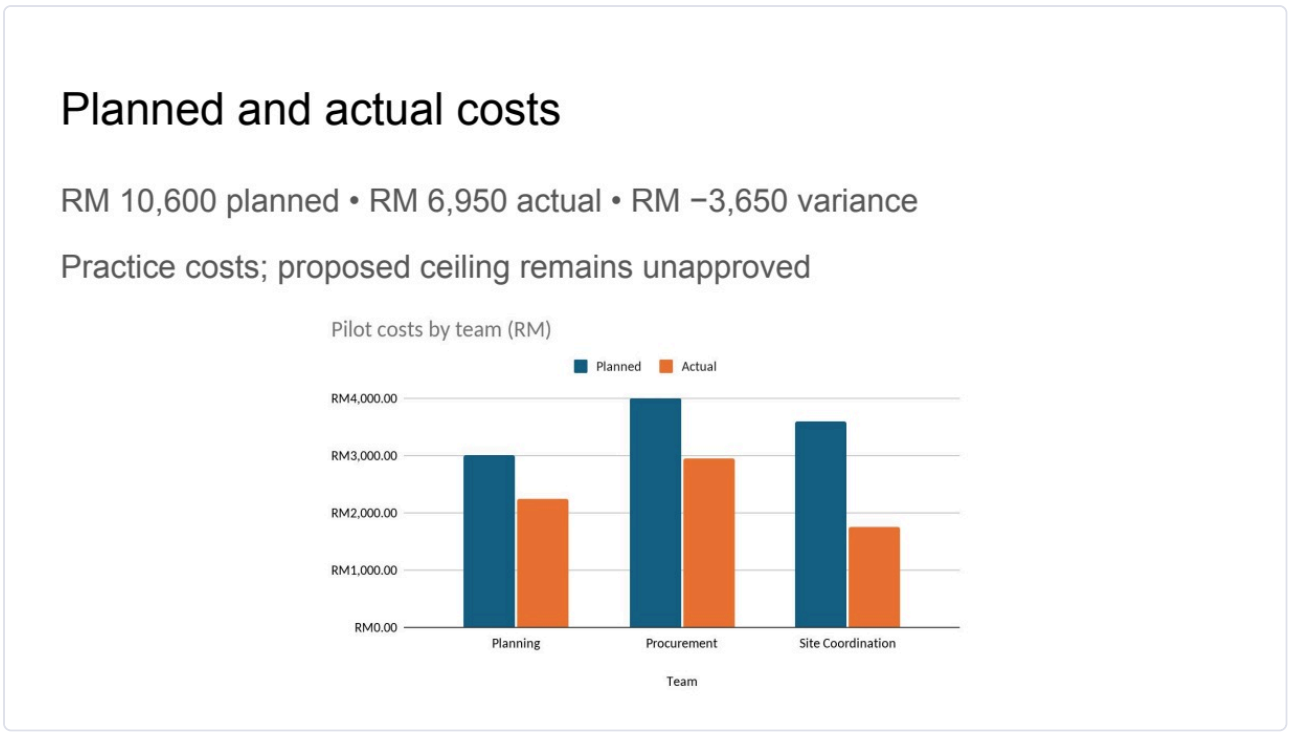
7. Check whether the previously downloaded PDF changed. It is a snapshot: keep `Pilot-Sponsor-Update-r1.pdf`, then issue `Pilot-Sponsor-Update-r2.pdf` from the refreshed native deck. Open every revised page and compare the cost slide with the source.

Planned and actual costs

RM 10,600 planned • RM 6,950 actual • RM −3,650 variance

Practice costs; proposed ceiling remains unapproved





8. Ask a reviewer to compare source, native deck and revised export. Leave T013 with actual cost 150 for the handover lab. Record the review result separately from the scripted reference result.

Evidence to Hand Over

- Five-slide native deck with two linked charts, source notes and explicit decision requests.
- Two-minute explanation and a recorded review correction or supported no-change finding.
- Source-change trace and a separately named revised PDF.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Repair to investigate
The chart shows an earlier task count	Confirm the chart source file and refresh after the summary recalculates.
A favourable variance is called a saving	Check whether the source proves completed scope and realised benefit; use neutral cost wording.
A PDF still shows old values	Refresh the native deck first, then generate and inspect a new export.

Check Yourself

Explain one error you found, how you proved the correction, and which downstream result it could affect. A finished-looking file alone is not evidence that it is correct.

Prompts and values

Optional Outline Prompt

Session: new chat | **Grounding:** pasted checked brief and checked summary only

```
Reply in the side panel only. Propose five slides for a sponsor update: purpose and scope,
task status, planned and actual costs, risk and proposed response, decisions requested. Give
each one a title, no more than three bullets and a source check. Use only the checked brief
and summary pasted below. Do not claim budget approval, a pilot start date, realised savings
or measured reporting success. Label proposed actions as proposals. Do not edit a
presentation.
CHECKED BRIEF:
[paste checked brief]
CHECKED SUMMARY:
[paste your final checked task and cost summary]
```

File Names

```
GW - Pilot Sponsor Update
Sponsor update - checked baseline
Pilot-Sponsor-Update-r1.pdf
Pilot-Sponsor-Update-r2.pdf
```

Use your real checked values; do not ask AI to supply missing data.

06

CHAPTER 6

Assemble the Hub and Prove the Handover

Your assignment: Build a navigable draft project hub, audit resource access and complete a source-to-report change rehearsal.

Target allocation: 70 minutes: 20 demonstration and discussion, 25 guided build, 20 independent challenge, 5 verification and repair. These are design allocations, not measured completion times. Finish the challenge and checks before moving on; finishing the guided clicks is not completion of the lab.

Status: partial real-app reference route captured: three-page unpublished Site, two native embeds, direct resource links, separately inspected Site/tracker/deck permissions, verified resource matrix, five opened operating-guide links and an author navigation improvement. Desktop and phone Preview remained blank, so responsive layout and visitor navigation are unverified. The independent change/restoration rehearsal, partner handover, visitor-access test and classroom timings remain pending.

What You Will Learn

- Build a useful Sites page hierarchy rather than a list of embeds.
- Design navigation, ownership notes and a refresh procedure.
- Distinguish site access, embedded-file access and displayed linked content.
- Diagnose an integrated change and hand the workflow to another person.

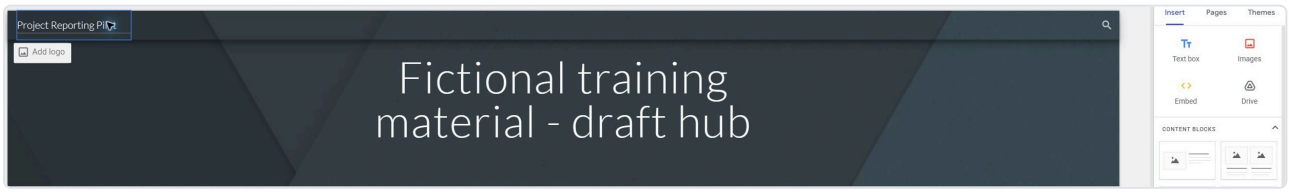
Before You Begin

Use the workspace register, checked brief, meeting record, final tracker and revised Slides deck. You need Google Sites. If Sites is disabled, produce an equivalent linked hub Doc and mark Sites creation and preview as untested. Publishing is outside this private draft exercise.

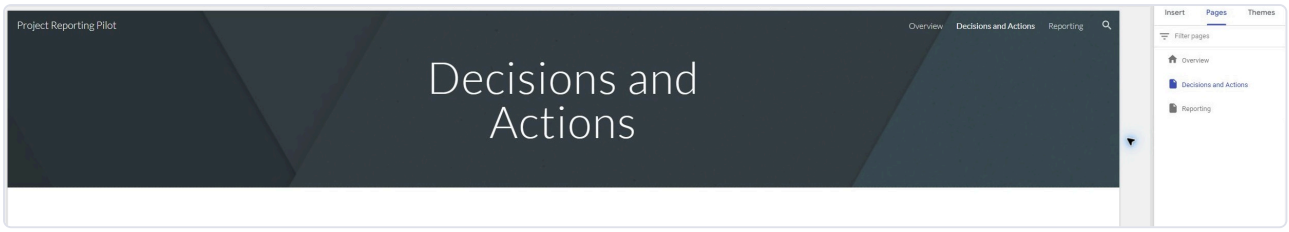
Use the copy-paste page and shared practice files. Keep fictional role names as text. Use only trainer-assigned test identities for any access test.

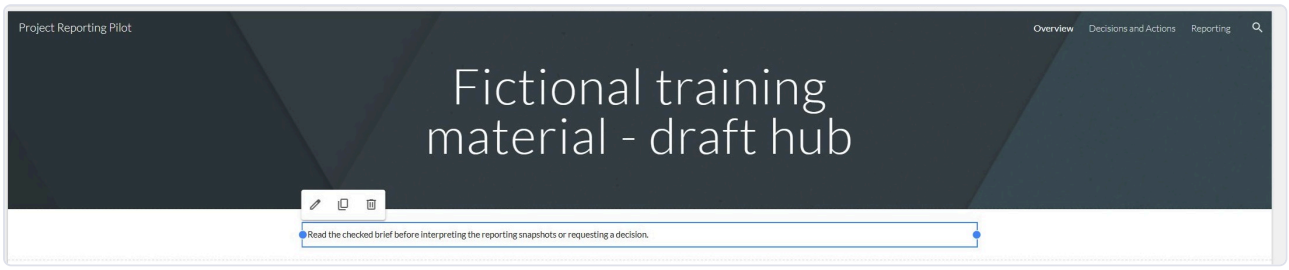
6.1 Design the Hub for Its Visitors

1. In Google Sites create a blank site named `GW - Project Reporting Pilot Hub`. Add a banner **Fictional training material - draft hub**.

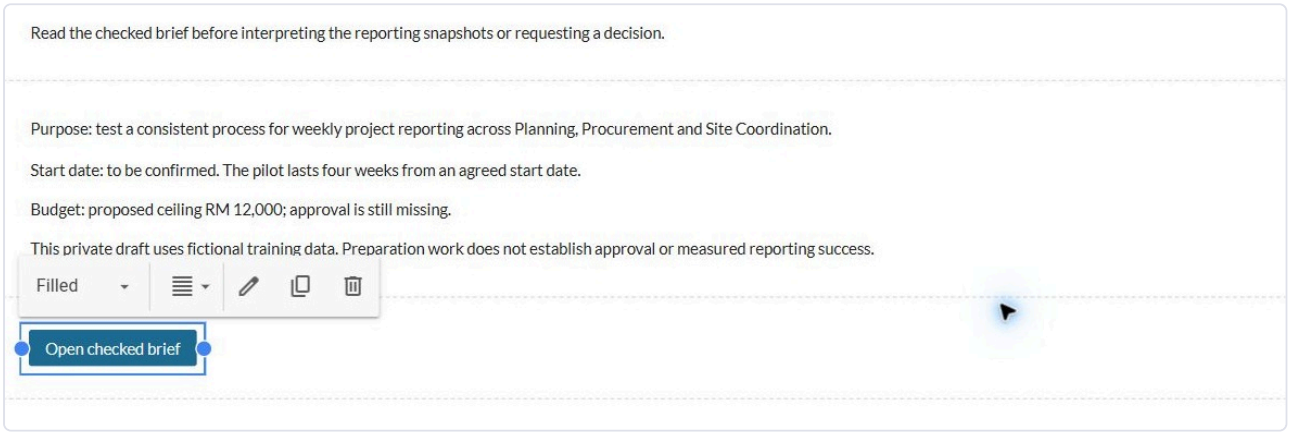


2. Create pages **Overview**, **Reporting** and **Decisions and Actions**. Write one sentence on each explaining the visitor's next useful action.

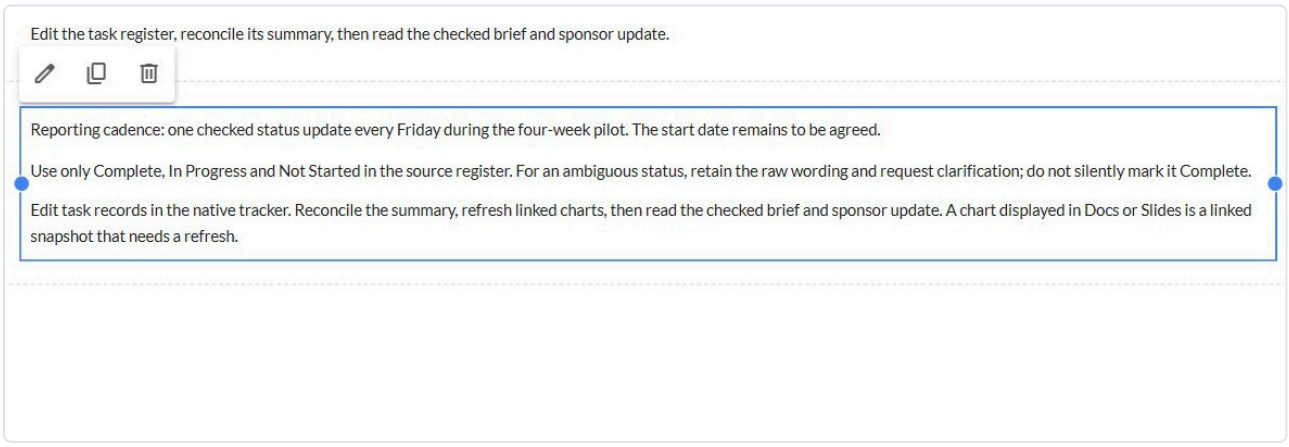




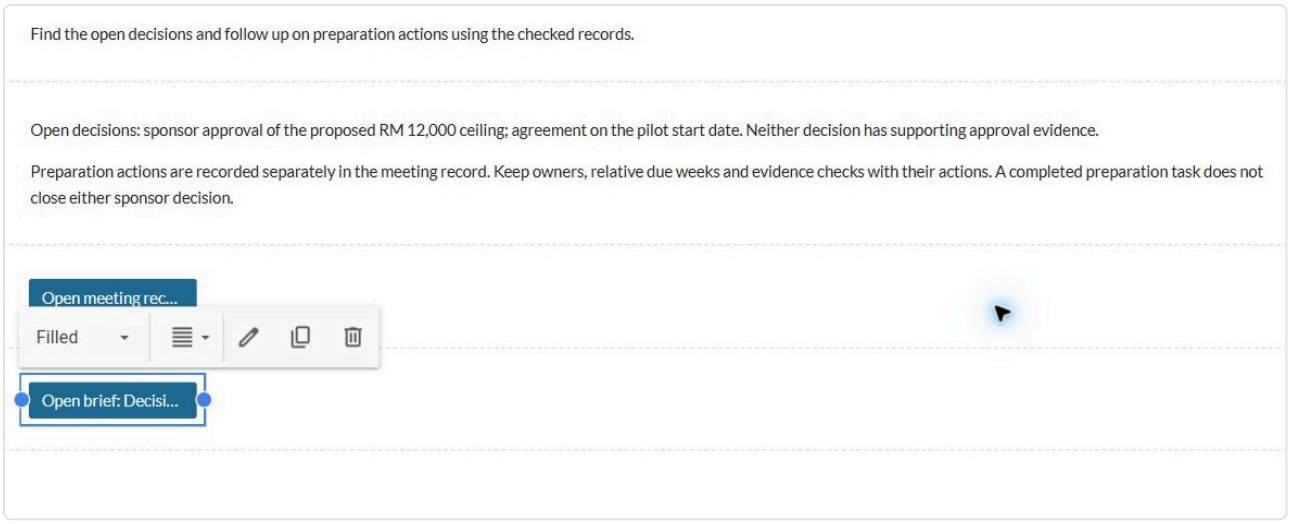
3. On Overview add the project purpose, unresolved start date and proposed budget caveat. Link to the checked brief. Avoid copying long sections that could become stale.



4. On Reporting add a short status-definition guide and the Friday reporting cadence. Explain where to edit source records and where readers should look for checked updates.



5. On Decisions and Actions add links to the meeting record and the brief's decision section. Keep open decisions visibly separate from completed preparation work.

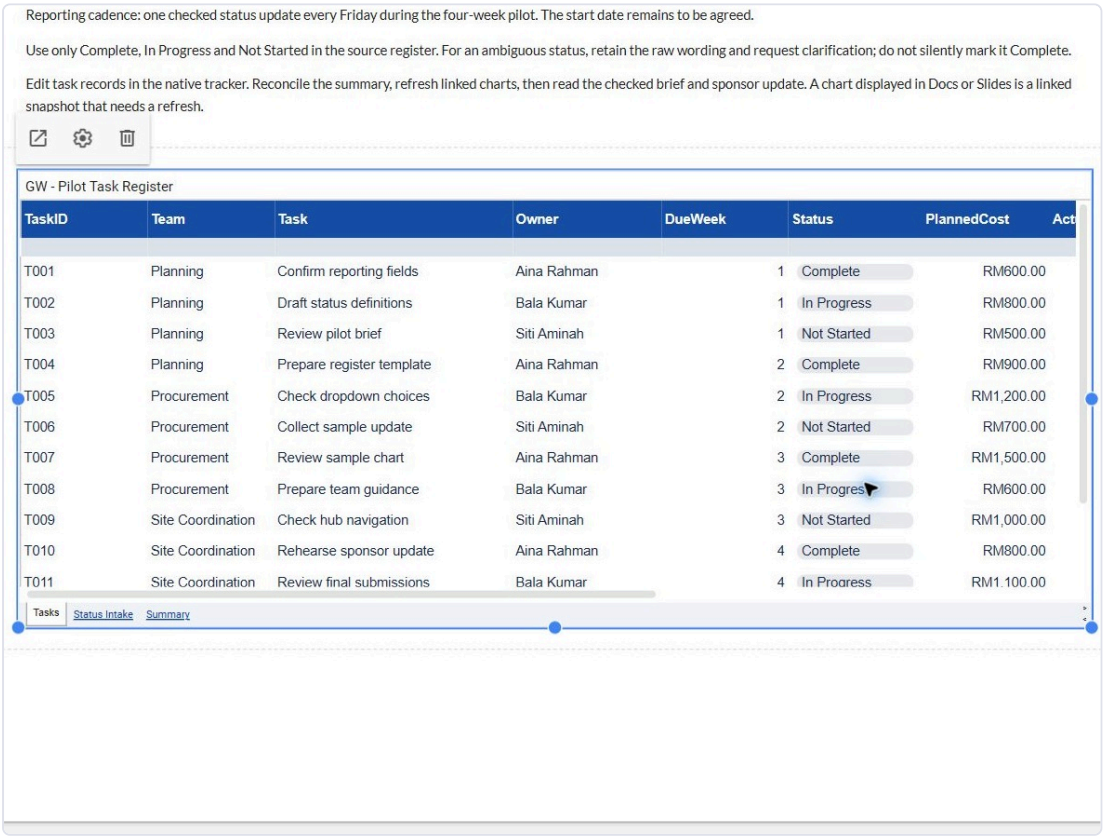


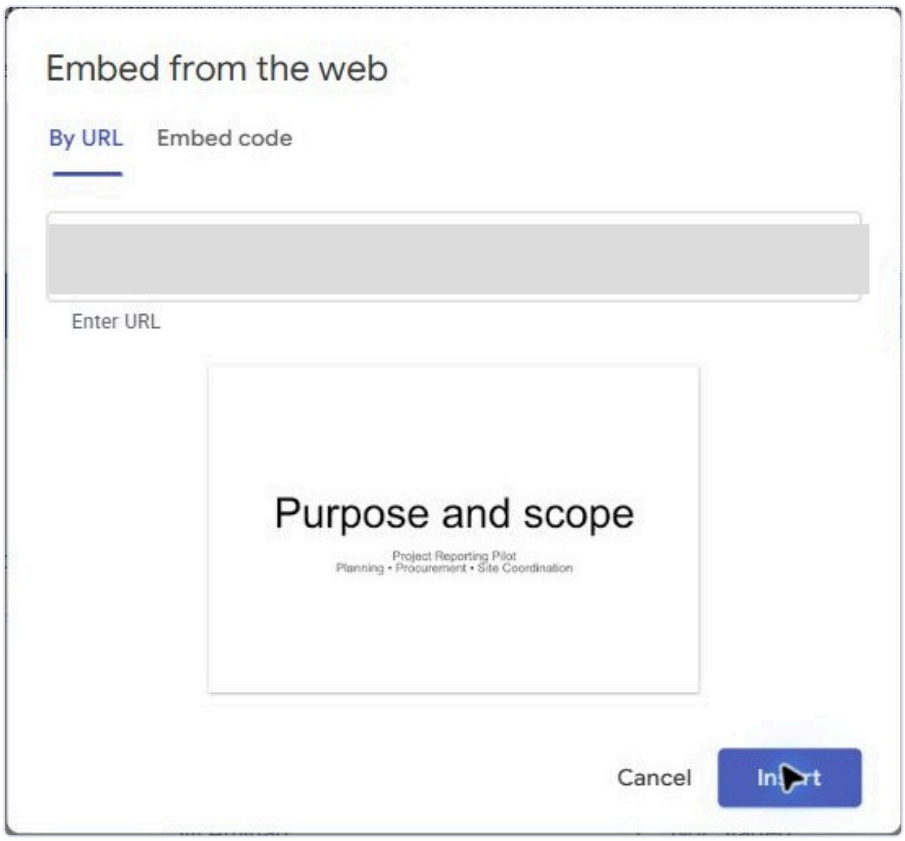
What should you see?

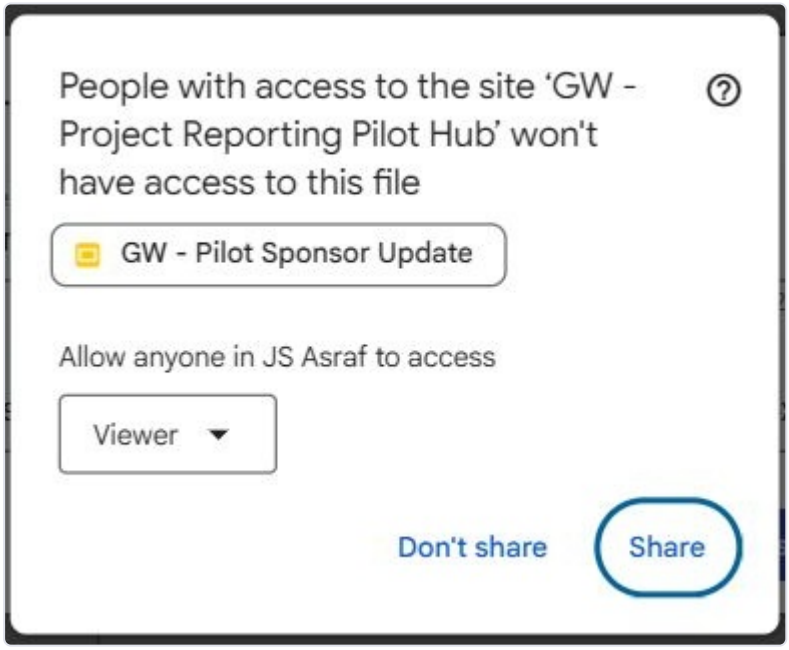
The draft hub has three distinct purposes and useful navigation. It directs editing to the source and does not imply that decisions have been approved.

6.2 Connect Resources and Check Access Dependencies

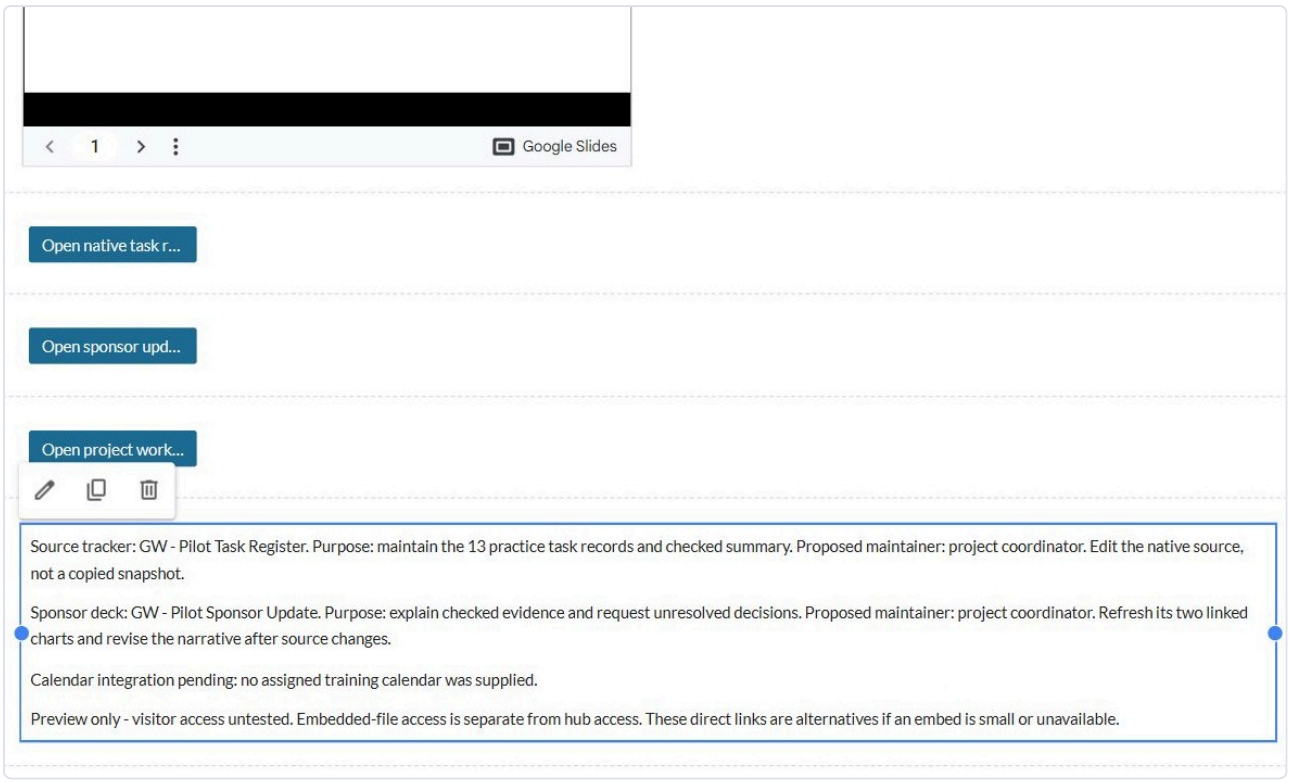
1. On Reporting use the available **Insert** controls to add the native tracker and Slides deck. Include clear text links beneath the embeds as an alternative way to open each resource.



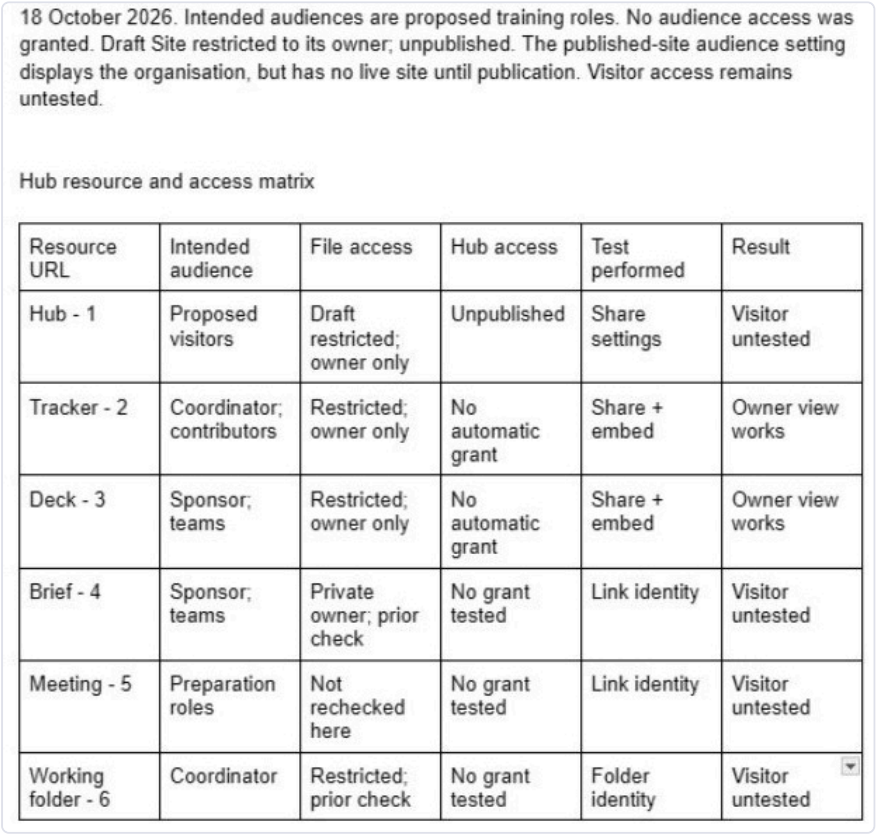




2. Add a link to the project working folder. Embed the practice calendar only if an assigned training calendar exists; otherwise include a clearly labelled **Calendar integration pending** note. Do not expose a personal calendar.
3. For each resource add a short caption: purpose, source file and who should maintain it. Label any not-yet-assigned maintainer as proposed.



4. Update the Workspace Register with a resource matrix: resource URL, intended audience, current file access, hub access, test performed and result.

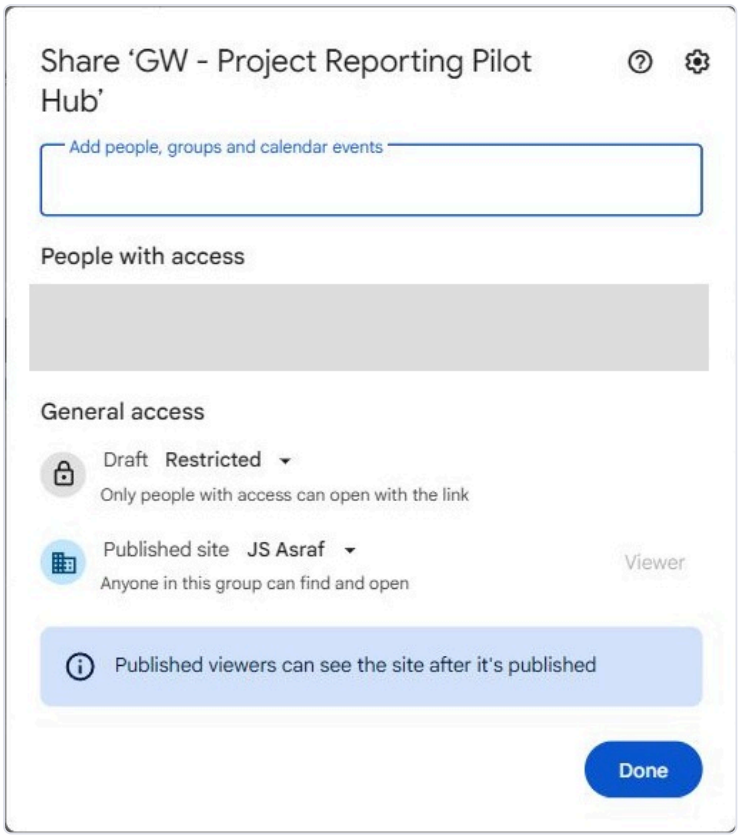


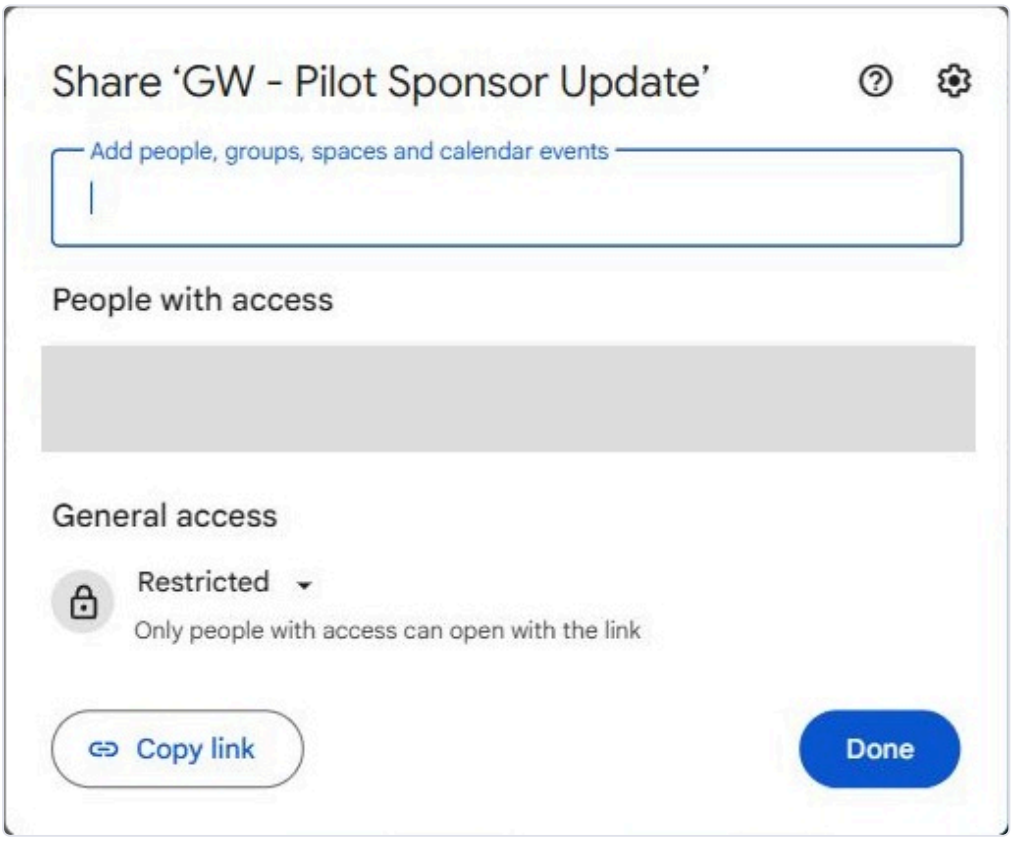
18 October 2026. Intended audiences are proposed training roles. No audience access was granted. Draft Site restricted to its owner; unpublished. The published-site audience setting displays the organisation, but has no live site until publication. Visitor access remains untested.

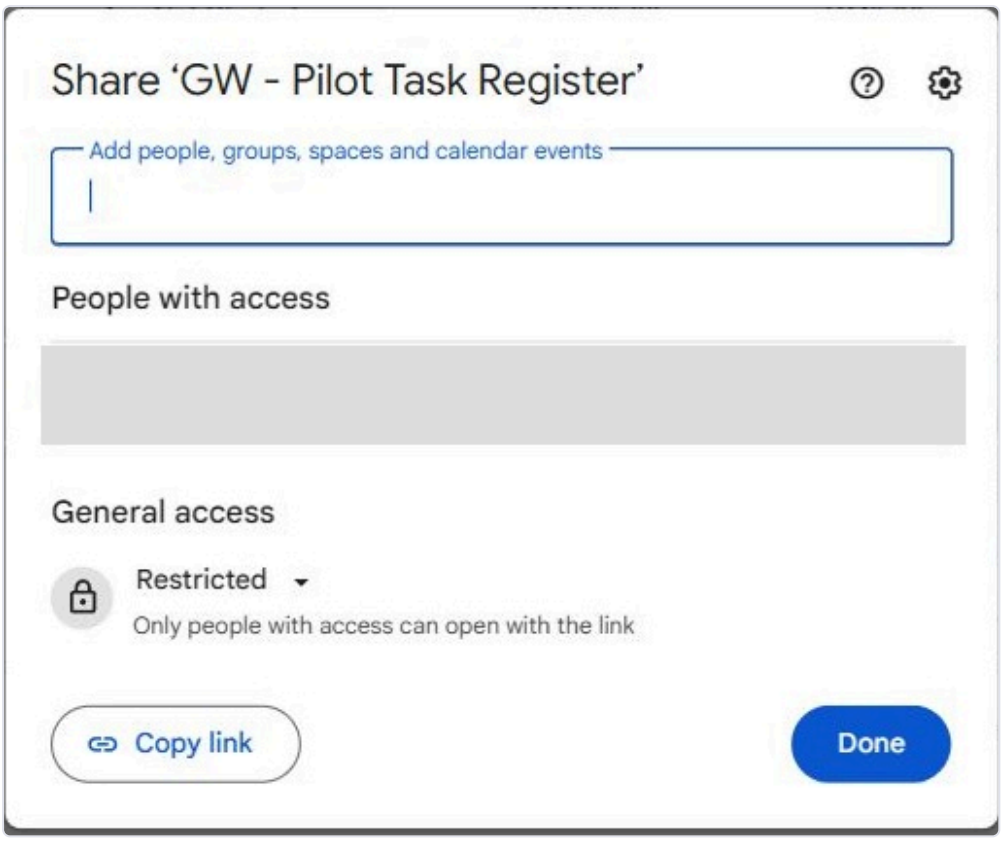
Hub resource and access matrix

Resource URL	Intended audience	File access	Hub access	Test performed	Result
Hub - 1	Proposed visitors	Draft restricted; owner only	Unpublished	Share settings	Visitor untested
Tracker - 2	Coordinator; contributors	Restricted; owner only	No automatic grant	Share + embed	Owner view works
Deck - 3	Sponsor; teams	Restricted; owner only	No automatic grant	Share + embed	Owner view works
Brief - 4	Sponsor; teams	Private owner; prior check	No grant tested	Link identity	Visitor untested
Meeting - 5	Preparation roles	Not rechecked here	No grant tested	Link identity	Visitor untested
Working folder - 6	Coordinator	Restricted; prior check	No grant tested	Folder identity	Visitor untested

5. Inspect the Site sharing settings and each embedded file's **Share** dialog separately. If using a training Shared Drive, inspect inherited membership too. Site access does not itself grant direct access to every embedded file.







6. If an assigned test viewer and an authorised restricted published sandbox already exist, test that route and log the actual result. Otherwise record **Preview only - visitor access untested**. A preview in your own editor account cannot prove a visitor's access.

What should you see?

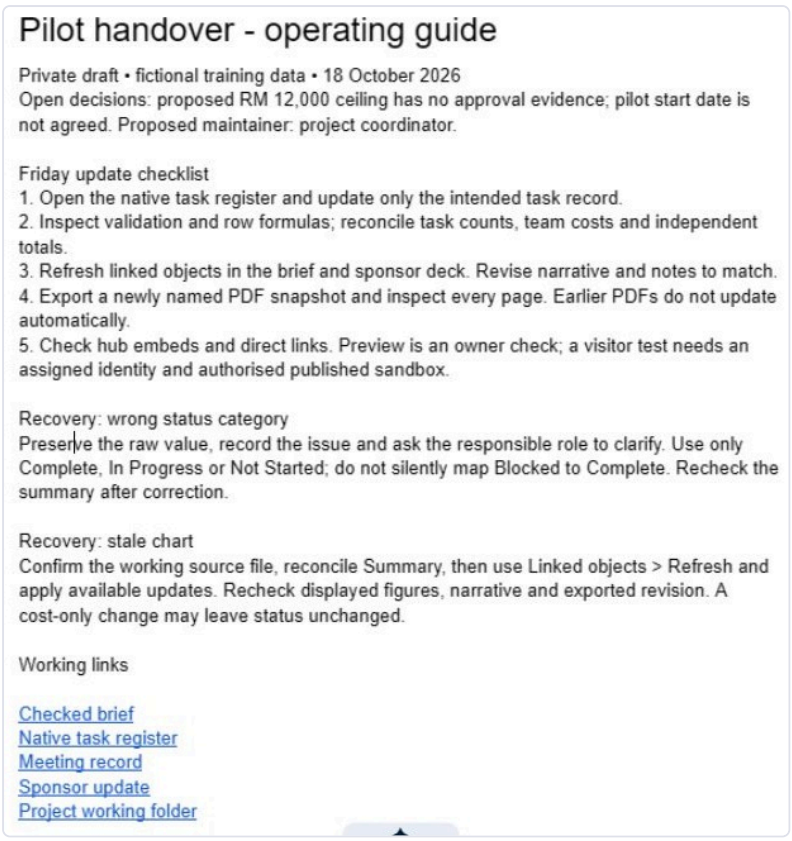
Every embed has a useful caption and direct link. The resource matrix separates inspected settings from tested visitor access; no public access is assumed.

6.3 Preview and Write the Operating Procedure

1. Choose **Preview** and inspect desktop and narrow-screen views. Check navigation order, chart legibility, broken or obscured embeds and text-link fallbacks.

Reference-run limitation: desktop and phone Preview opened with a blank content frame in this browser, including after reloading the saved draft and retrying desktop. Those layout and navigation checks remain unverified. The two native embeds rendered for the owner in the editor. Keep a failed preview distinct from a successful visitor test; do not publish or widen access to hide the limitation.

2. Open the text links and confirm each resolves to the intended working file. Record whether a displayed chart is a linked snapshot in Docs/Slides or a direct spreadsheet embed.
3. In the Workspace Register add a handover checklist: update task record, inspect validation and formulas, reconcile summary, refresh linked objects, revise narrative, export a new snapshot and check hub resources.
4. Add an exception route for ambiguous statuses and unresolved decisions: record the issue and ask the responsible role for clarification. Do not silently map ambiguity to Complete.



Pilot handover - operating guide

Private draft • fictional training data • 18 October 2026
Open decisions: proposed RM 12,000 ceiling has no approval evidence; pilot start date is not agreed. Proposed maintainer: project coordinator.

Friday update checklist
1. Open the native task register and update only the intended task record.
2. Inspect validation and row formulas; reconcile task counts, team costs and independent totals.
3. Refresh linked objects in the brief and sponsor deck. Revise narrative and notes to match.
4. Export a newly named PDF snapshot and inspect every page. Earlier PDFs do not update automatically.
5. Check hub embeds and direct links. Preview is an owner check; a visitor test needs an assigned identity and authorised published sandbox.

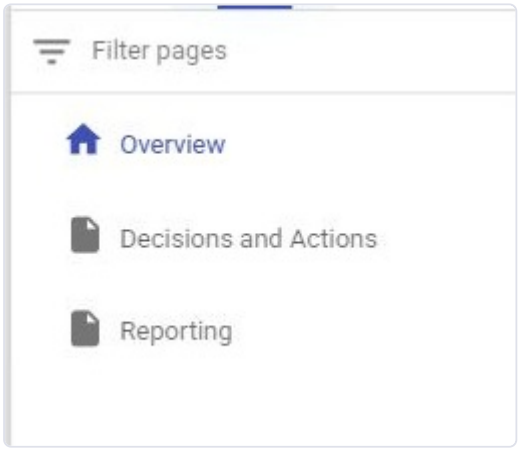
Recovery: wrong status category
Preserve the raw value, record the issue and ask the responsible role to clarify. Use only Complete, In Progress or Not Started; do not silently map Blocked to Complete. Recheck the summary after correction.

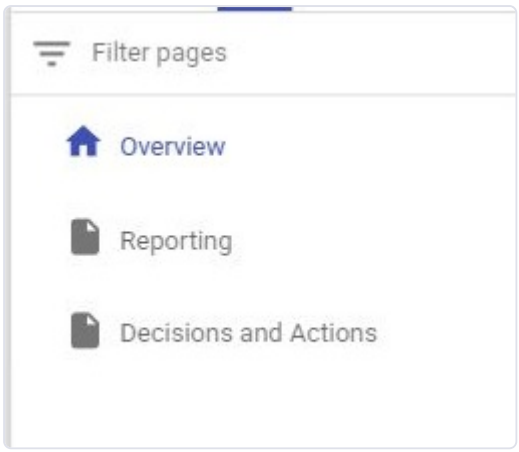
Recovery: stale chart
Confirm the working source file, reconcile Summary, then use Linked objects > Refresh and apply available updates. Recheck displayed figures, narrative and exported revision. A cost-only change may leave status unchanged.

Working links

Checked brief
Native task register
Meeting record
Sponsor update
Project working folder

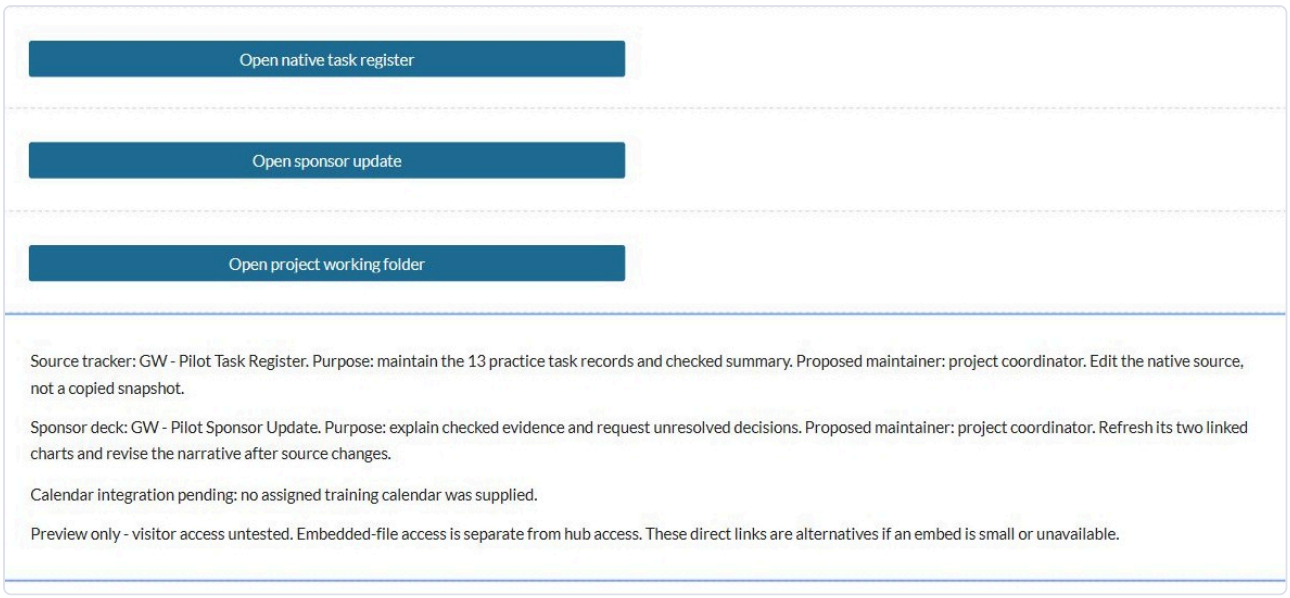
5. Give a partner the hub and checklist, or use a fresh read-through if working alone. Ask them to locate the source tracker, open decisions and refresh instructions. Record one navigation or wording improvement.

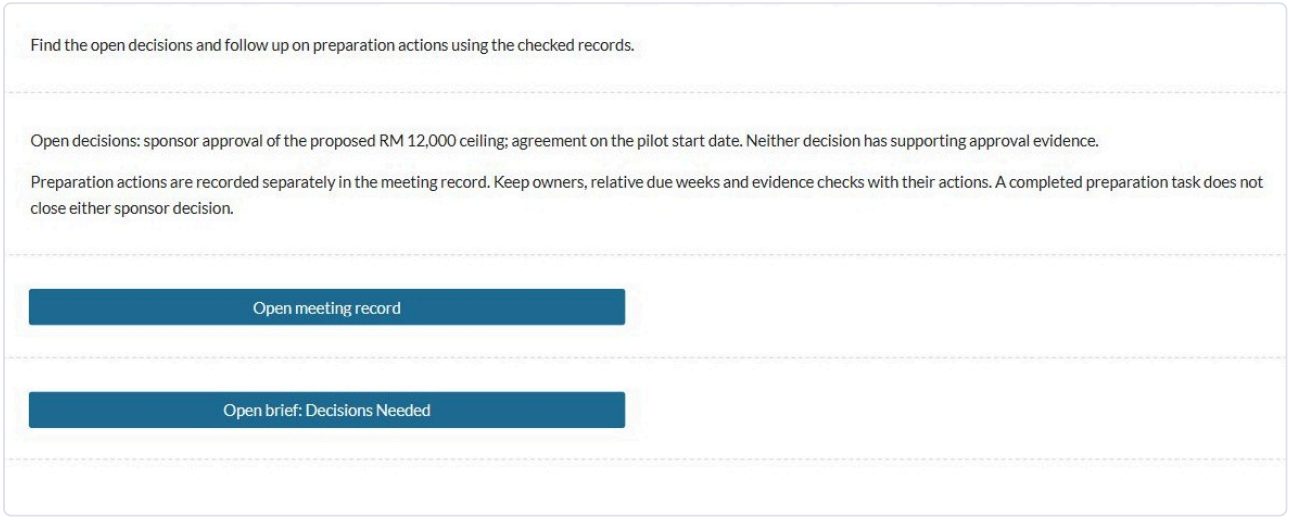




Hub author check and limitations

18 October 2026 — author read-through, not a partner or visitor test.
Navigation improvement: moved Reporting before Decisions and Actions. The saved order is Overview → Reporting → Decisions and Actions. This puts the source/update route before decision follow-up.
Five operating-guide hyperlinks were opened. Native titles and file IDs matched the checked brief, task register, meeting record, sponsor update and 02 Working folder. Site button destinations use these same working files; the brief decision button targets Decisions Needed.
Resource types: the hub contains a direct native spreadsheet embed and a native presentation embed. The charts inside the brief and Slides are linked snapshots, which require refresh after source changes. Direct text-link alternatives remain available.
Preview limitation: desktop and phone Preview opened with a blank content frame in this browser. Reloaded the saved draft and retried desktop; the frame remained blank. Desktop/narrow-screen layout, chart legibility and visitor navigation are not verified. The embeds rendered in the editor for the owner only.
Access limitation: draft Site Restricted, owner only; tracker and deck separately Restricted, owner only. The future published-site audience setting is the organisation. The site is unpublished. Chose Don't share when Sites offered wider file access. No assigned reviewer or published test sandbox was available. Preview only - visitor access untested.
Current source retained for the handover exercise: T013 actual cost RM 150, status Not Started, variance -RM 50. Thirteen tasks; counts 4/4/5; planned RM 10,600; actual RM 6,950; variance -RM 3,650.
The original fact sheet says budget proposed, not approved, and start date not yet agreed. The hub retains those qualifications. A request to label them approved or confirmed needs evidence.
Pending: Lab 6 independent change/restoration rehearsal, partner handover, resolved desktop/phone preview, visitor-access test and classroom timing. Keep this Site as an unpublished draft.





What should you see?

The workflow can be followed without the author pointing at each control. Preview checks are recorded separately from any visitor-access test.

Independent Challenge

Complete the Lab 6 handover card without following the earlier step lists.

1. Predict the effect of changing T003 to Complete in your current 13-row dataset. Change it at the source, reconcile counts, refresh the brief and deck, and inspect the hub's relevant resource.
2. Use the supplied "RM 12,000 approved" review request to decide whether the hub wording should change. Cite the fact sheet rather than accepting the request as project evidence.
3. Restore T003 to its original status and repeat the downstream checks. Keep T013 and its corrected actual cost from Labs 4 and 5.
4. Record before, changed and restored states with source URL, refresh action and the limitation of your access check. Identify any stale PDF and regenerate only the snapshots intended for handover.

5. Hand over a one-page operating guide with five links, unresolved decisions and two recovery procedures: wrong status category and stale chart. A partner must be able to find the correct source and explain the next refresh action.

Keep the site as a draft. If publication is needed for a later classroom access test, the trainer must provide the authorised destination and audience first.

Evidence to Hand Over

- Three-page draft Site or clearly labelled linked-Doc fallback.
- Resource/access matrix, preview results and one recorded navigation improvement.
- Change/restoration log and one-page operating guide with working links and two recovery procedures.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Repair to investigate
The author can see an embed but a reviewer cannot	Inspect resource permissions and inherited grants separately from the hub audience.
A chart appears current in one location only	Trace its source URL and object type, then refresh the affected linked destination.
The hub repeats outdated narrative	Link to maintained source material and update the short summary after checking the facts.
Sites is disabled	Build the linked-Doc fallback and mark Sites-specific checks pending.

Check Yourself

Explain one error you found, how you proved the correction, and which downstream result it could affect. A finished-looking file alone is not evidence that it is correct.

Collaborative Tools Masterclass

A practical 1-day course with step-by-step draft labs, copy-ready prompts, fictional inputs and expected-result checks. Use the supplied practice pack. Full lab execution, screenshots and classroom timing validation remain required before participant release.

Asraf Jaafar Sidik · Microsoft Certified Trainer ·